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SÈRIE 1

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

"AN INTERVIEW WITH GOTCHA, THE MUSICAL FORCE!"

In this podcast you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

to quote: citar textualment / citar textualmente

prone: propens/propenso

bouts: període/període

harp: arpa/arpa

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the podcast. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer (I): You are Gotcha, the musical force!

Gotcha (G): Haha, from now on I'm going to introduce myself as Gotcha, the musical force. My real name is Margot Chapman, but I guess I've got used to being called Gotcha more often now.

I: Right, I got you. That song we've just listened to, 'Turning a Blind Eye', is the first Australian single from your latest record, *Making Miracles*. It's a song that you say describes your feelings of being completely defeated, I'm **quoting** you, "by the realities of living in contemporary Australia." What's been difficult about life there?

G: Oh, it's not specifically about living in contemporary Australia, although I'm American. It comes from a place of defeat, I guess, in the sense of being someone who is concerned, maybe a bit more aware than some people, in terms of how things I do in my regular life, in terms of use of materials, driving cars, using so much disposable technology to make music, how that is so implicitly involved in so much... use, maybe overuse of resources?

I: Your carbon footprint.

G: Yeah. And I feel very conflicted about the reliability of the information available. When I try to research it and make changes, it's incredibly hard to find a clear basis for making informed judgments or decisions. It's hard to feel like anything I do makes a difference, even in my own life. Whether or not it sets an example for my fans or helps spread a more environmental message, sometimes it just feels like I'm making changes simply to avoid feeling completely defeated.

I: But the feeling of being "completely defeated" when you were writing this song suggests that you're quite pessimistic about our future. Are you?

G: I have moments like that, yeah. I sometimes change my mind a lot when I compose. You know, I think I'm an idealist a lot of the time, but often **prone** to **bouts** of very depressive cycles of thought and pessimism about the potential for really fundamental change in the way humans live on earth, at least. It's those moments when I feel like that really prompted the lyrics to 'Turning a Blind Eye'.

I: And what about the fact that now that you're touring, you're inevitably traveling more and experiencing not just different countries, but different cultures and different ways people are trying to deal with issues like the environment and ecological change? Does that make you feel more defeated, or do you find things on those travels that inspire you?

G: You know, touring for a music career does involve seeing a lot of airports, hotel rooms, cars, buses, et cetera, though some artists do it more than I do. Even so, I'm probably more in touch with the reality of having an ever-increasing carbon footprint, at least in terms of what I'm doing in my music career. And it is indeed something I think about.

I: So you wrote the song 'Turning a Blind Eye' feeling completely defeated. It's getting worse now because the song's popular and your carbon footprint is harming everybody.

G: Haha. I do think about that. It's funny, more and more people tell me, I must be so overjoyed and amazed by the success and how big everything's getting. But I guess part of what makes me worry and that might lead to writing a song like this, is the sense that the bigger things get, the less likely they are to stay sustainable or be personal. I don't know...

I: And not just environmentally, but materially, emotionally.

G: Emotionally, yeah, trying to communicate with increasing numbers of people. I feel a bit freaked out about it. I think I have a different approach. It's difficult for me to even write anything on my Twitter account; even though it's not like I have a huge number of people following me there, only around 40, 50,000. I still think about it. I know plenty of people have millions of followers on these social media. But even so, realizing that my audience is broader now, and that lots of different kinds of people are discovering my music, changes how aware I am of who I'm speaking to on these platforms.

I: Let me talk a bit about the record, *Making Miracles*. You're getting a lot of attention for this record, and that's got to be rewarding given the amount of work that you put into it. You play most of the instruments on it, but even more remarkable is the method of taking acoustic instruments, recording them note by note, and then turning them into virtual instruments. What exactly does that mean you're doing in terms of creating these sounds?

G: Yes, it's the case of a **harp** that I found at an antique shop. A harp is not particularly a new-sounding instrument. It's one you've probably heard. The way it sounds on a record is usually quite angelic, because that's the way you can play it, but to record it note by note and then have control over those notes just means that you make the instrument sound incredible. It almost turns into a completely new instrument.

I: That's remarkably creative and innovative, but where does that come from? I mean, do you have an allergy to just playing an acoustic guitar and singing a song?

G: Well, I'm really excited by alternative ways of making music. They open up windows to sound worlds I haven't explored before, and those are the kinds of records I want to make. I'm not against using traditional instruments: there's plenty of piano and regular drum kits on the album, but I have a pretty intense interest in things like, what if you could use... a plastic ball and use that as a drum instead of just getting a drum out and putting a mic on it. It's just more interesting. It just means there's more of a story. I guess it creates a far greater range of textures, though it also takes time.

I: This is so interesting, Gotcha, but I'm afraid we have run out of time. It's been a pleasure to have you here with us today.

G: Nice to chat, too.

Adapted from:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-0kNQc_UHn0

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions].

1. Her awareness of how everyday habits lead to overconsumption.
2. it's hard to know what really helps.
3. She alternates idealism and deep pessimism about the future, which is reflected in her songs.
4. How travelling constantly increases her environmental impact.
5. She fears larger projects will feel less meaningful to her.
6. She is more aware of the diversity of her audience and how that affects her communication.
7. The resulting sound is amazing.
8. they help her explore a new way to make music and create more original musical stories.

II. Reading Comprehension (3 points)

WHAT'S AFTER UMAMI? SCIENTISTS ARE HUNTING FOR THE SIXTH BASIC TASTE

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. Each question is worth 0.5 points with a total of 3 points. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

1.

Umami was recognized as the fifth basic taste after research/investigations corroborated/stated/proved that it was different from other tastes we already know/have.

2.

two effects/consequences/applications/results of understanding the science of taste.

3.

Contrary to popular belief

4.

Flavor is the (result of the) interaction between taste and other senses in the brain.

OR

Flavor is the (result of the) combination of taste, texture, temperature and aroma in the brain.

OR

Flavor is what registers in the brain when it combines the entire experience of taste, texture, temperature and aroma.

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Sèrie 5

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

A CONVERSATION WITH YAYOI KUSAMA ON THE POWER OF ART AND EMOTIONS

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

art installations: instal·lacions artístiques – creacions artístiques / instalaciones artísticas – creaciones artísticas

polka dots: estampat de topos / estampado de topos

boundless: sense límits / sin límites

tapestry: tapís / tapiz

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer: In the realm of contemporary art, few figures are as iconic and enigmatic as Yayoi Kusama. Renowned for her avant-garde **art installations**, **polka dots**, and infinite reflections, Kusama has captivated the world with her unique artistic vision. Today, we have the privilege of delving into the mind of this visionary artist, exploring her thoughts on the transformative power of art. Good morning, thanks for being with us today.

Yayoi Kusama: Good morning, thanks for the invitation.

Interviewer: Your art is often described as a celebration of love and hope. How do you envision the relationship between your work and these powerful emotions?

Yayoi Kusama: Love and hope are the essence of my art. They are the driving forces behind my creations. When people encounter my installations, I want them to feel a sense of **boundless** love and hope, transcending the boundaries of time and space. Through my work, I aim to cultivate a shared experience that unites people in a profound, positive way.

Interviewer: That was deep indeed! Your "Infinity Rooms" are immersive experiences that transport viewers into realms beyond this world. How do these installations contribute to the exploration of love and hope?

Yayoi Kusama: The "Infinity Rooms" are like cosmic vessels, offering a glimpse into the countless possibilities of love and hope. As visitors step into these spaces, surrounded by endless reflections, they are immersed in a universe of boundless

potential. It's a symbolic journey that mirrors the limitless nature of love and hope, inviting individuals to reflect on their own place within the cosmic **tapestry**. I believe sharing these positive emotions is the power of art. I fight anxiety and fear every day, and the only method I have found that relieves my illness is to keep creating this type of art.

Interviewer: Actually, in your autobiography, you mention struggling with mental health issues. How has art been a source of healing and hope for you?

Yayoi Kusama: Art has been my refuge, a sanctuary where I can channel my innermost feelings. In the darkest moments of my mental health struggles, creating art became a lifeline. It allowed me to transform pain into beauty, despair into hope. Art has been a cathartic journey, helping me to navigate the complexities of my emotions.

Interviewer: In any case, your use of polka dots is a signature element in your art. I perceive these motifs as a representation of hallucinatory visions. Similar to how episodes of depersonalization invoke fear, these dots create a visual manifestation of anxiety. The dots multiply and attach themselves to the surroundings, becoming a form of psychic obsession that you attempt to run away from.

Yayoi Kusama: Yes, I paint them abundantly; it's my way of trying to escape.

Interviewer: But can you also tell us about the significance of polka dots in conveying positive messages?

Yayoi Kusama: Polka dots are a symbol of the world, the cosmos, and our interconnectedness. When I cover surfaces with dots, I'm expressing the idea that we are all dots in this vast universe. The repetition of dots signifies the multiplicity of individuals, yet the pattern also reflects unity. It's a visual metaphor for the collective energy that binds us together, creating a sense of harmony and love.

Interviewer: Oh wow. Now, your installations are experienced by people from diverse backgrounds. How do you believe your art can bridge cultural gaps and speak a universal language of love and hope?

Yayoi Kusama: Art transcends cultural barriers, you know, it's a universal language that speaks directly to the heart. My installations are intentionally designed to be inclusive, offering a space where people from all walks of life can connect on a fundamental level. Love and hope, being universal emotions, provide a common ground for individuals to come together, fostering a sense of unity that surpasses cultural differences.

Interviewer: Can you tell us about your time in Japan before going to the US? You moved to New York at twenty-seven. By then, you must have already developed your unique style as a painter, rooted in Japan. Yet you didn't emphasize your identity as a Japanese artist.

Yayoi Kusama: I wasn't really aware of it. In Japan, the art community isolated me because of my mental health struggles. That's why I chose to leave Japan and pursue my art in New York. I picked America because of my connections and the belief that the future of art was in New York. However, I faced challenges due to restrictions on foreign exchange imposed by the Japanese government. I even had to sell my kimonos.

Interviewer: How do you see the role of art evolving in society, especially in fostering a sense of hope and unity in the face of global challenges?

Yayoi Kusama: In times of uncertainty, art becomes a ray of light. It has the power to inspire, uplift, and unite communities. As we confront global challenges, art catalyzes change, encouraging collective action and fostering a shared vision of a better future. It's a testament to the enduring capacity of art to instill hope and bring people together in the pursuit of a brighter tomorrow.

Interviewer: This interview has come to a close, leaving us with a profound understanding of how this visionary artist continues to shape the landscape of contemporary art with her timeless messages of love and hope.

Adapted from:

Yayoi Kusama on Sixties New York, Surviving Mental Illness and Why She's Never Thought About Feminism, Artspace, Akira Tatehata (May 5, 2020).

https://www.artspace.com/magazine/interviews_features/meet_the_artist/interview-yayoi-kusama-on-sixties-new-york-living-with-mental-illness-and-why-shes-never-thought-56560

Yayoi Kusama on love, hope and the power of art, Wallpaper, Megan C. Hills (March 22, 2023).

https://www.wallpaper.com/art/yayoi-kusama-interview

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions].

1. The essence of her art lies in creating a collective supportive feeling.
2. our place in the universe.
3. Art has given her tools to reverse her suffering and despair.
4. To represent distress.
5. Polka dots symbolize how individuals are connected.
6. Because her art connects people at the core of their essence as human beings.
7. The Japanese artists did not support her because of her mental health issues.
8. Art inspires people to work together for the common good.

II. Reading Comprehension (3 points)

THE SCIENCE OF FEAR: HOW IT AFFECTS YOUR BODY AND MIND

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. Each question is worth 0.5 points with a total of 3 points. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

1. Sabre-tooth tigers are not usually encountered anymore.
2. The production of dopamine can cause a sense of joy/satisfaction/bliss when experiencing/during/in frightening moments/events.

   (among others)
3. The hippocampus recalls familiar past events/thoughts/actions to aid the brain know whether the present danger is true or unreal.

   (among others)
4. Frequent exposure to scary experiences can desensitize the brain, reducing its ability to react strongly to real threats.
5. weigh(s) (line 20)
6. It's important to understand what fear is so that you… can appreciate its role in survival and entertainment but also treat its impact on your health with respect.

III. Writing (4 points)

Choose ONE topic. Your answer should be 125-150 words in length. There is no specific penalty for exceeding 150 words in length. Extra points are not given for exceeding 150 words.

Including a title is optional.

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SÈRIE 2

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

THE WORLD OF CENOTES

In this podcast you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

limestone: pedra calcària/caliza

coral reef: escull de coral/arrecife de coral

jade: jade/jade

manatee: manatí/manatí

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the podcast. [Now listen to the interview.]

Journalist: Ms. Zicari, thank you for joining us today. You're known as one of the top experts on cenotes. To begin, could you explain to our listeners what a cenote actually is?

Alison Zicari: Thank you for having me. A cenote is a natural hole in the ground. It forms when the roof of an underground cave collapses and allows us to see the water inside. The word "cenote" usually describes an underground chamber filled with permanent water.

Journalist: Where can people find these cenotes?

AZ: You can find cenotes in several parts of the world, but the best-known and largest concentration is in Mexico, especially on the Yucatán Peninsula. This whole peninsula is made from **limestone**, which used to be a huge **coral reef** millions of years ago. When the sea level dropped, the reef was exposed, and over time, it became full of caves, tunnels, and holes. Today, the land's almost completely flat, but underneath it's a giant network of underground rivers filled with rainwater that travels through cracks in the limestone filling caves which sometimes collapse creating cenotes. Scientists estimate that there're more than 7,000 cenotes in the Yucatán.

Journalist: That number is incredible. Can you tell us more about the cave systems connected to cenotes?

AZ: Yes, the Yucatán is home to some of the world's longest underwater cave systems. One of the most famous is Sistema Sac Actun, located in the Riviera Maya. It stretches about 350 kilometers and reaches a depth of around 119 meters. Explorers and archaeologists have found many important remains inside these caves, including 9,000-year-old human bones and the bones of animals that lived during the ice age. These discoveries tell us that humans have been exploring or using these caves for thousands of years.

Journalist: Speaking of humans, cenotes played a very important role in the Maya civilization, didn't they?

AZ: They certainly did. For the Maya, cenotes were not just a source of fresh water, though that alone made them extremely valuable. They also believed cenotes were the entrance to the underworld. According to Maya beliefs, spirits and gods visited cenotes, especially Chaac, the god of rain, thunder, and lightning. Because of this, the Maya built many of their temples and villages near cenotes. In fact, new research shows that some important Maya cities—such as Chichén Itzá—were actually built directly on top of cenotes.

Journalist: Were these cenotes used for ceremonies?

AZ: Yes. Some cenotes became sacred places for rituals and offerings. Archaeologists have found items such as jade, gold, silver, and incense at the bottom of these cenotes. They have also discovered human remains. At places like the Sacred Cenote at Chichén Itzá, many of the bodies show wounds that suggest human sacrifice. However, other cenotes contain human remains without signs of violence, so these may have been peaceful burials, perhaps to prepare people for the next life.

Journalist: And today, people visit cenotes for very different reasons, right?

AZ: That's right. Today cenotes are still important for water, but they're also major tourist attractions. Millions of visitors come every year to swim, dive, snorkel, and explore. Some cenotes offer cultural experiences where visitors can watch modern Maya ceremonies. These ceremonies aren't dangerous—of course, no one's sacrificed—but they still include symbolic offerings like resin, cacao, seeds, corn, flower petals, and sugar.

Journalist: There's also a surprising connection between cenotes and the asteroid that killed the dinosaurs. Can you explain that?

AZ: Yes, it's a fascinating story. About 66 million years ago, an asteroid about 10 to 15 kilometers wide crashed on the Yucatán Peninsula. The explosion released as much energy as 100 trillion tons of TNT. This event caused huge fires, tsunamis, and climate changes that led to the extinction of many species, including the dinosaurs. The impact also changed the structure of the limestone underground. It made the rock weaker and

easier to erode. Over millions of years, groundwater moved in special patterns around the edge of the impact crater. This process created the "Ring of Cenotes." The crater itself is buried under layers of ground and ocean, so we cannot see it with our eyes, but the ring of cenotes is still visible from space. The city of Mérida is right in the middle of this ancient crater.

Journalist: Besides history and geology, cenotes also have interesting wildlife. Can you tell us about that?

AZ: Yes, cenotes are important habitats for many animals. Because they're protected from the open ocean, they offer calm, safe spaces. Manatees, for example, sometimes travel from the Caribbean Sea into cenotes through underwater caves. They rest there and even nurse their young. Crocodiles also live in some cenotes. They're part of the natural ecosystem, and tourists need to keep a respectful distance. They're usually calm, but like all wild animals, they should never be disturbed.

Journalist: All of this makes cenotes sound like truly remarkable places. Any final thoughts for our audience?

AZ: Yes. I think cenotes are some of the most unique natural wonders in the world. They combine geology, history, culture, wildlife, and adventure in one place. They've been important for thousands of years—from the time of the Maya to the present day—and they're still full of discoveries waiting to be made. Anyone who visits the Yucatán should explore at least one cenote. It's an experience you'll never forget.

Adapted from:

https://cenotefinder.com/what-are-cenotes/#google_vignette
https://www.bbc.com/travel/article/20240628-the-hidden-wonders-of-mexicos-sacred-underwater-world

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions].

1. A cave ceiling collapses and reveals hidden water
2. It used to be a coral formation that became exposed.
3. water traveling through rock beneath the Surface
4. Evidence of ancient life, both human and animal
5. Cenotes provided water and were seen as spiritual gateways
6. They valued precious items for religious ceremonies
7. Water flows around the impact crater made a circular chain of cenotes.
8. They look for protection and need a quiet shelter

II. Reading Comprehension (3 points)

YOU MIGHT BE A LATE BLOOMER

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. Each question is worth 0.5 points with a total of 3 points. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

1.

The are 3 options (ONLY ONE IS NEEDED and any of the 3 is fine):

- Our school system sorts people by the time they are 18.
- Many models of success became successful when they were young.
- Magazines publish lists of young superstars.

(If they mention more than one, 0.25)

2.

They are all people who became successful late in life.

3.

Late bloomers accomplish success/live their lives/succeed in life/make progress (…) in ways that are different from the usual ones.

4.

Second-mountain people conquer their career mountain first/succeed early in life but find their success unsatisfying and they leave their careers to serve humanity.

5.

They have distinct characteristics that are not considered/seen/taken into account/encouraged by the present-day education authorities/laws.

(among other options)

6.

Any TWO of the following:

- Late bloomers do not plan ahead.
- They regard their lives as experiments.
- They focus on the process of learning.
- They enjoy the process of learning.
- They live their lives as a long period of trial and error.
- They are slow at the start but fast as they age.

(If they mention one, 0.25. If they mention more than two, 0.25).

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SÈRIE 1

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

ULURU: EXPLORING THE HEART AND SPIRIT OF AUSTRALIA

Journalist: Welcome to our program! Today we're joined by Dr. Cris Wood, a geologist and expert on Uluru, one of Australia's most iconic landmarks. Thank you for being here, Dr. Wood.

Dr. Wood: Thank you for having me. It's great to share the story of such an incredible place.

Journalist: Uluru is famous worldwide for its striking appearance, but why is it considered so special by the Aboriginal people?

Dr. Wood: Uluru is a sacred site for the Anangu people, the traditional custodians of the land. To them, it's more than a natural formation; it's deeply tied to their Tjukurpa, which is their system of beliefs and laws. Tjukurpa includes the creation of stories that explain how the land and its features came to be. Many parts of Uluru, including its caves and waterholes, are connected to these stories. The Anangu see themselves as caretakers of Uluru, and they ask visitors to respect their traditions when visiting.

Journalist: One of those traditions includes discouraging people from climbing the rock, which surprises many visitors. Why is climbing considered disrespectful?

Dr. Wood: For the Anangu, Uluru is a place of spiritual significance. They believe that climbing it disrespects its sacred nature. Traditionally, they don't climb it themselves. Instead, they encourage visitors to explore the base, visit waterholes, and learn about their culture at the cultural center. Climbing used to be popular, but now many people understand the importance of respecting indigenous beliefs and choose not to climb.

Journalist: Uluru is also a geological marvel. Could you tell us more about how it was formed?

Dr. Wood: Certainly! Uluru's story began about 550 million years ago. Back then, it was part of a massive mountain range called the Petermann Ranges, which were similar in size to the Himalayas. Over time, the mountains eroded, and rivers carried sand and gravel to the base. This material eventually formed two iconic landmarks: Uluru and Kata Tjuta. Uluru is made of arkose sandstone, which is rich in feldspar crystals. It's incredibly durable because the sand wasn't transported far, so it didn't undergo much erosion. Over millions of years, geological forces tilted the rock layers vertically, which is why we see those striking lines on Uluru's surface today.

Journalist: The red color of Uluru is so distinctive. What causes it?

Dr. Wood: The red colour comes from oxidation, or rusting, of the iron minerals in the rock. When the sandstone is exposed to the air, the iron reacts with oxygen, giving it that beautiful red hue. Interestingly, the rock underneath, which hasn't been exposed to the atmosphere, is actually grey.

Journalist: The Red Centre is known for its harsh conditions. What's the best way for visitors to explore Uluru and its surroundings?

Dr. Wood: The best way is by car. You can hire a vehicle at Ayers Rock Airport and drive around the area, including Uluru, Kata Tjuta, and the nearby town of Yulara. Driving gives you the freedom to explore at your own pace. While there is a shuttle bus in Yulara township, it doesn't operate within the national park. Beyond Uluru, many of the Northern Territory's attractions are accessible by well-maintained roads, whether you're in a regular car, campervan, or a four-by-four.

Journalist: Speaking of visiting, when is the best time of year to see Uluru?

Dr. Wood: Winter, from June to August, is the most popular time. The days are crisp and cool, making it perfect for outdoor activities. Summer, from December to February, is far too hot, with daytime temperatures often exceeding 40°C. Spring and autumn are much better with warm days and cooler evenings, so they're also great for visiting. No matter the season, it's essential to plan for the desert climate, which can have extreme temperature changes between day and night.

Journalist: Are there any safety tips you'd recommend for visitors?

Dr. Wood: Absolutely. Stay hydrated, as the desert air is very dry, and always carry water when walking or driving. Protect yourself from the sun with a hat, sunscreen, and lightweight clothing. It's also important to check the weather before heading out, as conditions can change quickly. Stick to marked paths, respect wildlife, and pay attention to park signals. Luckily, the area around Uluru and Yulara is well-equipped with facilities, rangers, and maps to help visitors stay safe.

Journalist: What do you recommend for visitors who want to learn more about the Anangu culture?

Dr. Wood: The cultural centre near Uluru is an excellent place to start. You cannot stay there overnight, but it offers displays, videos, and artworks that explain the Anangu way of life and their connection to the land. Visitors can also join guided tours led by local guides who share stories and traditions. These experiences help people understand why Uluru is so much more than a tourist attraction—it's a living, spiritual landscape.

Journalist: What's something people often don't expect about visiting Uluru?

Dr. Wood: Many are surprised by the variety of things to see and do around the rock. For instance, Uluru has many caves and waterholes, which are beautiful and have cultural significance. The base walk, which is about 10 kilometers long, lets visitors see the rock

up close, including its unique patterns, plants, and wildlife. It's also a great way to experience the changing colors of Uluru at sunrise or sunset. These colors are breathtaking and truly unforgettable.

Journalist: Finally, why do you think Uluru leaves such a lasting impression on people?

Dr. Wood: Uluru is a place where natural beauty meets deep cultural history. Its size and color are striking, but it's the stories and significance behind it that make it truly special. Many visitors say they feel a strong connection to the land when they visit. Whether it's the spirituality, the geology, or the quiet majesty of the desert, Uluru has a way of staying with you long after you've left.

Journalist: Thank you, Dr. Wood, for sharing your insights. Uluru sounds like a destination that offers both natural wonder and cultural depth.

Dr. Wood: It really is. Thank you for having me!

Adapted from:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j9t6kYpYnX4

https://www.abc.net.au/news/science/2017-06-27/how-did-uluru-and-kata-tjuta-form/8572068

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points (check the grid above). There is no penalty for unanswered questions].

1.

It holds deep connections to their Tjukurpa, or belief system.

2.

They think it violates the sacred meaning of the site.

3.

Through the erosion of a mountain range.

4.

The sandstone oxidizes when in contact to the air.

5.

December to February

6.

Drinking water and using sun protection

7.

Insights into Anangu culture.

8.

The many caves, waterholes, and wildlife.

II. Reading Comprehension (3 points)

TIPPING IS MORE CONFUSING THAN EVER. HERE'S HOW TO HANDLE IT

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. Each question is worth 0.5 points with a total of 3 points. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

1.

The practice of tipping started in America after the Civil War and it was brought by travellers who used to pay formerly enslaved black people, many of whom worked for a pittance as porters for the Pullman Company.

2.

Americans have been leaving a little extra with the bill for pretty much as long as the country has existed (lines 5-6).

3.

The tip credit system permitted businesses to pay their staff less than required if tipping increased their salaries to the minimum or more.

4.

Tips are believed to be expected in more places because we are in the digital era and pressing "no" on a screen feels ruder than not leaving any dollars in a jar/neglecting to toss a dollar in a glass jar.

5.

The tips workers get/receive might be determined by/might be related to their appearance rather than/and not by/to how well they treat you/how good the service was.

(among others)

6.

The second factor we should consider when tipping is whether the service you receive/are provided with/get is better/of higher quality/more valuable than the money the person doing it is receiving.

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Sèrie 4

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

30 BY 30

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

sea urichin: *eriçó de mar/erizo de mar*

seaweed: *algues/algas*

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer: Today I am joined by marine ecologist Jordan Scala who is here to tell us about 30 by 30, an ambitious plan to protect our planet. Jordan, what made you want to get started with this plan?

Jordan: When I was a kid growing up in the Mediterranean, I was fascinated by the underwater world that Jacques Cousteau showed us in his documentaries. When he started filming during World War II, the Mediterranean shores were still full of large fish. But when I went to the sea to swim in the '70s, I saw none of that. There were **sea urchins** at the bottom, but I never saw a large fish. The industrialisation of fishing after World War II put the final nail in the coffin of Mediterranean marine life. I thought nature was lost. Until, in my 20s, I started scuba diving in the Medes Islands marine reserve in Spain. One square kilometre fully protected from fishing and other damaging activities. I still remember that first dive in the reserve. As soon as I put my head underwater, I felt like diving into one of Cousteau's films. What was missing from the sea of my childhood was there: octopus, large fish, **seaweed** forests. Just a few years of protection had allowed the sea to recover.

Interviewer: Is the Medes Islands marine reserve unique, are there other areas of the sea which have recovered?

Jordan: No, I have seen this miracle happen in other areas across the ocean, like in Cabo Pulmo, Mexico, where local fishermen were so upset about not having enough fish to catch, that in the mid-90s, they asked the Mexican government to create a no-fishing area. A national park in the sea. We surveyed the marine environment then, and the place was an underwater desert. When we returned a decade later, everything had changed. What had been an empty sea was now full of life and colour. We saw it recover in only 10 years, including the return of the large fish and sharks. And those visionary fishermen are better off now. From diving tourism inside the reserve and better fishing around it.

Interviewer: So, there is obviously a strong argument for protecting our seas then.

Jordan: Yes, but today, globally, only seven percent of the ocean and around a fifth of our land has been protected. That means that we have converted most of our planet into a tame environment, where we and our farmed animals represent 96 percent of the mammals. Only four percent is everything else, from pandas to tigers to elephants. And we have removed over 90 percent of the large fish in the ocean in the last century alone.

Interviewer: Last summer saw some of the hottest temperatures in human history, in places that one would expect to be cool, like Canada, Finland and Siberia. I imagine this has played a role in the destruction of the natural environment.

Jordan: This extreme heat kills hundreds of thousands of people. If we are to prevent a global disaster, we need to do two things. As we know, we need to reduce emissions of greenhouse gases to almost zero. But we also need to decrease the excess carbon pollution in the atmosphere and in the ocean. We need nature's help. Because trees, grasslands, and healthy oceans are the best and most efficient technologies to remove carbon from the atmosphere, and they already exist. As long as we protect them, they do the removal for free.

Interviewer: So that's the solution. Surely, it can't be that simple.

Jordan: The problem is that nature cannot keep up with us. The biodiversity that is left today is not enough to absorb our impacts any longer. That's why I put together a team of top scientists and economists to answer the question of which areas in the ocean we must protect first. And how much of the ocean do we need to protect? We decided to focus on three objectives: biodiversity, food and carbon storage to help the fight against climate change. If we think of each objective in isolation, there are compromises. Protecting the top areas for biodiversity could result in a loss of fish to catch, for example. To solve that problem, we developed a new framework to optimize multiple benefits. Picking which areas to protect depends on how much we value the different objectives. We found that if we gave the same weight to biodiversity, food and carbon, we would need to protect the right 45 percent of the ocean to maximize the three benefits. We also found that even if we didn't value biodiversity, the minimum amount of ocean we would need to protect would be 30 percent.

Interviewer: But what about land?

Jordan: Similar analysis has been done for the land, also showing 30 percent as a minimum. Armed with this research, we launched a campaign for 30 by 30, meaning at least 30 percent of the planet, land and sea, protected by 2030. Getting governments to work together is essential. Working with the governments of Costa Rica, France and the United Kingdom, we built the High Ambition Coalition for Nature and People, which now has 66 countries, all supporting "30 by 30" as a main target for a global deal on nature.

Interviewer: Some will say, however, that we cannot afford to protect our natural world. What do you say to that?

Jordan: I understand that the idea of protecting a third of our land and ocean may feel threatening to those who see only the short-term profits of their destruction. But let's look at the numbers. A study has put the cost of protecting 30 percent of the planet at about 140 billion dollars a year. That's only a fraction of the money that governments use to subsidise industries that pollute our air, damage our land and empty our ocean. We need to reverse the flow of that money from funding the destruction of our life support system to preserving it.

Interviewer: Thank you, Jordan.

Adapted from:

Sala, E. Enric Sala: A bold plan to protect 30 percent of the Earth's surface and ocean floor. TED Talk.
https://www.ted.com/talks/enric_sala_a_bold_plan_to_protect_30_percent_of_the_earth_s_surface_and_ocean_floor

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

1.

The changes in marine life he observed from childhood to adulthood.

2.

Large scale exploitation of the sea for food

3.

requested a marine reserve and later benefited from it.

4.

Land animals' habitat has been better protected than that of sea animals.

5.

Their naturalness

6.

All three objectives are given the same priority everywhere.

7.

requires international cooperation.

8.

Optimistic and hopeful, focussing on solutions and positive outcomes for the planet.

II. Reading Comprehension (3 points)

HOW TO MAKE PIZZA LIKE A NEAPOLITAN MASTER

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. Each question is worth 0.5 points with a total of 3 points. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

1.

Naples's football team is mentioned in order to compare the passion families from Naples have to guard pizza recipes with the love Naples's citizens have for their football team.

2.

Soon the creation became a staple of the city's cuisine (line 22).

3.

Something that is not considered authentic/original/

An imitation / a bad copy

4.

The Association controls/ They control the ingredients that are put on the pizzas and how they must be cooked.

(among others)

5.

San Marzano tomatoes (which grow on the volcanic plains of Mount Vesuvius) and either fior di latte (made from cow's milk) or mozzarella di bufala (made from the milk of the water buffalo that live in the Campania and Lazio regions).

NB. Information between brackets is optional.

6.

Only an experienced cook / pizzaoiolo knows when a pizza is cooked to perfection / the cooking point of a pizza / when a pizza must be taken out of the oven to avoid it being burnt.

(among others)

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SÈRIE 3

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

SUBTITLING AS A FOREIGN-LANGUAGE LEARNING TOOL

Interviewer (I): Here we are with Margarita Pavlova, an audiovisual translator who works from English and German into Polish. Margarita managed to use subtitling to inspire interest in audiovisual translation among young students, while fostering motivation for language learning. Margarita, I know you held an audiovisual translation workshop a few years back with a bit of a difference. Tell us a bit more about it.

Margarita (M): Yes. It was part of a bigger educational and cultural project called 'School in Town'. The idea was to get schools to attend different workshops at universities, museums and all kinds of cultural places. We welcomed students from different schools to show them how it feels to be at university and what we do. The idea was also to get them interested in German as a foreign language.

I: German! How come?

M: In Poland, all students start by learning English as a first foreign language when they are rather young and later, they are required to learn another foreign language – German in most cases. There isn't the same level of motivation to learn German as to learn English or Polish. Students want to learn English, because they watch English shows, they listen to English music and watch English YouTubers. It's not that easy with German, so most students struggle with it. So, the idea of the workshop was also to show them that German can be fun as well.

I: I see, so what did you do to engage these students?

M: Well, I picked a German video that I thought would be manageable for them to subtitle. They were beginners, so the idea was for them to translate something without really knowing the language that well. First, we watched the video in German with no subtitles. Then I asked them questions about who they thought the good and the bad characters in this film were, the general atmosphere… This was something that shows how we deal with audiovisual translation. We just don't focus on the dialogues – we also need to focus on the music, on everything that is happening on the screen and in the background.

I: Given their low German level, wasn't that too **daunting** a task?

M: They were surprised to see that they were able to answer all the questions, so they were already feeling a bit more confident. After that, we started working on subtitles. I think the video was about 10 minutes long, and so I divided them into a couple of groups because their level of German was too low for individual work. Everyone was

working on one scene. The technical part was done to save time, they were typing the translation into the software so they could see it on ~~the~~ screen.

I: So the students didn't actually translate the text…

M: I provided them with German subtitles that I prepared. I tried to underline some of the phrases that they should look up as a unit, encouraging them not to go word-for-word, but to see the dialogues as ~~a~~ bigger units. For example, if they came across idiomatic phrases, then I underlined them so that they knew that they had to look them up as entire phrases, and then come up with Polish equivalents. This is what audiovisual translation is all about: not just translating each word, but an idea, so it is a little more complex.

I: What was the atmosphere in class like?

M: Oh, it was cool as there was an immediate result to what they were doing. What I didn't tell them was that I was going to add translator credits so that all of their names were listed on the final version. At the end of the workshop, I glued the translations done by different groups together, and we watched the clip one more time with their subtitles. They felt they could understand the entire film now because there were subtitles, and at the end, when they saw their names, they started cheering!

I: Cool! How do you think their attitude towards subtitling and learning German changed?

M: If I had asked them before the workshop if they were able to translate from German, they would have said "No way", and at the end it turned out that not only did they do it, but they also did a really good job. I don't think there is any disadvantage to using traditional materials at school, yet we have to understand that students like audiovisual materials – they are on TikTok all the time. They not only watch it, but they also create stuff. We can see the educational profits, and they can use it as a skill for whatever they want. It doesn't have to be audiovisual translation, but any kind of content that is interactive.

I: One last question. If each one of them went home and started a discussion with their parents after your workshop, what one thing that they learned about subtitling that day would you have liked them to discuss?

M: I would love for them to say two things. First, that they had fun subtitling and translating from German. This is something that parents would never ever have heard of in the context of German learning. And finally, that subtitling is not just translating words, but ideas. If they can explain this to their parents, then that would mean that the workshop was successful.

I: Thank you, Margarita, for talking about your experience, which we hope is inspiring to many others.

M: My pleasure.

Adapted from https://subcomm.co.uk/research/an-interview-with-kwiryna-proczkowska-subtitling-as-a-learning-tool/

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points (check the grid above). There is no penalty for unanswered questions].

1. To give students a taste of university life.
2. Polish students are not as exposed to German as they are to English.
3. By asking them to analyze the protagonists and the overall mood.
4. She placed them in teams to work on different scenes.
5. To emphasize the importance of context in translation.
6. They felt satisfied and excited.
7. They are familiar with this kind of content.
8. That subtitling involves translating concepts and that it is enjoyable.

II. Reading Comprehension (3 points)

GIVE YOURSELF A BREAK: WHY SMALL BUSINESS OWNERS NEED TO REGAIN A SENSE OF BALANCE

Answer the questions below **using complete sentences (i.e. not just subordinate clauses or phrases).** Each question is worth 0.5 points with a total of 3 points. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

1.

Balancing work and leisure time…can benefit our body and our mind and make our business more successful.

OR

Balancing work and leisure time…is not the norm, particularly in small businesses, where the owners often work extra hours or at weekends.

Recordeu que aquí han d'utilitzar les seves pròpies paraules però poden mantenir la paraula "business", si volen.

2.

There is a gap between intention and action because small business owners recognise the importance of frequent breaks in improving their work-life balance but many of them struggle to find room for downtime.

Recordeu que aquí poden copiar del text, si volen.

3.

The freedom and flexibility that starting a business might give you can be reduced if you try to do everything in the business, and then you might run out of time in the day and gas in the tank.

Recordeu que aquí poden copiar del text, si volen.

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Sèrie 1

Listening Comprehension

MICHAEL SMITH: A MICHELIN-STARRED CHEF FROM THE SCOTTISH HIGHLANDS

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

accolades: reconeixements/reconocimientos

larder: rebost/despensa

to go for a wander: passejar/pasear

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer: Michael Smith became head chef of The Three Chimneys restaurant achieving considerable critical acclaim. His style of gastronomy inspired by Scottish tradition and classical techniques has received many accolades. Among them, The Three Chimneys was named by New York Times food critic, Frank Bruni, as one of his top 5 destinations in the world. Michael earned a Michelin star in 2014 as Chef Director of The Three Chimneys. In early 2016, Michael opened his own restaurant, Loch Bay. Situated in Stein in the Waternish peninsula of Skye, the small restaurant is described as serving "contemporary Scottish food with classic French influences".

Dolores Hill is with us today to let us know a bit more about this renowned Scottish chef. She is a biographer and is currently working on a book about Smith.

How did you become interested in Michael Smith's life?

Dolores: I'd eaten at The Three Chimneys various times when he was head chef and I ate at Loch Bay just after it opened. All the meals were sumptuous and some of the dishes still stand out in my mind. As a writer I felt that I had to learn more about the person behind those dishes.

Interviewer: Can you start by telling us who he is, how he became a chef and about his early career?

Dolores: Sure. Smith defines himself as a 'simple Highland boy'. He's from Inverness, the capital of the Highlands, and it was there that he first started working in the kitchen of a local restaurant when he was 15. From then on, he quickly decided to pursue a career as a chef and this decision was reinforced in 1988 when he started working in the kitchens of Arisaig House on the west coast of Scotland, where he stayed for 3 years.

After that he moved to London. He spent 4 years as Senior Chef with Jeremy Lee at Blue Print Café. He then decided to move back to Scotland, working in and opening up some of Glasgow's best restaurants.

Interviewer: How did he end up on Skye?

Dolores: While he was working in Glasgow he had a chance meeting with Shirley Spear, who as you know was Chef at The Three Chimneys restaurant. Shirley asked him about the possibility of taking over from her in the kitchen. So, Smith and his wife Laurence went to Skye to check the island out. They loved it, they felt it was both a fantastic professional opportunity and lifestyle choice for their young family.

The adventure went well and he stayed at The Three Chimneys for 11 years. He continued to maintain and enhance the reputation of the Three Chimneys, creating and perfecting dishes that reflected the restaurant's surroundings, specifically utilising as much of the superb Skye and Scottish natural larder as possible.

Interviewer: What made him move on to set up his own restaurant?

Dolores: Since he first started to work in local restaurants at the age of 15 it had been his dream to have his own place and he accomplished that in early 2016 with Loch Bay. While he wanted to set up his own restaurant he also wanted to stay on Skye as he had been very happy there and his kids had grown up there. Smith, his wife and children love the Highlands of Scotland. They are never afraid to go for a wander to discover new places and meet people there.

Interviewer: For those who are yet to visit, how would you describe Smith's restaurant?

Dolores: The restaurant is small, welcoming and full of charm. They offer a 5-course seafood degustation and a set 3-course meal. It is contemporary Scottish cuisine, combining local, seasonal ingredients, perfect cooking and a beautiful but simple presentation. It is still a restaurant where locals go and they're very happy to have a Michelin-starred restaurant on their doorstep that also serves chips.

Interviewer: It's a fantastic achievement to get a Michelin star after only 18 months of opening. What was Smith's reaction?

Dolores: In one of my interviews for the book, Smith told me that the Michelin star is just a very happy by-product of creating great food, from fantastic local produce in a beautiful environment. For a small restaurant, it is an important achievement.

Interviewer: Does Smith enjoy his daily routine as a chef?

Dolores: I guess so! He has been at the stoves every day since the restaurant has been open. They have only just hired someone to help in the kitchen lately. Smith says that being a chef is a very rewarding profession. He likes the camaraderie, the excitement of service, and being able to be creative. He thinks that a restaurant is an organic living entity, so there are lots of moving parts and a chef and his team are only

as good as their last service. If he has time, he likes to take a moment during service to hear the sound of a lively and happy restaurant.

Interviewer: We will need to go to Smith's restaurant to get a real slice of traditional Scottish food!

Dolores: Yes! Do let me know when you're going! I would love to join you!

Adapted from:

Away from the Ordinary (May 25, 2018). Interview with a Michelin starred chef: Michael Smith. https://awayfromtheordinary.com/2018/05/25/interview-michelin-starred-chef-michael-smith-skye/

MyCityLifeTV (August 3, 2011). Chef Michael Smith. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZPcy04GQSLI

Listening Comprehension

Clau de respostes

1. The Three Witches.
2. In his hometown.
3. Yes, he spent four years in London.
4. Shirley Spear offered Smith the opportunity to work at The Three Chimneys.
5. Eleven years.
6. Yes, because he was happy with his life on the isle.
7. She thinks it is appreciated by local people.
8. He likes to do the cooking and sees a Michelin star as the result of combining good products and a lively atmosphere.

Reading Comprehension

Clau de respostes

1. involve helping mothers with childcare.
2. can be used to understand better how our ancestors lived in the Stone Age.
3. some Mbendjele communities have stopped being nomadic.
4. several caregivers would quickly take care of babies when they cried.
5. does not involve spending a lot of time with babies.
6. is often used to ensure that parents can work.
7. has positive effects both on mothers and children.
8. Parents have had more support and less pressure for childcare in modern times than in any other historical period.

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SÈRIE 5

Listening Comprehension

K-POP, MORE THAN JUST A MUSIC STYLE

Interviewer: South Korea is known for its festivals, some of which have been celebrated since the 16th century. Due to its rich history, there are also many traditional buildings, such as Buddhist temples and huge palaces. But among young people, South Korea is famous for K-pop. Early in the pandemic, sociologist Chris Resa began watching K-pop videos, largely for fun. Now she's exploring the societal impact of the popular genre. Good morning, Chris.

Chris: Good morning. A pleasure to be here.

Interviewer: Well Chris, K-pop stands for Korean Pop but now it belongs to the whole world as it has transformed into a global cultural phenomenon. Is it true?

Chris: I couldn't agree more. During the 1990s, it was a musical subculture popular in South Korea but K-pop now frequently tops the **billboard charts**, attracts fiercely dedicated online followers, and generates billions of dollars. Its best-known artists, the boy band BTS, were nominated in three different categories at the Grammy Awards last year, and they are the most-listened-to group in Spotify history.

Interviewer: UCLA professor Yao Kim, who has also written about the K-pop phenomenon, said, "It's way more than music. It is a total entertainment that incorporates choreography, fashion and lifestyle." Do you agree?

Chris: Sure. We used to have very prominent boy bands and girl groups, such as New Kids on the Block, Spice Girls or One Direction. I think K-pop really hits kind of a **vacuum** that Western pop cultural trends left behind.

Interviewer: Chris, as a Professor of Sociology and Professor of ethnicity, race, and migration in Yale's Faculty of Arts and Sciences, you have done research on why the genre's rise has been important to so many Asian Americans. You have said that watching a TV programme on Saturday Night Live changed your view of K-pop. How did that performance turn your personal interest in K-pop into an academic one?

Chris: I saw that performance, and it stayed in the back of my mind. Then, when we were on lockdown because of COVID, being stuck at home set the stage for having time to watch more K-pop videos. At first, I was just watching them for fun. I knew K-pop was something important, but I didn't know anything about it. I thought "I should educate myself on this." I've always been interested in race and ethnicity and Asian Americans. I knew that K-pop was important, so I started investigating the phenomenon.

Interviewer: What kind of research are you doing?

Chris: My colleagues and I, we are studying the link between 80s synth-pop and current K-pop. Others have argued that K-pop borrows heavily from American Black music. And it's true, but we're arguing that K-pop has links to many different genres (black music, synth pop, hip hop, new wave synth, even reggae). In another project, with two data scientists, we're looking at Twitter data related to a tweet that BTS posted in 2021, about a week after a gunman in Atlanta murdered eight women, including six of Asian descent. K-pop fans are really well organized, and they may be ready to take political action. K-pop is extremely influential. So, we're looking at how the conversation about the shootings before and after they tweeted changed.

Interviewer: Why do you think K-pop is so influential? I mean, yeah, they are really popular in Korea but what about the States, for example? Do you think that K-pop may have a role in American society?

Chris: Sure! Think about this. BTS performed on Saturday Night Live, NBC's Emmy-winning late-night comedy showcase. Especially people my age in their mid-thirties, we had never seen a bunch of East Asian people on the stage singing in a non-English, non-Western language. I knew that was an important moment regardless of whether or not you like the music or the performance. Asians were visible! BTS made Asian faces more visible. They were on the cover of Time magazine, every major publication. They were everywhere. But it also brought up questions of xenophobia. People were making fun of them because of how they looked. At the time, there was also the extra baggage that comes with being Asian. But any time BTS were attacked, because their fandom is so big and so passionate, their fans would jump on anyone who did anything to them. Then journalists would cover it, and suddenly there were all these stories about how you shouldn't be racist against Asians.

Interviewer: Are you saying that BTS fans could stop xenophobia?

Chris: Well, many of us who study Asian Americans have observed over time that it often seems acceptable for people to make fun of Asian things. Now, BTS fans are protecting them, and that that gets elevated to the news is a big deal. President Biden invited them to the White House. These are all things I would have had trouble imagining even just five years ago.

Interviewer: I have heard that many fans would like to become K-pop idols themselves. But that's not easy at all.

Chris: Right. Many go for an audition. If you're chosen, you'll spend up to ten years in South Korea's K-pop training centres, operated by the entertainment companies. It's kind of like a boot camp. You go to your acting class, you go to your singing class, you go to your dance class. Your appearance will also be managed: you get camera tested on every angle, hair and makeup. They change up different hairstyles, different colours.

Interviewer: Is there a dark side to it?

Chris: When there's a good side, there's always going to be a bad side. It was a pressure of success. While the training camps may sound intense to Americans, that

kind of competitive pressure **pervades** Korean culture. I'm not sure that it's unique to K-pop. It's a societal thing in Korea. There is a lot of pressure on doing well in school. They're all up until whatever time at night, like, studying, doing the work. There is this idea of wanting to do your best, and not disappointing others.

Interviewer: I see…but if K-pop idols are often put on extremely strict diets, strenuous training schedules, and are heavily scrutinized, ... no one, no adults criticize this situation?

Chris: Well, in fact, last year **a bill was passed** amidst rising concerns from the public about the health and safety of minors in the highly demanding Korean entertainment industry, as companies continue to debut K-pop idols at younger ages. It is a bill to protect underage K-pop idols from exploitation and it is meant to reinforce financial transparency. Previously, entertainers under the age of 15 could work up to 35 hours a week, while those older than 15 were allowed 40 hours a week. Now, entertainers under the age of 12 can only work a maximum of 25 hours a week, up to 6 hours a day. Those aged 12 to 15 are allowed 30 hours a week, while those above the age of 15 can work 35 hours a week, both of these age groups are limited to 7 hours a day. What is more, the law also prohibits any **infringement** of underage entertainers' rights to education by forcing them to be absent from or drop out of school. So, K-pop teenagers must attend school.

Interviewer: I see that things are changing for the better. Well, Chris, we do not have time for more. Thanks for your interesting insights into K-pop.

Chris: Thank you.

Adapted from:

The rise of K-pop, and what it reveals about society and culture, Yale News, Caroline Huber (August 21, 2023) https://news.yale.edu/2023/08/21/rise-k-pop-and-what-it-reveals-about-society-and-culture

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions].

Clau de respostes

1. Its fans prefer K-pop concerts to online music.
2. K-pop substitutes boy and girl bands.
3. After watching some K-pop videos for entertainment.
4. All statements are correct.
5. K-pop draws attention to Asian people.
6. Asian artists are popular enough to appear in the news.
7. work extremely hard and under a lot of pressure, which is something accepted in Korean culture.
8. The maximum amount they can legally earn.

Reading Comprehension

Clau de respostes

1. The environmental cost of the clothes.
2. because of its high consumption of water.
3. has changed the way we buy and use clothes.
4. a large amount of.
5. Most water pollution all over the world comes from the textile industry.
6. people wore their clothes many more times than they do now.
7. to end the negative social and environmental effects of the fashion industry.
8. it is very difficult to solve the environmental problem associated with fashion.

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Sèrie 3

Listening Comprehension

MAKING MUSIC AFTER BRAIN SURGERY

Interviewer: This is Fresh Air. I'm Tom Mosley. This past summer electronic music producer and DJ Jennifer Lee, better known as Tokimonsta, released one of her latest collaborations. Tokimonsta came into her own story through a near-death experience. In 2016, she was diagnosed with a rare brain disease that required two surgeries, leaving her temporarily unable to understand sound or speak. This was devastating for Tokimonsta, who had, before this diagnosis, become a well-known and respected artist in the electronic music world, having released six albums and numerous collaborations.

But she made up for lost time. Just two months after her recovery from brain surgery, Tokimonsta pushed herself to make music again, creating one of her most personal albums, "Lune Rouge," which **garnered** a 2019 Grammy nomination for best dance electronic album, making Tokimonsta the first female Asian American producer to receive a nomination in this category. Tokimonsta creates music with electronic tools as well as a piano, field recordings and vocals. And in live performances, it's like watching a DJ on steroids with Tokimonsta creating sounds and melodies with synthesizers, sequencers and drum machines. Tokimonsta, welcome to Fresh Air.

Tokimonsta: Hi. Thanks for having me.

Interviewer: You have to tell us the origins, Jennifer, of the name Tokimonsta.

Tokimonsta: OK. So the origin - in short, it was a chat screen name. We all had one back in the day. So tokki means rabbit in Korean. And monsta was a way - I guess I thought it was a cool way to write monster when I was 16. But I can't take it back 'cause this has been my name now for many years.

Interviewer: Would you change it if you could?

Tokimonsta: I mean, there are moments where I feel like when people see my name, it doesn't fit the kind of music I make. You know, in the very beginning, maybe when you see Tokimonsta, you assume that I make really aggressive music. And I think I've been around long enough, and people know that, oh, Tokimonsta makes, like, cool, chill, fun stuff that I've redefined what it means to be Tokimonsta. And in many ways, that name represents me because of the juxtaposition of tokki, which is cute, and then monsta, which is this scary being. And that shows very much in the music that I make. There are moments where my music is very quiet, and then I have moments where my music is loud or beautiful and disturbing or light or heavy. And now, more than ever, I do feel like I identify with my name, and I'm proud to have it be a part of my life.

Interviewer: You know, Jennifer, one of the things about electronic music that's fascinating to me is you need to be a musician who understands music in the traditional sense, but you also need to understand technology. What was your first exposure to that part of it, so the actual components of making music with electronic devices?

Tokimonsta: My first dive into being creative with music would probably be the piano. I think when I downloaded software in high school, that was the first attempt at trying to make electronic music. I downloaded a program. I opened it. It looked so intimidating that I just uninstalled it 'cause at that time, computers didn't have a lot of space, so it had to go. And I **put that on ice** for a bit 'cause I felt that urge and that want in me to create, and that was going to be the easiest way to create something very complete through my computer. But I put it to rest. And then fast-forward to my first year in college, I downloaded some different production software. A friend of mine showed me very, very basic - like, a very basic way to use it, and I became obsessed. You know, I went on, I was watching YouTube tutorials, I was going on the website, reading their tutorials, which made me think, whoever reads the actual manual from any kind of software, you know?

Interviewer: Yeah.

Tokimonsta: But it just became something that became my whole world, my whole focus. It was the hobby of all hobbies. I finally figured out a way to express all these ideas that I had **swirling** inside me.

Interviewer: Can you describe, for those who aren't familiar with electronic music, the tools that you love the most to create your sound?

Tokimonsta: So for me, as an electronic artist, I mostly work within my computer. I like the efficiency of working on a computer, but it's really important for me to also work with synthesizers. I also use a piano heavily in my music, I think, to touch back on my own roots in classical music.

Interviewer: A big part of your sound is also the integration of other sounds in addition to those melodies. You actually carry a recorder with you, and the sounds that you record when you're out in the world - just about everything - car doors slamming, the sounds of birds chirping, wind blowing - and you integrate that in your music.

Tokimonsta: Yes. I feel like there's something about field recordings, which is what we call this, that gives your music a specific sonic signature that no one else will have. Because if I record the waves crashing or an airplane flying overhead, that particular moment will only happen once in time. You'll never be able to recreate that same wave or that same airplane or that same car door shutting. And in that way, that song that I use it on will also remain completely unique.

Interviewer: And delving a little bit deeper into how your experience with brain surgeries impacted you, how has recovering affected your music afterwards?

Tokimonsta: I would say from a technical or scientific or medical standpoint, nothing really changed. I listen to music to the same degree as before. I feel like a lot of people want to think I became superhuman. Like, I have incredible hearing now...but not really. The bridge between your thinking mind and the music was broken down during my surgery. And now I'm able to access that part of my brain that was held away during that recovery process. So in that way, nothing has changed very much. I'm just glad I can hear and appreciate music to the same degree. But I guess philosophically, everything has changed because now I know how precious music is. It's like being starved and having your first bite to eat. Every song has a level of excitement to me that is precious and more precious because I know that it can be taken away.

Interviewer: Jennifer Lee, thank you so much for this conversation.

Tokimonsta: Absolutely. Thanks for having me.

Adapted from:

"Brain Surgery left Tokimonsta unable to understand music. Now every song is precious", NPR, October 2, 2023

Listening Comprehension

Clau de respostes

1. had a turning point in her career.
2. Briefly after she got over her operation.
3. It was a chat name she picked when she was 16.
4. No, because it represents the music that she makes.
5. She learned it through a friend who taught her the basics of a software and video tutorials.
6. She mainly uses her computer.
7. Because the sounds give her music a unique character.
8. She values music to a greater extent.

Reading Comprehension

Clau de respostes

1. is a US government-led project to reduce cancer death rates.
2. can help improve cancer treatments.
3. reaching all kinds of patients and empowering them to make decisions.
4. not everyone has had access to proper diagnosis to the same extent.
5. AI cannot be trained with large patient datasets.
6. Because they can predict how tumors might develop.
7. By ensuring patients receive more information.
8. make patients commit to treatment.

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Sèrie 1

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

The Rise of Pregnant Stand-Up

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

stand-up – monòleg – monólogo

pregnant – embarassada - embarazada

stretch mark - estria – estría

booker – agent - agente

lactation – lactància - lactancia

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

I**nterviewer**: Men have dominated stand-up comedy for a long time. But as women have come to the stage more often, one kind of performance has been hard not to notice: pregnant comedians popping up on high-profile comedy specials, late-night shows, and in clubs. Udane Castle, a pregnant comedian based in Boston, is with us today to talk about this phenomenon. Hi, Udane! Let's start from the beginning: what is it like to be a stand-up comedian?

Udane: Good evening! I am thrilled to be here. Being a comedian is the most fun and depressing lifestyle that I could possibly imagine.

I get to perform in front of hundreds of people and work with some of the funniest people in the world. It's the biggest rush that I've ever felt, and at times it is totally crazy to think about what I do and who I do it with.

But comedy also isolates you from a lot of people. You spend all day looking at the world to find out what's funny or weird about it rather than just living in the moment and enjoying social experiences. A couple of years ago, for example, I stopped going to clubs or bars with my friends, because all I could think about was how silly it was that everyone considered going out like that to be the highlight of their week.

Interviewer: What about when you're on stage? What does it feel like?

Udane: Everything has to be perfect. Your tone, your rhythm, your cadence, and especially your timing. You have to be charming and charismatic even though you don't know any of the people in front of you. You have to connect with that room full of

strangers. All while those spotlights are cooking you. You have no idea how much they make you sweat.

Interviewer: You are pregnant now. Do you use your pregnancy as a topic for your stand-ups?

Udane: I do! In comedy, pregnancy is no longer seen as something that gets in the way of the act and the microphone stand. In fact, a baby on the way is now a rich source of stand-up material: stretch marks, placentas and all!

Interviewer: Tell us about your models—the people you look up to. Where have you found inspiration so far?

Udane: I love Ali Wong's monologues—she has done two Netflix specials while pregnant. She is hilarious when she talks about lactation consultants and diapers. I also really like Kara Klenk, a stand-up comedian in Los Angeles.

Interviewer: Is this something new? What was it like before?

Udane: It is. Let me tell you just a couple of examples. When Joan Rivers, who is considered a pioneer of women in comedy by many critics, appeared on "The Ed Sullivan Show" in 1967 she was carrying her daughter, Melissa. She was not allowed to say she was pregnant and was asked to wear a really uncomfortable dress to hide it. Also, just four years ago, Ophira Eisenberg, a comedian and the host of the comedy show "Ask Me Another", said that some bookers had warned her that she might alienate her audience by talking about her pregnancy on stage.

Interviewer: What do you think has changed?

Udane: There is no comprehensive account of women in comedy, but comedians, club owners and bookers say there are more of them working today, even though they remain vastly outnumbered by men. And with women starting families later than they used to, female comics are now more likely to have established careers by the time they start having babies.

Interviewer: For women who have difficult pregnancies, I guess the travel often required for stand-up can be a real challenge. Do you know of any bad experiences so far?

Udane: Sadly, I do. Amy Schumer, a well-known comedian from New York, announced that she had to cancel the remainder of her tour last February. She had a pregnancy complication and was no longer allowed to fly. She wanted to push through and do her shows, but she had to prioritize her health and the baby's.

Interviewer: Do you think this tendency will last?

Udane: I am not sure. As fun as it can be to play with expectations about maternal behavior and delicate pregnant ladies, many comics, including myself, look forward to the day that an expectant mom on stage is not unusual at all.

Adapted from the following sources:

"Amy Schumer, Ali Wong and the Rise of Pregnant Stand-Up", *The New York Times*, April 19, 2019. https://www.nytimes.com/2019/04/19/arts/pregnant-comedians-amy-schumer-ali-wong.html

"What does it feel like to be a stand-up comedian?", *Quora*, https://www.quora.com/What-does-it-feel-like-to-be-a-stand-up-comedian

Clau de respostes

1. How does Udane feel about being a comedian?

   She can tell it has both advantages and disadvantages.

2. Why does Udane not go to clubs or bars anymore?

   Because she thinks there are more meaningful ways to pass the time.

3. What is Udane's problem with the lights on stage?

   They make her feel too hot.

4. Which of the following is **NOT** true about Udane?

   She lives in Los Angeles, like Kara Klenk.

5. What happened to Joan Rivers in 1967?

   She was asked to keep her pregnancy a secret.

6. According to Udane, female comics

   are more frequent today than they used to be.

7. Which of the following best summarizes Amy Schumer's experience?

   She had to cancel some shows because of a medical condition.

8. What does Udane think about using pregnancy on stage?

   She hopes that people will normalize the image of a pregnant woman on stage.

III. Reading comprehension

1. In this text, the word **immersion** (and **immersive**) refers to

   leisure experiences where people can interact with series or movies scenes.

2. In the second paragraph, the author of the text

   wonders why immersion experiences are popular now.

3. Netflix

   has incorporated new ways of making profits.

4. Which of the following is NOT TRUE about the Stranger Things experience?

   Only the show's actors take part in it.

5. The Queen's Ball

   attracts female Bridgerton fans of several ages.

6. Elizabeth Cohen thinks that

   the fans' contact with the fictional world has become normal.

7. Why does there seem to be a double standard for pop culture?

   Because immersion tends to be criticised more often than sports fandom.

8. Immersion experiences

   give people the chance to escape from real difficulties.

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Sèrie 5

I. Listening comprehension (3 points)

Chocolate and Valentine's Day: A Sweet Story

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

whip fuetejar /azotar

elxir elixir/elixir

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer: Welcome to our weekly chat about holiday celebrations around the world. Today's guest is going to tell us about our sweetest holiday celebration, Valentine's Day. Today we know that a heart-shaped box of chocolates is a symbol, and an important part, of Valentine's Day, but how did that tradition arise? We know that chocolate is not native to Britain, or even to the United States. To find out more about Valentine's Day and chocolate, we've invited Dr. Anne Ward, a professor at King's College London, to give us some background about this sweet connection.

Welcome, Anne, to the program.

Anne: Thank you, I'm glad to be here.

Interviewer: Has chocolate always been a part of Valentine's Day? How did we get to celebrate Valentine's Day in the first place?

Anne: Chocolate is relatively new to Valentine's Day. The roots of Valentine's Day are ancient, but not entirely clear. It probably originated with the Romans and a fertility festival they held. But the Romans did not exchange candy, they sacrificed goats and dogs and **whipped** people, among other things. Eventually, hundreds of years later, this festival became a Christian feast associated with a martyred saint, Valentine. The Roman Emperor Claudius had had Valentine executed on February 14th in the third century A.D.

Interviewer: And how did this martyred saint become associated with love?

Anne: We don't know exactly, but we do know that in *Canterbury Tales*, Chaucer talks about St. Valentine's Day as a day in which birds gather together to choose their mates. That means that by the 14th century, there was a strong link between love, mating, and St. Valentine's Day.

Interviewer: So when does chocolate come into the picture?

Anne: Obviously, Chaucer didn't talk about chocolate. Chocolate was first introduced into Europe by the Spanish, who had seen people drink it in Mexico. Chocolate as a drink became very popular in Spain, and from there it traveled to other parts of Europe. It became very popular in France. And people at the time thought that chocolate was a sexual stimulant. Giacomo Casanova, the famous Italian adventurer and womanizer from Venice, called chocolate the "**elixir** of love."

Interviewer: Was chocolate always served as a drink?

Anne: Yes, until the mid-19th century, chocolate was always consumed as a drink. They didn't eat chocolate cake. Chocolate was very popular with Europe's kings. For example, documents from the 17th century show us that British King Charles II spent 30 times more money on chocolate than on tea. He certainly spent more money on chocolate than on his servants. For most people of that time, though, chocolate was a very extravagant, exotic product. Most never tasted it.

Interviewer: So when did we start eating chocolate bars? Today, we tend to think of chocolate as something that is eaten as a solid, not drunk as a liquid.

Anne: In the mid 19th century, specifically in 1847, the British chocolate maker J.S. Fry & Sons produced the first modern-day candy bar. The company combined cacao powder and sugar with cacao butter, the fat that is extracted from cacao beans, to form a paste that they could shape into bars. A few years later, they started making individual chocolates filled with flavored creams.

Interviewer: So was it this company, J.S. Fry & Sons, that linked chocolate to St. Valentine's Day?

Anne: No, chocolate didn't become an important part of St. Valentine's Day celebrations until a rival chocolate company, Cadbury, decided to start selling fancy boxes of chocolates. Cadbury knew that extreme ornamentation was very popular in Victorian England, so he came up with the idea of selling chocolate in boxes with heavily decorated lids and lace inside. And soon after that, Cadbury created boxes in the shape of a heart. Once the chocolates had been eaten, people would save the pretty boxes and use them to keep special mementos.

Interviewer: I see, you might say that we eat chocolate on St. Valentine's Day because it was a successful business strategy.

Anne: Yes, Cadbury's idea was a huge success. This year in the United States alone, companies will sell more than 40 million heart-shaped boxes of chocolate, many of them decorated with roses and lace. Surveys show that 70% of Americans prefer receiving chocolate as opposed to flowers as a Valentine's Day gift.

Interviewer: And is chocolate really an aphrodisiac? You mentioned that Casanova thought it was.

Anne: Despite what Casanova and others have said, modern science has found little evidence to support chocolate as an aphrodisiac.

Interviewer: That's all we have time for today, Anne. Thank you for joining us today.

Anne: My pleasure.

Clau de respostes

1. Where and when did St. Valentine's Day celebrations originate?

With the Romans before Christ.

2. Which of the following best describes who Valentine was?

A martyr who was executed in ancient Rome.

3. Who first introduced chocolate to Europe?

The Spanish.

4. What did Europeans use to think chocolate was good for?

They thought it was an aid in sexual activity.

5. Which of the following is TRUE?

In the 18th century, a very few rich Europeans drank chocolate.

6. When did chocolate candy bars first appear?

In the middle of the 19th century, in Britain.

7. Which of the following occurred first?

J.S. Fry made individual, cream-filled chocolates.

8. What differentiated Cadbury's chocolates from those made by others?

They were sold in heart-shaped boxes that could be kept.

II. Reading comprehension

1. At the COP21 summit, countries

agreed to limit the increase in global temperatures to 2C.

2. The most ambitious target at the Paris climate summit…

was considered too difficult to reach by a number of countries.

3. The 1.5C mark…

represents a major difference with respect to the 2C target.

4. What prediction has the IPCC made?

Heat waves will become more frequent in the future.

5. Which of the following is TRUE?

If ice sheets in Antarctica become destabilized, sea levels will rise.

6. The number of people living in areas of extreme heat stress…

doesn't reach a hundred million today.

7. What are the IPCC estimates for the remainder of the 21st century?

Temperatures might start declining after 2050 if action is taken.

8. What does the IPCC predict will happen If no climate action is taken now?

Temperatures might rise by more than 4C by the end of the century.

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Sèrie 2

Listening Comprehension (3 points)

Juanita. The Inca mummy

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

Mummy: mòmia, momia

Attire: indumentària, atuendo

Bundle: paquet, paquete

Burial site: lloc d'enterrament, lugar del entierro

Appease: Apaivagar, apaciguar

Coca leaves: fulles de coca, hojas de coca

Docile: dòcil, dócil

Blow: cop, golpe

Kneel: agenollar-se, arrodillarse

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

INTERVIEWER: Popularly known as Mummy Juanita, the finding of a young Inca girl sacrificed more than 600 years ago made headlines. Dr Chris Van Gils, a specialist in the Inca Culture, is with us today to tell us more about this famous mummy. Good morning, Dr Van Gils. First of all, why is this discovery so significant?

CHRIS: Well, analysing her internal organs, hair, skin, and blood provided scientists a glimpse into the cultural and societal practices of the Incas of the time. It is not the mummy itself, but what we can learn from it.

INTERVIEWER: I see. But let's start by the beginning. Who was Juanita?

CHRIS: Juanita was a young girl. She was probably between 12 to 14 years old. She seemed to be in excellent health. Biopsies of bone, muscle and other tissues confirmed that the girl had enjoyed good nutrition and had healthy, mature

bones. The mummy was found wearing clothes resembling those of Cusco's elite, of the nobility. Specialists in textiles were especially impressed with the fine alpaca wool of the girl's garments. She wore a boldly striped dress, encircled by a belt, and her shawl was fastened with a silver pin. Her attire was similar to that of the female statuettes buried with her.

INTERVIEWER: Are you suggesting that Juanita was no ordinary girl?

CHRIS: Probably not. Her attire, along with the geographical location of the sacrifice, suggests to archaeologists that the young girl was part of Cusco's nobility. Furthermore, by analysing her hair, scientists were able to determine that she ate maize and animal meat prior to the sacrifice, both of which were part of the diet of the elite.

INTERVIEWER: Interesting. Tell us a bit about the discovery. She was found near Arequipa in Peru, right?

CHRIS: Exactly. In September 1995, American anthropologist Johan Reinhard climbed the volcano Mount Ampato in Arequipa located at about 6,300 meters above sea level. He, along with his Peruvian climbing partner Miguel Zárate, came across a bundle inside a crater, most likely fallen from an Inca burial site at the summit. The two men took the frozen bundle to the Catholic University of Santa Maria in Arequipa. It weighed about 40 kilos and included the mummy and numerous burial items including pottery, shells, and small llama figures. The body of the sacrificed girl was given the name Juanita, and is also known as the Lady of Ampato and the Inca Ice Maiden.

INTERVIEWER: So, after her death, sometime between 1450 and 1480, Juanita would sit alone in the mountains until she was uncovered by these two men.

CHRIS: That's it. The thin, cold air near the summit of Mt. Ampato left the mummy incredibly intact. Reinhard once said in an interview that the doctors had been shaking their heads and saying Juanita sure doesn't look 500 years old but could have died a few weeks ago.

INTERVIEWER: Amazing. But the fact that it was discovered is also surprising.

CHRIS: If it weren't for volcanic activity, it's possible that the mummified young girl would have continued to sit in on the frozen mountain top for centuries to come. But because of the volcanic activity warming the snow, Mt. Ampato's snow-cap began to melt, pushing the wrapped mummy and her burial site down the mountain.

INTERVIEWER: And was this the only mummy found in the area?

CHRIS: No. In fact, Reinhard returned to the mountain a month later and found two more mummified children, this time a boy and girl. It is believed these may

have been companion sacrifices to the more important sacrifice of Juanita. This is corroborated by a Spanish soldier who witnessed similar sacrifices in 1551 and wrote about them.

INTERVIEWER: OK. So, tell us about these sacrifices.

CHRIS: These sacrifices among the Inca that involved the deaths of children were known as Capacocha. Capacocha can be translated as "royal obligation" and it was the Inca's attempt at ensuring that the best and healthiest among them were sacrificed to appease the gods, often as a way to stop a natural disaster like an earthquake, or simply to ensure a healthy harvest. This sacrificial rite was also performed to celebrate events such as battle victories, or the death or birth of Inca royalty. Considering that Juanita's body was discovered atop Ampato, a volcano in the Andes, her sacrifice very likely played into the Inca's Mountain worship.

INTERVIEWER: What did scientists discover about her death? How did she die?

CHRIS: Well, you can imagine a girl with long black hair and a graceful neck, dressed in fine alpaca wool, knelt on a cold, windswept summit in the Andes. She was in the presence of Inca priests and surrounded by offerings of pottery, coca leaves and golden figurines.

INTERVIEWER: I visualize one of the sacrifices we have watched in an Indiana Jones' movie.

CHRIS: Sort of. In fact, experts say that Juanita was probably docile.

INTERVIWER: Did she want to die? Did she not fight?

CHRIS: Juanita's days leading up to her death were very different than the lifestyle of a typical Inca girl. Scientists know what she ate before she died. Markers in her hair indicate that she was selected for sacrifice about a year before her actual death. She had switched from a standard Inca diet of potatoes and vegetables to the more elite foods of animal protein and maize, along with large quantities of coca and alcohol. The final six to eight weeks of life for Inca child sacrifices was one of a very intoxicated psychological state altered by the chemical reaction of coca and alcohol. Archaeologists believe that when she died, she was likely in a very relaxed state.

INTERVIEWER: In other words, she was drugged before she died.

CHRIS: That's right. Radiologist Elliot Fishman discovered that Juanita's death was brought about by a massive haemorrhage from a blow to the head. Her injuries were "typical of someone who has been hit by a baseball bat." After the death blow, her skull swelled with blood, pushing her brain to the side. Dr Fishman said the girl probably never regained consciousness, but might have

lived several hours before dying. Observations of the position of the feet indicate that the girl was probably kneeling when struck, he said, and the posture suggested that her head was bent forward at the time.

INTERVIEWER: One last question, Dr Van Gils. Was this ritual frequent? Juanita wasn't the only child sacrificed, was she?

CHRIS: All in all, experts estimate that there may be hundreds of Inca children mummified in the mountain peaks of the Andes still waiting to be discovered.

INTERVIEWER: Dr Van Gils, thank you for joining us today.

Adapted from https://allthatsinteresting.com/mummy-juanita-lady-of-ampato , https://www.pbs.org/wgbh/nova/article/ice-mummies-inca/ ,https://www.nytimes.com/1996/05/22/us/mummy-tells-story-of-a-sacrifice-scientists-say.html.

1.- Which of the following sentences best describes Juanita?

She was a rich, healthy girl who belonged to the Cuzco elite.

2.- What did scientists study and analyse to find out what Juanita ate prior to her sacrifice?

Her hair

3.- What did the American anthropologist and his partner NOT find inside the parcel together with the mummy?

Volcano ash

4.- Why did doctors say that Juanita could have died a few weeks ago and not 500 years ago?

The mummy was flawless because of the weather conditions at the top of the mountain.

5.- Which of the following statements is true?

The snow melted because of a volcanic eruption and pushed the bundle into the crater where it was found.

6.- Which of these statements is false about Capacocha?

Capacocha was a sacrificial rite that took place near a lake.

7.- When Juanita died,

she had been prepared with coca and alcohol for 6 or 8 weeks.

8.- How did Juanita die?

She had a brain haemorrhage caused by a head injury.

Reading comprehension

1. Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE?

Mesoamerican civilizations owe ball games to Columbus.

2. The rules of a sport that involved a heavy rubber ball

varied across Mesoamerican cultures.

3. Which of the following statements is TRUE?

Aztec players used hard, heavy balls that could even kill them.

4. The ball game was sacred to Mesoamerican cultures and

sometimes replaced battles and helped resolve conflicts.

5. 19th century British schools

are responsible for modern football or soccer.

6. By 1870

some working-class football players were paid.

7. The popularity of football as a sport

resulted in its internationalization.

8. Although professional football has flourished since the early 20th century

the essence of the sport is in the fact that it can be played by anyone.

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Sèrie 2

Comprensió d'un text oral

America's Best Known Architect

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

windbag: persona que pontifica

grace: honorar/honrar

flock: congregar

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Interviewer: Welcome to our weekly program about famous Americans. Tonight, we go after the story of one of the most extraordinary men of our time. He is Frank Lloyd Wright, perhaps the greatest architect of the twentieth century and certainly the most famous American architect ever. And in the opinion of some, America's foremost social rebel. So, let's talk to Mr. Roger Wolf, Frank Lloyd Wright's biographer. Mr Wolf, how would you define him?

Mr Wolf: Well, I'm not the most appropriate person to define him. According to a story in *Life Magazine* not many years back, fellow architects have called him everything, from a great poet to an insufferable windbag. The clergy has deplored his morals, creditors have deplored his financial habits, politicians, his opinions. Admirers of Frank Lloyd Wright consider him as a man one hundred years ahead of his time. I'm an admirer.

Interviewer: One of his most famous statements was "If I had another fifteen years to work, I could rebuild this entire country, I could change the nation." Now, would you tell me why should he, one man, want to change the way of life of millions and millions of people?

Mr Wolf: Well, he thought the way of life in which the country... to which the country is committed needs change.

Interviewer: But don't you think these words show his ego, his self-centeredness? You're saying that practically everyone in the United States is out of step except Frank Lloyd Wright.

Mr Wolf: Not at all, I'm not saying anything of the kind. It isn't their job to build, it was his. He thought people should have a right to look to their architects for suggestions for what they should build.

Interviewer: Well, as an architect...

Mr Wolf: ...and how they should build it.

Interviewer: As an architect, how would he have liked to change the way that we live?

Mr Wolf: He wouldn't have liked to change so much the way we live, as what we live in, and how we live in it. Wright always said that we ourselves are changing in the buildings we live in. Most people don't really understand what it is to live in an organic building with organic character.

Interviewer: Well now, organic building, organic character, these are words which are difficult to understand.

Mr Wolf: Well, let's say natural, would that suit you better? For Wright, a truly organic building developed from within outwards and was thus in harmony with its time, place, and inhabitants.

Interviewer: I'm still not... I would like specifically, to know what you mean, how would he like to change the way that we live?

Mr Wolf: He meant he'd have liked to have a free architecture, an architecture that belonged where you see it standing, architecture that graced the landscape instead of being a disgrace in the landscape. His clients told him how those buildings he had built for them had changed the character of their whole lives and their whole existence. And it's different now than it was before. Well, he'd have liked to do that for the whole country.

Interviewer: But, imagine New York. When he came to New York, and he saw the skyline of New York, didn't it excite him? After all, he did design the Guggenheim Museum in New York. Most of us think that New York is so spectacular and imposing.

Mr Wolf: In fact, it didn't impress him at all. Because it never was planned, it was all the result of a race for rent, and it is a great monument, he thought, to the power of money and to greed. It wasn't about ideas. He didn't see an idea in the whole thing anywhere. Do you? Where is the idea in it? What's the idea?

Interviewer: The idea is obviously, it seems to me, that a lot of people want to live together to make their livings, to make money, to... to enjoy what this large city has to offer. And I guess from time immemorial people have flocked more or less to one spot to exchange ideas as well as goods.

Mr Wolf: But there was a justification for that. When there were no other means of communication than by personal contact. That's when the plans for the cities we now live in originated. They originated back in the Middle Ages, when the only way you could have a culture, the only way you could get social distinction or any education, was by joining other people. Today, however, we cannot get modern improvements here in the city anymore.

Interviewer: Let me see if I get your point. Is Fallingwater, Frank Lloyd Wright's most famous work, an example of good architecture? What is it that makes Fallingwater so special?

Mr Wolf: Fallingwater is Frank Lloyd Wright's house built over a waterfall in Pennsylvania for a rich family from Pittsburgh in the 1930s, and it's arguably *the* most famous house of the modern era. I think it's Wright's supreme example of architecture connected to nature, what he called 'organic architecture', because the house is integrated into the landscape. The water flows through the living room.

Interviewer: I get it now. Let's talk about other aspects of Wright's personality. Wright had faith in youth. However, he did not have faith in the mob, yet young people grow into adults and often turn into a mob. Or do I misunderstand?

Mr Wolf: I think you've got it right. He believed that many people were not properly educated and didn't have an opportunity to go right instead of left. He always said that he put a capital N on Nature, and that is where people had to go, go back to Nature. He said that when you go out into a big forest, with towering pines, and experience a feeling of awe, frequently you do connect with the presence of nature, you not only feel large, you feel enlarged and encouraged, intensified, more powerful.

Interviewer: It is clear in your biography that he was rebellious, a radical in his art and life. Do you agree?

Mr Wolf: Absolutely. But don't forget that if you ask the average citizen to name a famous American architect, you can bet that their answer will be Frank Lloyd Wright. Wright gained such cultural primacy for good reason: he changed the way we build and live.

Interviewer: Mr. Wolf, I thank you for talking with us today.

Mr Wolf: Well, you're welcome.

Adapted from https://hrc.contentdm.oclc.org/digital/collection/p15878coll90/id/23/rec/1.

Clau de respostes

1. Why is Frank Lloyd Wright a famous American?

His designs for buildings are admired by architects everywhere.

2. Frank Lloyd Wright wanted people to look to architects and to consult them more because

he wanted to change the type of buildings we live in.

3. What did Frank Lloyd Wright want to reform in the U.S.?

The general way of life.

4. Frank Lloyd Wright liked buildings that

fit into the natural area where they were built.

5. Why did Frank Lloyd Wright not like New York City?

He thought the type of buildings there represented a money-oriented view of society.

6. Why is Fallingwater so famous?

Because a stream runs inside the building.

7. The text says that in certain circumstances we can "experience a feeling of awe." Which of the following expressions is a synonym for awe in the text?

admiration.

8. According to Mr. Wolf, Frank Lloyd Wright

deserves his fame.

Comprensió lectora

1. The horses we see in Assateague Island are described as "feral". This means that they…

descend from domestic animals that have become wild over the years.

2. These horses are unique because they…

have adapted to very tough living conditions.

3. How did the horses arrive on the island?

They were most probably taken there to avoid paying tax.

4. Which of the following sentences is NOT true?

The National Park Service is in charge of all the horses on the island.

5. The U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service…

issues a permit allowing the horses to feed on its grounds.

6. The Pony Penning festival

is a local festival in which horses swim to a nearby island to be sold.

7. The Assateague horses

have adapted to their environment and developed a complex social structure.

8. Visitors to Assateague Island

must treat the horses as wild animals and respect their habitat.

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SÈRIE 5

Comprensió d'un text oral

The Surprising History of Handwashing

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

go delirious: *entrar en un estat de deliri / entrar en un estado de delirio*

ward: sala d'hospital / sala de hospital

midwife: *llevadora / comadrona*

puzzling: *misteriós / misterioso*

aisle: *passadís / pasillo*

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer: We take it for granted now that washing our hands is a tool to fight disease. But somebody had to discover that, and most of the credit goes to a Hungarian doctor named Ignaz Semmelweis. How did he come to realize that handwashing was so important for our health? To answer that, we've invited Dr. Diana Tulane, a professor of the history of medicine at Purdue University in Indiana who has studied Ignaz Semmelweis, to our program.

Welcome and good morning, Prof. Tulane.

Prof. Tulane: Good morning, and thank you for inviting me.

Interviewer: My pleasure. How did you become interested in Ignaz? Is he famous?

Prof. Tulane: Actually, I was interested in medicine as practiced in the 19th century, and Ignaz Semmelweis became an important name in medicine from that period.

Interviewer: I'm assuming he had something to do with handwashing.

Prof. Tulane: Yes, that's right. The history of handwashing is actually complicated, and it's pretty amazing that someone discovered the importance of handwashing at a time when most people thought disease was caused by something like bad air.

Interviewer: How can the history of handwashing be complicated? It seems like a pretty basic thing to do.

Prof. Tulane: Now it seems basic, but that wasn't always so. The story begins in 1844 in Vienna, Austria, where Ignaz worked in Vienna General hospital, which was the largest maternity hospital in the world. As you can imagine, hospitals at that time were very different from what we know today. They didn't know about germs, and hospitals were so crowded that it wasn't really that rare for there to be more than one patient in a single bed. Conditions for healing were very poor. Not surprisingly, the mortality rate in hospitals of the time was extremely high.

Interviewer: I can imagine.

Prof. Tulane: One disease that was particularly deadly at this time was child bed fever, which was responsible for the death of many, many women. Women would notice symptoms just a few days after giving birth. Child bed fever was a particularly dramatic disease because it occurred at a time when people were supposed to be very happy, as their child had just been born, but things could go very bad for the mother in a very short period of time. She would start screaming because of the pain and **go delirious**, and die a horrible death.

Interviewer: How terrible. What caused this disease?

Prof. Tulane: We know now that this disease is caused by a bacterial infection, but that wasn't known at the time. Remember, they didn't know about germs.

Interviewer: So what happened at the hospital in Vienna?

Prof. Tulane: The conditions at Vienna General hospital were so crowded that they had to divide the maternity ward into two clinics, one that was served by doctors, and the other that was served by midwives. Soon it became apparent that many more women were getting child bed fever and dying in the doctors' clinic than in the midwives' clinic. This was very puzzling to everyone, because doctors had more training than midwives, so everyone expected that doctors would be able to provide better care. No one understood why more women in the doctors' clinic were dying.

Interviewer: I bet it was Ignaz who solved the puzzle. And how did he do it?

Prof. Tulane: Well, first he analyzed some of the explanations that people had already suggested. Many people thought that child bed fever was caused by overcrowded conditions, but he knew that that could not be the only factor because both the clinic served by doctors and the one served by midwives were equally crowded, so there was no difference there that would explain the difference in mortality. But he did observe some other differences between the two clinics.

Interviewer: Really? How did he do this?

Prof. Tulane: He did what any good scientist would do: he set up controlled experiments. He had the women in one clinic give birth while lying on their sides, while

those in the other clinic gave birth while lying on their backs. He then switched the positions for each group, but this had no effect. More of the doctors' patients were still dying. Then, he noticed that in the doctors' clinic, a priest was walking down the aisles ringing a bell. He thought that maybe psychological terror played a role because the women in the doctors' clinic knew that they were dying once they saw the priest and heard the bell, but that he couldn't proof that, either.

Interviewer: It sounds like this process took a long time.

Prof. Tulane: Oh yes, it took him several years. Then, in 1847, his best friend Robert, a doctor, was accidentally cut while doing an autopsy and died soon afterwards. Ignaz noticed that his dying friend shared a lot of characteristics with the women dying from child bed fever, so he hypothesized that they all had the same disease, and it obviously wasn't only related to giving birth. He then observed that the doctors would do autopsies and afterward go directly to the maternity ward to deliver babies. He realized that the disease might be caused by the contact with dead bodies.

Interviewer: So, in effect, the doctors were spreading the disease from cadavers to mothers who had just given birth.

Prof. Tulane: Exactly. To test his hypothesis, Ignaz had the doctors wash their hands with a disinfectant after they performed an autopsy and before they entered the maternity ward. Once the doctors started doing this, the mortality rate of women in their clinic decreased to the same level as that in the midwives' clinic.

Interviewer: So, did Ignaz become a hero? It sounds like he saved a lot of women's lives.

Prof. Tulane: Well, yes and no. At first, the medical community was skeptical. Most of the doctors agreed to his idea of handwashing, but Ignaz was not an easy person to work with. For example, he insisted that all cases of child bed fever were caused by contamination from autopsies, even when that really wasn't possible. In the end, he was taken to a psychiatric hospital and died alone.

Interviewer: How sad! But his realization that handwashing could prevent the spread of disease turned out to be very important.

Prof. Tulane: Yes. At about the same time as his death, scientists discovered that germs cause disease, and that would not have happened without the work of people like Ignaz Semmelweis.

Interviewer: That's all we have time for today. Thank you, Dr. Tulane, for this very interesting history of handwashing.

Prof. Tulane. Thank you.

Text adapted from the program "The Surprise History of Handwashing" on National Public Radio, January 26, 2021.

Clau de respostes

1. Where did Ignaz Semmelweis work?

- In a large hospital in Vienna.

2. Which of the following statements about Vienna General Hospital is NOT TRUE?

- It only served veterans of war.

3. Child bed fever was a disease affecting

- women who had just given birth.

4. Why did the hospital divide the maternity ward into two clinics?

- Because the hospital had too many maternity patients.

5. As he tried to discover why more women were dying in one of the clinics, what did Ignaz do first?

- He considered solutions that others had proposed.

6. Which of the following statements is TRUE about Ignaz's work?

- He discovered the importance of handwashing because he had done controlled experiments.

7. Ignaz discovered that child bed fever

- was spread by the doctors' lack of personal hygiene when working.

8. Once the doctors started to wash their hands after performing autopsies,

- the number of women dying in the clinic served by doctors decreased.

Comprensió lectora

GINKGO TREES NEARLY WENT EXTINCT. HERE'S HOW WE SAVED THESE 'LIVING FOSSILS'

1. According to scientists

- ginkgo trees losing their leaves later in the year is possibly due to climate change.

2. Which one of the sentences is FALSE?

- ginkgos almost went extinct because of human carelessness with nature.

3. According to the International Union for the Conservation of Nature

- practically no ginkgos exist in the wild.

4. Which one of the sentences is TRUE?

- ginkgos produce seeds.

5. Fossilized plants confirm that

- ginkgos have actually changed very little through time.

6. The undomesticated population of ginkgos found in western China

- might have been cultivated by monks.

7. Today domesticated ginkgo trees

- are common around the world.

8. Crane is not worried about the future of the ginkgo because

- it is a popular species of tree.

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SÈRIE 3

Comprensió d'un text oral

3, 2, 1… Slam!: Poetry comes to the stage

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

scribble*:* gargotejar/garabatear

thumb through: fullejar/hojear

be hooked on: estar enganxat/estar enganchado

open mic: micròfon obert/micrófono abierto

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Interviewer: Welcome to our weekly programme on literature. Today we're going to discuss a relatively recent development in literature, a poetry slam. A poetry slam is a competition arts event in which poets perform before a live audience and a panel of judges. Slams have become increasingly popular all around the world, with events welcoming a large number of attendees. My guest Anne is here with us today to tell us about her experience as a slammer.

Hi, Anne! Could you tell us about yourself? Would you define yourself as a poet?

Anne: What a nice question! I had never been asked that! The truth is that I have always loved writing. I've got my notebook with me all the time —whether it's by the side of my bed or on trains, I always scribble things down, although I don't type that often. In fact, there's a suitcase full of poems beneath my bed. I don't remember how most of them got there. Sometimes I'll thumb through them and see my messy little-kid handwriting. There may be over a hundred pages stained with dirty hands and the remains of more than a few grilled cheese sandwiches.

Interviewer: When did performance jump in? Why did you start taking part in poetry slam competitions?

Anne: I first saw a live slam competition in 2018. I'd never heard of this kind of event, but I saw it was advertised in a magazine. After attending a few sessions, I got completely hooked on it and decided to give it a try from stage. I think what I liked about it was that emphasis on connection. Whether it's a performer making you laugh or making you cry, there's a certain live element to that. You know, I've got videos online and you can see me perform from any device, but it's different when it's live. In a live context you can immediately get what the performer's trying to say and there's an added level of accessibility, because the person who's written the poem is in front of you, saying it, and it gives it so much more context.

Interviewer: You have a degree in Maths, if I'm not wrong. Has that helped you with your poetry?

Anne: Yeah! For ages I told myself that the two were just separate worlds, but then I realised that when I'm writing my poems or searching for a particular way of phrasing something or a rhyme, there is definitely a technicality to it. It's not as rigid as a formula that I have to follow, but I think I've really embraced the idea of patterns and playfulness that I learnt through maths. I try to bring that to my poetry.

Interviewer: Tell us about slam poems. What are they like and how do you prepare for them?

Anne: There is a time limit in poem performances –we typically have a maximum of three minutes. I used to just write my poems as a hobby in my free time, so from start to finish it would be a couple of months, maybe, waiting for inspiration to come. Now I

think that I do it full time, I'm a bit more disciplined with that, so it's anything from a couple of weeks to much longer. It'll often start with a playful bit of language, whether that's a rhyme or a one-liner, and then it just comes out.

Interviewer: And you need to memorise the whole poem for live performances?

Anne: Yes, but that's something I've always done. I was always good at remembering the lyrics to songs or specific jokes that I heard. As part of my writing process, I'll speak poems out loud to feel their rhythm. The first time I perform, I'll still have it in my book in front of me just in case, but I think once I've learnt a poem, I enjoy the performance aspect of it and I find that easier if I can do it without worrying about what the next line's going to be.

Interviewer: And then in the event a panel of three to five judges gives each slammer a score, is that right? What is your secret to score high?

Anne: Yes, that's right. Usually, the panel is selected randomly from the audience in the room. A good idea to score higher is to read the room to choose the poem you're going to perform, because it's a live thing, you know, so it's dependent on who's in the room. It's also helpful to have enough poems so that you can pick and choose among them.

Interviewer: Are there any tips you'd like to give people who perhaps want to get into spoken word poetry?

Anne: Don't get too nervous if you decide to try. The audience at these events is usually very supportive. Sometimes it can be difficult to feel confident, but it's really worth it. Try **open mic** nights first if you think that could be helpful before getting into a competition. Watch videos online of some of the best slammers worldwide to prepare yourself, like Harry Baker's, Dani Orviz's, or Emi Mahmoud's –they are a true source of inspiration!

Interviewer: Wow! I'm looking forward to watching those videos myself! Thank you, Anne, for your time and for letting us know about poetry slam. We hope to see you on stage very soon!

Anne: My pleasure.

Adapted from 'An interview with our favourite World Poetry Slam Champion: Harry Baker', *The Temple Times*, 13th March 2020.

Clau de respostes

1. **How does Anne write her poems?**

   She prefers to write out her poems by hand.

2. **How did Anne learn about poetry slam?**

   She read an ad about a competition.

3. **According to Anne, the best thing about slam is**

   the strong link between the poet and the live audience.

4. **Anne's poem**

   search phrasing and rhyme by following patterns.

5. **How long does it take Anne to write a poem?**

   Sometimes just a couple of weeks.

6. **How does Anne prepare for a performance?**

   She recites poems aloud to become familiar with their rhythm.

7. **Why is the audience important in a slam competition?**

   Because some members of the audience may be part of the panel.

8. **Which of the following statements is NOT true about Anne?**

   She does not like maths anymore.

Comprensió lectora

1. **Which of the following best describes Parwana?**

   Parwana didn't want to accept her parent's decision.

2. **According to the text,**

   her parents were forced to sell her due to hunger.

3. **Which of the following sentences is NOT true?**

   The country's economy is booming.

4. **The word *futile* is used in the text in paragraph 5. A synonym for *futile* is**

   useless.

5. **Parwana's sale**

   will be a decision that Parwana's father will have to face for the rest of his children's sake.

6. **According to the text, what does Qorban say about the sale?**

   He would treat her as another family member.

7. **When girls under 15 are married off**

   their fundamental freedoms are being infringed.

8. **Which of the following sentences best summarizes the content of the article?**

   The sale and marriage of young girls is a desperate measure to overcome extreme poverty.

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Sèrie 2

I. Listening comprehension

Goalball, a Unique Sport

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

goalball*: golbol / gólbol*

low vision*: baixa visió / baja visión*

eyeshade*: antifaç / antifaz*

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme. [Now listen to the interview.]

Interviewer: The **Paralympic Games** are a series of international multi-sport events involving athletes with different disabilities. What you may not know is that there is one sport played in the Paralympics which does not have an Olympics counterpart: goalball. My guest today is Chloe Thompson, and she is here to tell us what makes goalball unique. She is a goalball player on the American team.

Welcome to our programme, Chloe. I must say I've never heard of goalball. Can you tell us a little bit about this sport, and what makes it unique?

Chloe: Sure, and thank you for inviting me to your programme. Goalball is the only sport played in the Paralympics that has not been adapted from another sport. It was created on its own, specifically for people who have low vision or who are blind. It was invented in the 1940s by two doctors to help with the rehabilitation of soldiers who had been blinded in the Second World War, and developed as a competitive sport in the 1950s and 1960s. Today goalball is played in over 100 countries around the world. The game has a large following in these countries and is played both for enjoyment as well as a rehabilitation technique for children who are born blind and for anyone who loses their sight later in life. It was first played in the Paralympics unofficially in 1972, and in 1976 it became an official Paralympic sport.

Interviewer: What kind of court is it played on?

Chloe: Goalball is played on a court that is the same size as a volleyball court. It is 18 meters long by 9 meters wide and all of the lines that are on the floor are both painted and tactile so that the players can feel them with their hands and feet as they play.

Interviewer: Why do the lines on the floor have to be painted, if all the players rely on their sense of touch to feel them?

Chloe: Goalball has referees, like other competitive sports, and they need to see the lines. In fact, there are nine officials on court during official competitions.

Interviewer: Of course. Could you tell us a bit about the game itself? How long does a game take, and how do you score points?

Chloe: A goalball game consists of two 12-minute halves with a 3-minute halftime in which the players switch ends of the court, so each game lasts about half an hour. There are two teams, and there is a maximum of six players on each team, and there are three players from each team on the court at any single time. Players try to defend their goal from throws of a ball from the other end of the court. So, the object of the game is to score goals by getting the ball past the opposing team and across the goal line, and to do this you either throw the ball or roll it on the ground. The ball is about the size of a basketball and it weighs just under three pounds.

Interviewer: So you either throw or roll the ball. Can you also kick it?

Chloe: No, players are not allowed to kick the ball.

Interviewer: This may sound like a silly question, but how do you know where the ball is if you can't see it?

Chloe: The ball has bells inside of it so that it can be heard when it's being thrown or when it's rolling. So for the players it's very important for the crowd to keep quiet while the ball is in play because otherwise we can't hear it. The coaches must also stay silent during gameplay. In fact, silence is so important that if players on the offense make too much noise while they are throwing or rolling the ball, they can be penalized because the team defending its goal might not be able to hear the ball.

Interviewer: Is this sport only for people who are totally blind?

Chloe: No. Some players are totally blind and some have low vision. Because of the varying degrees of visual impairment of the athletes, we are all required to wear eyeshades that completely black out our vision, so that everybody on court, in effect, plays blind.

Interviewer: Tell us a little bit about your last goalball game.

Chloe: It was great! We played in San Francisco. One of the referees punished me with a penalty because I touched my eyeshades, which is not allowed, so I had to defend the entire goal on my own. I was nervous and could feel the tense atmosphere in the audience. But in the end, we won!

Interviewer: I can tell you're very enthusiastic about goalball Why do you like playing so much?

Chloe: To me, my team is like a family. I love the unity that we have. We are really good friends and rely on each other. Apart from that, this sport improves my orientation skills and builds confidence, which helps me in lots of ways. I also like the competitiveness of the game. It's really great fun!

Interviewer: Thank you, Chloe, for such a lovely introduction to this sport. We hope to see you on court very soon, although now we know we won't be allowed to shout each time you touch the ball. I'm looking forward to seeing your next match!

Chloe: Thank you!

Text adapted from United States Association of Blind Athletes / https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=du5doesduIw; Goalball New Zealand / http://www.goalball.org.nz/home/what-is-goalball; and Goalfix USA / https://goalfixsportsusa.com/news/goalball/.

1. Goalball was created…

as a rehabilitation activity after the Second World War.

2. Goalball players…

may have lost vision at any point in life.

3. The goalball court in the Paralympics…

is the same size as a standard volleyball court.

4. In a goalball game…

three players from each team play at the same time.

5. How do players know where the ball is while playing?

By following the sound of the ball.

6. Why are players required to wear eyeshades?

Because they may have different degrees of vision loss.

7. What did Chloe do wrong in her last goalball game?

She touched her eyeshades.

8. What does Chloe especially like about goalball?

How the game helps her to develop orientation skills.

II. Reading comprehension

The Woman Who Saved Millions of Lives Without Knowing

1. Which one of the following sentences about Henrietta Lacks is NOT true?

She died while giving birth to her fifth son.

2. When Henrietta Lacks was in hospital, George Gey

received some of her tissue.

3. Because of senescence,

cells eventually die.

4. Lack's cells "became a workhorse of biological research". This means that

they were used over and over again.

5. The HeLa cell line

has been the basis for medical research for years.

6. According to the text,

neither Henrietta nor her family were ever asked permission to conduct experiments with her cells.

7. The #BlackLivesMatter movement

has made researchers consider stopping the use of HeLa cells completely.

8. Some of Henrietta's descendants

do not mind what was done wrong, because the result was worth it.

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Sèrie 5

Listening comprehension

The Mystery of Jim Thompson

In the following conversation, you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

silk: seda

guild: gremi / gremio

spinner: filador / hilandero

fabrics: roba, tela / ropa, tela

legacy: llegat / legado

teakwood: teca (tipus de fusta / tipo de madera)

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

More than forty years after the supposed death of Jim Thompson, he remains the most important and beloved farang ('foreigner') in Thailand. His name is related to the silk business in Thailand, but he led a life full of adventures and his death, if he is dead, is still a mystery. In today's program, our reporter interviews Mark Biles, who has just published a biography of Jim Thompson.

REPORTER: Hi, Mark. Welcome to our programme.

MARK: My pleasure.

REPORTER: **To start, tell us why you are so interested in Jim Thompson.**

MARK: Well, learning about someone from a different era, a different background or a totally different set of life experiences gives you a new perspective. It allows you to see the world in new ways. Two years ago, I was in Thailand on holidays, and someone told me about this man. Everything about him seemed taken out of a movie. So, I started to investigate. I was able to find out many things about his life but much remained, and will remain, a secret forever.

REPORTER: He was American, wasn't he? So how come he is so famous in Thailand? Tell us a bit about his life.

MARK: Jim Thompson was born in Delaware, in the United States. He was the youngest of five children His father was a wealthy textile manufacturer. He studied

architecture at Princeton. He lived and worked in New York and had a comfortable life there. But in 1944 he quit his job and enlisted with the Delaware National Guard. In 1949, he joined the Department of Strategic Services of the United States, what today we know as the CIA, to participate in different operations in the Far East. He arrived in Thailand shortly after the victory over Japan in World War II. After a series of "missions", he was finally assigned to Bangkok as head of American secret services, thus beginning the fabulous legend that emerges from his no less fabulous life.

REPORTER: So, let me see if I got it right. He was a spy!!

MARK: Exactly, notice we are referring to the 1940s. The Second World War had just ended. It's the time of the Cold War. The United States needed information, so Thailand seemed like a great place to get it. However, oddly enough he is not remembered for his deeds as a member of CIA. He was a benefactor for Thai society and that is why he is well remembered.

REPORTER: Right. He is linked to the silk industry, isn't he? How did this relationship start?

MARK: In Bangkok Thompson bought a part of the Oriental Hotel, but his great opportunity came with the **guild** of silk **spinners**. The guild was in decline because silk had been relegated by the Thais themselves in favour of other, cheaper **fabrics**. Thompson was a visionary and relaunched the silk business thanks to his contacts with Europe. In 1948, he founded the Silk Company of Thailand.

REPORTER: But wasn't being a foreigner a huge inconvenience for him? I mean, did the Thais trust him? He may not have known many of their customs and ways of doing business.

MARK: Well, at a time when the Thais preferred everything Western, Thompson was a revolutionary who recovered traditions and craftsmanship. He defended Thai art and architecture at all costs, but without losing his own Western roots. In fact, there was no party or social event of any kind that Thompson did not attend. His presence was fundamental at any and every event, and both the Thais and the international community in Bangkok adored him.

REPORTER: So, he was kind of a star!

MARK: Yes, in fact, all the personalities that passed through the Bangkok of those years sat at his table, among them his friend Truman Capote.

REPORTER: I see. But tell us a bit about his mysterious disappearance. What happened?

MARK: In fact, his mysterious disappearance accelerated his legend. In 1967, during a vacation in Malaysia with some friends, he went for a walk and simply disappeared. This gave rise to speculations of all kinds: kidnapping, murder, all sorts of things.

REPORTER: But people do not just disappear. I'm sure the police looked into the disappearance.

MARK: Yes, of course. But the fact is that he was never found, which only served to forge his legend. And to put more salt on the wound, his only sister was killed in her home in the United States soon after his disappearance and their driver and guide in Malaysia dropped out of sight and was never heard from again. You can see how all of this seems to be part of a crime novel as opposed to real life. Some people say that, in reality, he never stopped working for the CIA and that's why he left as suddenly as he had arrived.

REPORTER: Spy or not, the truth is that he left a magnificent **legacy**.

MARK: Definitely. Today the silk business that Thompson created is one of the main sources of income in the country, a thriving industry that exports silk to the whole world. In addition, the firm has diversified and has entered the restaurant business, opening restaurants and wine bars with all the glamour that always characterized this man of exquisite tastes.

REPORTER: We are running out of time, so a last question. Is there a place in Thailand where we can see his legacy?

MARK: Yes, absolutely. Currently you can visit his magnificent mansion, which has been converted into a museum in Bangkok. In 1958, he began what was to be his most important architectural achievement—the construction of a new home to display his art objects. The house is a combination of six independent Thai-style **teakwood** houses that have been reassembled in traditional Thai fashion—not even a single nail was used. And the museum also houses an excellent collection of Thai art that includes one of the best collections of traditional art from around the world.

REPORTER: Well, Mark, it's been a pleasure to have you here tonight.

MARK: Thank you for inviting me.

Adapted from: http://www.turismotailandes.com/el-misterio-de-jim-thompson-y-el-negocio-de-la-seda-en-tailandia/ and https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e1yq9gCKnEE [30th November 2018]

1. **Which of these facts is NOT true about Jim Thompson?**

   He arrived in Bangkok in the middle of the World War.

2. **Why did the Thais not use silk? Because**

   They used other types of cloth that were cheaper.

3. **Which of these statements is TRUE according to the text?**

   Thais liked Western things more than traditional Thai things.

4. **How did Thompson disappear?**

   He was on holiday in Malaysia and did not return after leaving for a stroll.

5. **What contributed to the mystery of his disappearance?**

   His sister was murdered not long after he went missing.

6. **Which of these things does Thompson's firm NOT have?**

   Architecture studios

7. **What can you visit in Thompson's mansion?**

   Thompson's collection of Thai art.

8. **What is special about Thai buildings?**

   The houses are held together without nails.

Reading comprehension

1. Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE?

The biologists extracted the straw right away.

2. The harm that plastic causes on marine birds

results in a constant feeling of hunger.

3. We can deduce from Matthew Savoca's research that

anchovies feed on algae.

4. Plastic is a threat to animals because

it can be thrown away easily.

5. Straws, water bottles and plastic bags

last much longer than expected.

6. The massive use of plastic

is a relatively recent phenomenon.

7. The impact of plastic waste on wildlife

requires government intervention.

8. According to the text, which of the following is an effective solution to the threat of plastic waste on wildlife?

Locating crucial areas and then forbidding plastics there.

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SÈRIE 1

Listening comprehension

(3 points)

KAREN BLIXEN, A LIFE MADE FOR FILM

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

supplies: provisions / provisiones

spells of drought: sequera / sequía

hazardous: arriscat / arriesgado

auction: subhasta / subasta

engaged: compromesa / comprometida

breakdown: atac, crisi / ataque, crisis

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Journalist: Among the many stories that Kenya hides, one of the most interesting is that lived by Karen Blixen, the Danish writer who published some of the most beautiful stories of the twentieth century under the name of Isak Dinesen. However, it was in 1985 when the film directed by Sydney Pollack, Out of Africa, starring Meryl Streep and Robert Redford, brought her universal fame. But today we are not here to talk about the film but rather about the woman Karen Blixen. And to do so, we have here with us, Professor Jensen from the University of Copenhagen, who has just published Blixen's biography. Good morning, Dr Jensen.

Dr Jensen: Good morning. A pleasure to be here.

Journalist: Professor Jensen, Blixen did not like being interviewed. Where did you find the information you needed to write her biography?

Dr Jensen: You're right. In 1957 when she was interviewed in *The New York Times Book Review*, she said that interviews are like medical examinations and, who can feel inspired when he is being examined!

Journalist: Funny way of describing an interview!

Dr Jensen: Yeah, but … in fact, she did give many interviews.

Journalist: So, did you get information about her life there?

Dr Jensen: Not really. The interviews shed light on Karen Blixen's personality, literary interests and her view of Africa. She did not talk a lot about her private life. In the interviews, she commented on a number of social issues and values, as well as more general aspects of her storytelling.

Journalist: OK. Tell us something about her life. We all know about her life in Kenya and her love affair with an aristocratic hunter because of the film "Out of Africa". But how much of what we see in the film is real?

Dr Jensen: The film is based on Blixen's life in Kenya but, in my opinion, the film has become a classic because the safaris, the biplane and the epic scenery captured the imagination of cinema audiences all over the world.

Journalist: I see. So, let's look at Blixen's life. She was Danish and the daughter of a wealthy politician. Why did she go to Kenya?

Dr Jensen: Marriage. In 1913, when she was 28 years old, she left Denmark and her childhood home, and embarked on the journey to Africa, where she married a Swedish Baron named Bror Blixen-Finecke and began a new life on a coffee farm in Kenya. Their families gave them money to start the coffee farm but in August that year the First World War broke out *and* spread to Africa. This had consequences for the Blixens: there was a shortage of both workers and supplies for the farms. Even more, in 1917 the British banned the importation of coffee. On top of this, Kenya was hit by a plague in cattle and by catastrophic spells of drought. The difficult conditions were even worse because Blixen's husband started hazardous projects, which led to debts. They lost a lot of money. To make matters worse, Karen became very ill. She was diagnosed as having syphilis and had to go back to Denmark to be treated. So that meant more spending.

Journalist: So, I imagine those were hard times for them.

Dr Jensen: Sure, they were. But Karen was happy at that time because she met the English aristocrat Denys Finch Hatton, who was a safari leader in Kenya. The meeting led to the start of a long love affair, the nature of which is very apparent in Karen Blixen's *Out of Africa*.

Journalist: And what happened to the coffee farm? And her husband?

Dr Jensen: Well, the board of directors of the farm fired her husband and Karen took over the running of the coffee farm. On top of that, in 1925 they got divorced.

Journalist: So, did she manage to make a living out of the farm together with Finch Hatton?

Dr Jensen: On the contrary. Karen did not succeed in straightening out the farm's hopeless financial situation, and in 1931 the board of directors ran out of patience and the farm was sold at auction. Karen had to get ready to leave Africa. At this point she was ready for a change because a few months earlier, Denys Finch Hatton died when his private plane crashed.

Journalist: Ohhh. So, she went back to Denmark.

Dr Jensen: Exactly: In 1931, 46-year-old Karen Blixen, now financially ruined, moved in with her mother in Denmark.

Journalist: And that was when that she started writing?

Dr Jensen: Well, not exactly. Many great artists and writers show a desire during childhood and early youth to express themselves in the form of poems, little stories and sketches. This was also true of Karen. At 8, she wrote poems, fairy tales, stories and plays. In 1907 and 1909, before her marriage, some of her short stories were published under the pseudonym "Osceola" in two of the leading literary periodicals of the time, but they received no particular attention. But in 1913, when she became engaged to the Swedish baron, she gave up all thoughts of an artistic career. In a letter written to her brother, she explains that she did it to follow the convention of the time: women were destined for marriage and family life.

Journalist: So, she gave up writing when she was in Kenya and started writing again when back in Denmark?

Dr Jensen: Yes and no. She started writing in Africa around 1925, when her problems had begun piling up. But yes, it was when her life changed radically that she was obliged to find a new purpose in life and a new occupation, so she set out to finish the stories. In 1934, *Seven Gothic Tales* was published under the pseudonym "Isak Dinesen" and in 1937 *Out of Africa* made Karen Blixen's name a modern classic.

Journalist: She did not have an easy life but, at least, she was aware of her literary success.

Dr Jensen: Yes, that's right. She was a strong woman with extremely fragile health. By the time she died in 1962, she had had several health breakdowns including severe operations which left her an invalid and unable to eat. However, when her health allowed, she gathered enough strength to visit different countries to receive prizes or to give talks on her books.

Journalist: What an extraordinary woman! Thanks, Dr Jensen for giving us an insight into her fascinating life.

Dr Jensen: My pleasure.

1. She did not talk much about herself and her ordinary life.

2. Their own families.

3. It rained a lot and the farm was flooded often.

4. She wrote about the love affair in *Out of Africa*.

5. The farm went bankrupt and was sold at auction.

6. When she was 8 years old.

7. She wanted to follow the general expectations for women at that time.

8. She went on writing and gave talks when her illness allowed.

Reading Comprehension

1. they were able to forget about their problems.

2. if we learn to go without technological tools.

3. students learn best after moments of outdoor relaxation.

4. has induced several organizations to remind people to unplug.

5. Taking technological breaks can develop into a severe addiction.

6. to pause our use of connected devices periodically.

7. Because we know companies are constantly launching state-of-the-art devices.

8. Being connected all the time makes us less creative.

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Criteris de correcció **Anglès**

SÈRIE 1

Listening comprehension (3 points)

We'll be on Mars again!

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

spacecraft, craft: nau espaial, nau / nave espacial, nave
layer: capa
gust of wind: cop de vent / golpe de viento
shield: escut / escudo
quake: terratrèmol / terremoto
seismometer: sismòmetre/sismómetro

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Paul Smith: This is *Science Today*. Welcome! The spacecraft InSight successfully landed on the surface of Mars a few weeks ago, just as other spacecraft had done in previous missions, but it is different this time. Today, Dr Susan Halliday, a scientist working for the InSight mission for NASA is with us and will help us find out why this mission is different from previous ones.

Paul: We've had a lot of spacecraft go to Mars. What's unique about this mission?

Dr Halliday: We have had many missions that have looked at the surface of Mars, but we are the first one that is really going to tell us about the interior of Mars and its several layers, how all those layers got there. We will learn about the geologic activity that could have created a habitat that may have supported life early in Mars's history.

Paul: And why do we want to know that?

Dr Halliday: Well, what we are really aiming for, our big-picture scientific question is what happens in the first tens of millions of years after a planet forms. We know from investigations of volcanoes on Earth that all the rocky bodies go through this process of separating into different layers, but we don't know much about how that process really works. Our mission will help us gain a better understanding of this process.

Paul: Can you tell me a little bit about the craft?

Dr Halliday: Sure, it's the InSight Lander. Lander crafts don't have wheels. We actually need to stay in one place and be as quiet as possible so that we can use our instruments to detect Mars quakes. In fact, we put those instruments underground. This is extremely important to us. The first mission that landed on Mars, Viking, actually had a seismometer that stayed on the craft. So it detected the gusts of wind that made the craft shake, but it could not detect quakes precisely at all.

Paul: I see, so the InSight also has a seismometer?

Dr Halliday: Yes, that's right, but for the first time we're going to place it on the ground. The only other place where this has been done besides Earth is on the Moon. The Apollo astronauts actually drilled holes into the Moon to place some instruments underground. But now we are going to do all those things robotically. We use a robotic arm to put the seismometer in the ground and then place a wind shield on top of the seismometer to protect it from wind gusts that could be mistaken for seismic waves.

Paul: And how do you decide on the landing location? Can you determine a location precisely?

Dr Halliday: Yes, we can be very precise about the location. In fact, we chose a specific area where there is a certain elevation for safety reasons. The atmosphere of Mars is very thin, so we need to have enough atmosphere to slow us down so that we can land. And because the InSight is powered by solar energy, we need to be near the equator. And then, lastly, we don't want our spacecraft to land on rocks or to have rocks under the surface we want to drill. We went for the flattest, safest, most boring landing site ever on Mars, we were not interested in exploring the geology of various areas, as previous missions had done.

Paul: When the Curiosity spacecraft landed on Mars about six years ago, the landing was described as the seven minutes of terror. Is it less risky now?

Dr Halliday: Well, not really. Every time you land on Mars it's always very risky. When it works, it looks smooth and easy, but, in fact, at least a third of the missions that have been sent to Mars have failed.

Paul: And how is the landing achieved?

Dr Halliday: Well, first we need a heat shield, because we are going at 12,300 miles per hour when we hit the atmosphere of Mars. This slows down the craft quite a bit. Then, when it is pretty near the surface, the parachute is released. This makes the craft go quite slowly, and finally, in the last one hundred meters or so we remove the parachute and we come down on landing rockets. And so if everything goes well, it's quite a gentle touchdown.

Paul: But it's still a precision landing really, isn't it?

Susan: It is, and it's all automated. Because of the one-way flight time to Mars, we can't command anything when this is happening, we just have to rely on getting the sequence of commands correct in advance and we just sit in the control room and wait to hear back.

Paul: So, now that the landing was successful, what happens next?

Dr Halliday: Our initial mission lasts one Mars year, that is, two Earth years. The first thing we are going to do is spend a few months choosing the right place to put our instruments down in the ground. So it will be a while before we actually start acquiring data.

Paul: I am sure that data must be very interesting and revealing.

Dr Halliday: We hope so.

Paul: I'm afraid we've run out of time. Many thanks for talking to us about the InSight mission.

Dr Halliday: My pleasure.

Sources:

Adapted from:

https://www.abc.net.au/radionational/programs/scienceshow/mars-insight-lander-to-monitor-mars-interior/10548156#

ABC Radio National (Australian Broadcasting Corporation)

Listening comprehension

1. The InSight mission is unique in that it will investigate
❒ **the geology of the interior of Mars.**
❒ Mars' surface and atmosphere.
❒ whether Mars can support human life.
❒ the early history of Mars' atmosphere.

2. According to Dr Halliday, this mission will help scientists understand how
❒ the activity of volcanoes developed on Earth millions of years ago.
❒ layers of different types of rocks were formed on Earth.
❒ **rocks separate into different layers.**
❒ long ago planets like Mars and the Earth were formed.

3. Why does the InSight spacecraft need to stay in one place?
❒ **To detect quakes.**
❒ To detect wind.
❒ To avoid making noise.
❒ To avoid breaking instruments.

4. The seismometer of the Viking spacecraft
❒ **could not detect Mars quakes well**.
❒ could not measure wind gusts well.
❒ was better than the one on the InSight lander.
❒ was handled by astronauts.

5. The InSight makes use of a shield
❒ to help put the InSight instruments underground.
❒ **to protect the seismometer from wind gusts.**
❒ to protect astronauts while they drill holes.
❒ to protect the spacecraft from seismic waves.

6. The choice of the InSight's landing location was partially determined by
❒ the orbit of Mars.
❒ the amount of fuel left in the rocket.
❒ **the type of surface of the landing spot.**
❒ the speed of the spacecraft when reaching Mars.

7. A gentle touchdown of the spacecraft is achieved by
❒ removing all rockets.
❒ removing the heat shield.
❒ **using a parachute to slow it down**.
❒ separating the craft into 2 parts to make each part lighter in weight.

8. When will Dr Halliday and her team start receiving data from Mars?
❒ One year after InSight lands.
❒ Two years after InSight lands.
❒ Almost immediately after InSight lands.
❒ **After the instruments have been placed underground.**

Reading comprehension

1. According to professor Todorov
- ❒ **we only make first impressions about people we don't know.**
- ❒ we make first impressions only if they are misleading.
- ❒ our first impressions about someone are usually wrong.
- ❒ we usually share our first impression with many other people.

2. Once people have made their first impressions
- ❒ they may change them quite quickly if their opinions are not accurate.
- ❒ they will change their opinion if they are not sure of the person they have just met.
- ❒ **they will hardly ever change their first opinion about a person they have just met.**
- ❒ they always change their mind soon afterwards if given more time to judge a person.

3. Which one of these sentences is **TRUE**?
- ❒ **In first impressions women and men make similar judgments.**
- ❒ In first impressions women and men are judged similarly.
- ❒ In first impressions feminine-looking men are badly considered.
- ❒ In first impressions masculine-looking men are badly judged.

4. According to the text, the photos people publish on their dating profiles are
- ❒ their best ones in order to reflect their personalities only.
- ❒ a mixture of fake and real ones; people don't want to show how they really are.
- ❒ very superficial in order not to show one's real personality and generosity.
- ❒ **chosen to show physical and personality traits.**

5. Prof. Todorov affirms that
- ❒ first impressions are always reliable even when our date starts speaking.
- ❒ **people can change their first impressions when they start talking to their date.**
- ❒ talking to our date reinforces our first impressions, making them more certain.
- ❒ people in general make good predictions from their first impressions.

6. According to Professor Todorov, the conversational strategies used in online dating show
- ❒ that women talk more about themselves than men do.
- ❒ that men talk more about their profession than women do.
- ❒ that men and women use quite different approaches to dating.
- ❒ **that men and women take similar approaches to dating.**

7. If you want to find your perfect date, prof. Todorov recommends that you be
- ❒ talkative when you meet your date.
- ❒ **honest when you talk to your date.**
- ❒ a little vague when talking about your interests.
- ❒ responsible when you talk about your wealth.

8. At the end of the article we can come to the conclusion that speed-dating meetings
- ❒ are the only way to get married successfully.
- ❒ are successful only if you want to have children.
- ❒ **sometimes fulfil people's expectations.**
- ❒ are a very flawed system of meeting people.

SÈRIE 3

I. Listening Comprehension (3 points)

IS LIFE IN THE OUTBACK COMPATIBLE WITH CLIMATE CHANGE?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

drought sequera / sequía
livestock bestià / Ganado
well pou/pozo

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Journalist: Today everyone is talking about climate change and its negative effects on our planet. In recent years, natural events such as huge forest fires, severe droughts and major hurricanes have made people around the world more aware of the importance of our environment. To talk about these and other issues, today we've invited Dr. Robert Thomas from Australian National University to our program. Welcome, Dr. Thomas.

Dr. Thomas: Thank you. Happy to be here.

Journalist: What can you tell us about the effects of climate change in Australia, Dr. Thomas?

Dr. Thomas: Climate change is affecting the amount of rain in the country. Simply put, it rains less. Right now one of the major issues in Australia is the shortage of water in the outback, the central part of the country that is quite a distance from the coastline cities where most Australians live. In the outback, there are more than a dozen towns without a reliable source of water.

Journalist: Oh, I didn't know that.

Dr. Thomas: In the past few years, there has been a severe drought in Australia. Most people don't realize that Australia is the world's most arid continent. Rivers and lakes are disappearing, so people are beginning to fear that many of the rural areas in the middle of the country may have to be abandoned.

Journalist: Is the lack of water only a result of climate change?

Dr. Thomas: Not exactly. In addition to severe drought in recent years that IS related to climate change, the government approved mining projects that depended on an intensive use of water. Tourism in the outback has been promoted for years, and the

population there is growing. More mining and more people mean more pressure on water resources.

Journalist: So there has been a combination of factors involved.

Dr. Thomas: That's right. Besides the new mines and the growing number of people, the country has not invested enough money to prepare for its future water needs. Australia is behind countries like the United States and China in preparing for the future. And the sad part is, the future is now. It rains less in Australia than it did before, so the rivers are drying up. And every year there are huge forest fires that are uncontrollable.

Journalist: What are people going to do?

Dr. Thomas: Well, actually a lot of the farmers in the outback are giving up. Many have decided not to plant any crops on their land and are selling all their livestock. They are moving away. And the towns that developed to serve the farmers and ranchers will probably be abandoned. Those towns depend on the business created by the farmers, and the farmers depend on access to water. With no water, whole towns will probably disappear.

Journalist: It's surprising that nothing can be done. Can't they dig wells? I know that some deserts do have underground water.

Dr. Thomas: In some places, wells already supply part of the drinking water. Many towns want to dig new wells. But digging wells is not a permanent solution to the problem.

Journalist: Why not?

Dr. Thomas: Because the water underground is not high quality water for drinking. It often has a metallic taste, and there have been some studies to suggest that it is responsible for some long-term health problems like high blood pressure. This water has to be treated, and water treatment plants in the outback are expensive and harmful to the environment.

Journalist: Is the situation as bad in Australia's big cities, like Sydney and Melbourne?

Dr. Thomas: No, the situation in coastal areas like Sydney and Melbourne is better but not without problems. Both cities restrict the amount of water people can use. In Sydney the government has hired "water officers" to educate the public and enforce water restrictions.

Journalist: How about using sea water, like they do in other parts of the world? Australia obviously has easy access to oceans.

Dr. Thomas: We do use ocean water. The coastal areas have desalination plants, which are crucial to Australia's water supply. Desalination plants, however, also create some environmental problems because they require a lot of energy to operate and the salt they remove from the water is dumped back into the oceans, which is not good for fish and other sea-living creatures. But the fact is these plants are necessary for Australia.

Journalist: Can water be recycled? I know that in some places in the U.S. recycled water is used to clean streets, for example.

Dr. Thomas: Yes, recycling water is important now and will become even more important in the future. Recycled water is often used to water parks in cities. There are other things that can be done, too. For example, fire stations are studying how to use sand, instead of water, to put out fires. Gardens can have artificial lawns, as opposed to grass. We still don't know the long-term results of climate change, but it is clear that no matter what, Australia must plan for its future water needs.

Journalist: That's all we have time for today. Thank you, Dr. Thomas, for joining us today.

Dr. Thomas: My pleasure.

(adapted from an article by Livia Albeck-Ripka published in The New York Times, Dec. 8, 2019)

Listening comprehension

1. Which of the following is true about Australia?
❒ **The centre of the country has problems with its water supply.**
❒ Each year the country must prepare its coastal cities for hurricanes.
❒ The government currently restricts tourism in the outback.
❒ Several rivers flood every spring, after heavy rainstorms.

2. What is the relationship between the water supply in Australia and climate change, according to Dr. Thomas?
❒ Climate change is the only cause of the lack of rainfall in the outback.
❒ There is no obvious relationship between drought and climate change.
❒ **Climate change is one of the factors causing Australia's current problems.**
❒ The issue needs to be studied more before any conclusion can be reached.

3. What are some farmers and ranchers doing because of the situation described in the conversation?
❒ They are promoting the outback for tourism.
❒ They are building silver and gold mines.
❒ They are changing the crops they plant and raising sheep instead of cattle.
❒ **They are quitting and leaving.**

4. Why will digging wells not meet the population's needs in the outback?
❒ Because there is very little underground water in Australia.
❒ Because digging wells is extremely difficult and expensive.
❒ Because there are so many people that a few wells will not resolve anything.
❒ **Because the well water contains some elements that harm people's health.**

5. Which of the following is **NOT** a problem associated with water desalination plants?
❒ They need a lot of electricity to run.
❒ They deposit salt in ocean water.
❒ **They require nuclear power plants for energy.**
❒ They harm wildlife in the nearby seas.

6. Where is recycled water being used at present in Australia?
❒ In city drinking water.
❒ **In city parks.**
❒ On ranches, for animals to drink.
❒ In mines.

7. According to Dr. Thomas, which of the following is a possible measure to reduce the amount of water used?
❒ Cities can stop building public parks.
❒ New wells can be dug to use underground water.
❒ **Firefighters can substitute sand for water.**
❒ More dams can be built to better conserve river water.

8. Which of the following best characterizes Dr. Thomas' view of water use in Australia? He thinks that…

❒ **there should be more investment in the country's future requirements for water.**

❒ the government is doing everything it can to reduce water consumption.

❒ farms will disappear but ranches will continue to grow in the outback.

❒ new technology will help to reduce Australia's use of water.

Reading comprehension

1. According to the author, many young people…
❒ want to wear light-coloured clothes with flowers.
❒ like shopping for second-hand clothes to achieve a "retro" look.
❒ **like buying used clothes that don't look dated.**
❒ shop for genuine fur coats in second-hand shops.

2. In the US…
❒ the second-hand market for clothing is getting smaller and smaller.
❒ the first-hand market for clothing is 21 times larger than the second-hand market.
❒ the second-hand market for clothing will overtake the first-hand market in 10 years.
❒ **the second-hand market for clothing has increased much faster than the first-hand market.**

3. Which of the following is **TRUE** about people's shopping preferences in the U.K.?
❒ **People over 60 are the age group that feels best about buying pre-worn clothing.**
❒ Teenagers do not usually like buying second-hand clothes.
❒ About 1/2 of all 30-40-year-olds regularly buy used clothes.
❒ Less than half of people between 16 and 21 feel comfortable buying second-hand clothes.

4. Where is the first *Picknweight* vintage store?
❒ In Covent Garden in London.
❒ In Camden market in London.
❒ **In Berlin**.
❒ The text does not say.

5. How is second-hand clothes shopping different from buying new, unworn clothes?
❒ Shoppers can find well-matched outfits ready to be purchased.
❒ All sizes are available in second-hand stores.
❒ **Shoppers should be ready to spend more time in the store.**
❒ Clothes look nicer in a second-hand clothes shop than at home.

6. Which of the following is **NOT** true about *Rokit*?
❒ Its business has grown substantially since 1986.
❒ **It has a single retail location in London.**
❒ It has sold a huge amount of pre-worn clothing.
❒ It mends clothing before trying to sell it.

7. According to the author, if you want to buy now-but-not-new clothes…
❒ you need to browse the internet.
❒ you need to look for famous brands.
❒ you should be looking for bright colours.
❒ **you need to look for details currently in style.**

8. What does the phrase "Fashion is cyclical, after all" mean?
❒ **It means that fashion trends return and are periodically back in style.**
❒ It means that vintage clothes inevitably look old and outdated.
❒ It means that cycling trends will always be fashionable.
❒ It means that we should reduce, recycle and reuse vintage clothes.

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Criteris de correcció **Anglès**

SÈRIE 4

Listening comprehension

Counting The Bugs And Bacteria, You're 'Never Home Alone'

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

microbe*: microbi/microbio*
showerhead*: carxofa de dutxa / alcachofa de ducha*
moist: *humid / húmedo*
to breed*: criar/criar*

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Presenter

You may be shocked to learn what's living in your home. The bacteria, the fungi, viruses, parasites and insects - probably many more than you imagined. My guest Rob Dunn says the real goal is to create a healthy balance of all the microorganisms and insects that co-habit with us. Dunn and the team of scientists he works with analyze the populations of microorganisms living on floors, in basements, on water faucets, the surfaces of TVs, etcetera. He's a professor in the Department of Applied Ecology at North Carolina State University and author of the new book "Never Home Alone" about the microbes, insects, some of them quite exotic, that live in our homes.

[Now listen to the interview]

REPORTER: So, let's start with just an overview of what's going on in our homes.

DUNN: Every surface, every bit of air, every bit of water in your home is alive. And every house, every building we've ever studied, is alive. When we study homes, different homes have different kinds of life in those different places. And so your house has habitats. Each of those habitats is a little bit different. And there are, across houses, hundreds of thousands of species.

REPORTER: How did you get interested in this?

DUNN: So I started off studying rainforests. I was fascinated by the fact that you could turn over a leaf, and every leaf seemed to have something new. And then I eventually found myself in homes with the realization that a lot of what I'd done in jungles we could do under the bed and in showers. And we were making the same kinds of discoveries I'd make in Bolivia or Ghana or Australia or anywhere else.

REPORTER: One of the things you've learned in studying the microecosystem of homes is that there are microbes that live in the extreme environments outdoors - in very cold temperatures or very hot temperatures - that could live indoors because our homes reproduce the extremes of the outdoors through things like the freezer and the hot water heater. So can you elaborate on that a little bit?

DUNN: Certainly. So if you look at a traditional home from a couple of hundred years ago, it would have been relatively open to the outdoor environment, and the conditions in it would have been very much like the conditions outdoors. But in our modern, complex homes, we've built a whole bunch of little structures in the home that replicate really extreme environments from elsewhere

on Earth. You know, our freezers are kind of like the Arctic. Our ovens are like really, really hot deserts. And so when we do that, we're creating habitat for species that like those conditions.

REPORTER: Last year, you were in Iceland filming a documentary near a geyser. People studying the microbes of hot water taps and heaters in homes found similar microbes to the ones in this geyser. So what are they, and what are they doing in our homes?

DUNN: These are really amazing microbes and their environment has to be really hot, close to boiling temperature of water, to grow. And then, if you go to houses, hot water heaters are full of them, too. And they live in that superhot water and they love it. They pour on to you when you take a shower. And they're fascinating little bugs.

REPORTER: Are they harmful to us?

DUNN: No, they're not harmful in any way.

REPORTER: Another study that's been done is on the bacteria in **showerheads**. Can you assure us that it's OK to take a shower, please?

DUNN: It's OK to take a shower. It's far less risky than shaking hands with your neighbour.

REPORTER: Should we stop doing that?

DUNN: No, you should do that, too. We live in a world that's full of life, and we're always making decisions about how to avoid the very most dangerous things while still keeping contact with the rest of life. And, you know, I think we just have to acknowledge that we're surrounded by life.

REPORTER: A lot of people now use antibacterial soaps and hand sanitizers. Having studied all these microbes, what are they doing to the microecology of our homes?

DUNN: Well - so first of all, we know that soap and water - good old-fashioned soap and water - works great to kill pathogens that show up on your hands because you shook somebody's hand who was sick or, you know, after you go to the bathroom. And soap and water saves millions and millions of lives a year. Antibacterial soaps don't work any better than good old-fashioned soaps. We get scared by the idea that there's life around us. We try to kill all of it, and in doing so, we're more likely to make ourselves sick.

REPORTER: Heat and air conditioning systems, which are **moist**, can **breed** a lot of stuff. What are some of the surprises that you and other scientists have found growing in heat and air conditioning systems?

DUNN: Well, we often work with dust. If you have a heat and air conditioning system, there's a set of microbes that those systems seem to favour. And they're not species we know much about, but we know that we can predictably find them in houses that use their heat and air conditioning system a lot.

REPORTER: You know how a lot of people take probiotics so that you create in yourself a good bacterial environment instead of an imbalance? Do you think someday there's going to be something similar to that for homes, something that will allow us to create a good microbial ecology in our homes?

DUNN: Yeah, I hope so. It's not there now. But I look forward to a time when we can essentially garden our homes, fill them with species that benefit us and push out the species that don't.

REPORTER: Well, Rob Dunn, thank you so much for talking with us.

DUNN: Oh, it's been an absolute pleasure. Thank you so much.

Adapted from
https://www.npr.org/sections/health-shots/2018/11/12/666933600/counting-the-bugs-and-bacteria-youre-never-home-alone-and-thats-ok
[November 12, 2018]

1. Different species
❒ move across houses hundreds of thousands of times.
❒ **live in different habitats in our homes.**
❒ study every building alive.
❒ include little different habitats.

2. Professor Dunn
❒ **began his career studying rainforests.**
❒ started off his career studying homes in rainforests.
❒ began his career discovering jungles in Bolivia, Ghana and Australia.
❒ started off his career finding homes in jungles.

3. Which of these sentences is NOT true?
❒ Traditional home conditions were similar to the conditions outdoors.
❒ Freezers and ovens in modern homes replicate extreme environment conditions.
❒ **Some little structures in traditional homes create really extreme habitats for species.**
❒ In modern homes, some structures duplicate extreme environments.

4. Some microbes
❒ **live in hot water heaters.**
❒ are similar to hot water taps and boilers.
❒ grow on people when taking a hot shower.
❒ harm people when taking a hot shower.

5. According to Professor Dunn,
❒ taking a shower is more risky than shaking hands.
❒ people should stop shaking hands.
❒ the world is full of dangerous things.
❒ **life surrounds us.**

6. Which of these sentences is TRUE?
❒ Antibacterial soaps and hand sanitizers are not used by a lot of people.
❒ Antibacterial soaps work much better than soap and water.
❒ Soap and water does not save millions of lives.
❒ **Soap and water destroy pathogens on our hands.**

7. Heat and air conditioning systems
❒ seem to work with microbes that favour dust.
❒ grow species we know much about.
❒ **can breed lots of microbes.**
❒ can predictably find a set of microbes.

8. Professor Dunn looks forward …
❒ **to creating homes with species that benefit us.**
❒ to having houses with gardens to our benefit.
❒ to pushing out species that benefit us from our gardens.
❒ to filling homes with gardens that benefit us.

Reading Comprehension

1. In order to avoid environmental damage
- ❒ **people should eat less meat.**
- ❒ people need to eat more fish.
- ❒ people should eat more meat and dairy.
- ❒ vegan diets need to be adopted.

2. In a few decades, the world population
- ❒ will increase to 2.3 billion people.
- ❒ will increase by 70%.
- ❒ **will increase to 10 billion people.**
- ❒ will not change.

3. If global warming is kept under 1.5ºC
- ❒ traditional farming areas will experience major floods.
- ❒ the risk of drought, floods and extreme heat will increase.
- ❒ we will have a dozen years of continuous drought, floods and extreme heat.
- ❒ **we will reduce the risk of drought, floods and extreme heat.**

4. The report states that dietary habits and changes in farming should be accompanied by
- ❒ more emissions from livestock.
- ❒ less impact on beef production.
- ❒ **a decrease in food loss and waste.**
- ❒ a global increase in meat consumption.

5. A flexitarian diet implies
- ❒ eating mainly raw vegetables.
- ❒ eating no meat from farms.
- ❒ eating more meat and less legumes.
- ❒ **eating more beans and peas and less meat.**

6. In order to be effective against climate breakdown, dietary changes
- ❒ should be applied equally across the world's population.
- ❒ **should be applied more strictly in developed countries.**
- ❒ are unnecessary in developing countries.
- ❒ should not be applied in the US or UK.

7. What does the report recommend to reduce people's consumption of meat?
- ❒ Adopting traditional European farming practices everywhere.
- ❒ Using more fertilisers in developing countries.
- ❒ **Changing menus served to children in schools.**
- ❒ Clearing forests to increase the land available for agriculture.

8. Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE?
- ❒ The Earth's resources are limited.
- ❒ The current food system does not enable future generations to have a sustainable planet.
- ❒ **Technology will help us to continue with food production as we know it now.**
- ❒ The current food system has a damaging impact on our climate.

Listening Comprehension

'Moby-Duck': When 28,800 Bath Toys Are Lost At Sea

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

to end up resultar
deck coberta / cubierta
to stack apilar
to maneuver maniobrar, operar

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

This is FRESH AIR, our weekly program devoted to the environment. What happens when 28,000 rubber ducks and other bath toys are accidentally dumped in the ocean? Where do the ocean currents take them, and what environmental impact do the ducks and other ocean junk have on the seas? That's what our guest, the journalist Donovan Hahn, investigated in his book "*Moby-Duck: The True Story of 28,800 Bath Toys Lost at Sea and the Beachcombers, Oceanographers, Environmentalists, and Fools, Including the Author, Who Went in Search of Them*".

REPORTER: Welcome, Mr. Hahn, to FRESH AIR.

Donovan Hahn: Thank you. Happy to be here.

REPORTER: Let's begin at the beginning. These 28,000 toys **end up** in the North Pacific in January, 1992, when a container falls off a cargo vessel. When and where do people begin finding them?

DH: The following year, in the autumn of 1993, people started finding hundreds of rubber ducks in Sitka, Alaska.

REPORTER: So the ducks were in a container that fell into the ocean. Does that happen often? I mean, millions of containers are shipped around the world every year, so I would imagine that this was a pretty rare event.

DH: In fact, the loss of containers at sea is not so uncommon. But the shipping companies don't particularly like to talk about this problem because of issues with insurance policies. In the accident that is the subject of my book, 12 containers were lost at sea, and that is considered a small spill. In 1998, there was a major disaster in which a ship traveling from China to Seattle, Washington lost 407 containers. That was one of the most expensive shipping disasters in history.

REPORTER: Could you tell us a little more about the kind of ship this container was on, so we can understand how these containers are lost?

DH: Sure. These cargo ships are huge, they're hundreds of meters long. Many are too big to go through the Panama Canal, which explains the importance of the shipping routes between China and the west coast of the U.S. They carry hundreds and hundreds of containers. Even though some containers are carried below **deck**, most are **stacked** on top of each other on the main deck. Typically, the containers are placed into stacks of six, so you can see how easy it would be for some to fall off.

REPORTER: With so many stacked containers, how do they NOT fall off the ships?

DH: The shipping companies study how to best stack the containers in order to balance their weight without affecting the ship's ability to **maneuver**.
REPORTER: It must be a complex calculation.

DH: It is. And, of course, insurance companies require the shipping companies to take every measure to get the calculations right.

REPORTER: It must be hard, with the size of these ships. And they also have to take into account the weather, which can be very bad in the North Pacific.

DH: Absolutely. The shipping companies believe that the huge ships today will survive almost any storm, and for the most part, they do. The fact that these ships are so huge explains why they are more likely to try to sail through bad weather than ships in the past, which tried hard to avoid storms. In fact, part of the route taken by the large cargo ship that lost the toys off the coast of Oregon is known as the Graveyard of the Pacific because of all the shipwrecks recorded there, especially during the time of sailing ships in the 19th century. Given the number of ships today, significant accidents are quite rare.

REPORTER: Let's go back to the lost rubber ducks. Can you tell us a little bit about what would have happened that day? I mean, what was in this container, and what would've happened as it tumbled into the sea?

DH: We know where the cargo ship was—it was very near the International Date Line, just south of the Aleutian Islands in Alaska. We don't know if it was day or night. We know that a ship in the same area sent a weather report to the National Weather Service describing waves over 10 meters high, which means the seas were rough. We don't know exactly how, but 12 containers went overboard. And the container with the toys would have burst open during the fall, and initially a bunch of cardboard boxes were sent into the sea.

REPORTER: And then I suppose the cardboard dissolved, so what we have left are the toys.

DH: Exactly.

REPORTER: How can you be so sure that the toys found in Alaska are the ones that were lost at sea in this container?

DH: That part of the investigation was actually easy. First, these toys are no longer being made, so the design is different and not difficult to recognize. They are hollow plastic and sort of strange-looking. Second, the ducks have the manufacturer's mark on the wing. Third, we know from other merchandise lost at sea what plastic looks like after crossing the ocean. The ducks became thin and lost their color, becoming almost white. And finally, the toys were found by the dozens exactly where the sea currents would have taken them.

REPORTER: One of the things you mention in your book is the harm that plastics are causing in the ocean. But you say that most of the harm isn't from container ships but rather from other sources, is that right?

DH: Yes, although container ships are responsible for some of the plastic waste in the oceans, in fact most of the plastics are from coastlines with urban waste and garbage dumps, and even fishing fleets. Merchandise from containers lost at sea is just a small portion of the problem.

REPORTER: That's all we have time for today on FRESH AIR. Thank you, Mr. Hohn, for your interesting story.

DH: My pleasure.

Adapted from an interview heard on National Public Radio's programme Fresh Air, March 29, 2011.

1. Where were the lost toy ducks first found?
- ❒ **Alaska**.
- ❒ Canada.
- ❒ China.
- ❒ Oregon.

2. How long did it take the first rubber ducks to surface on a beach after their container was lost at sea?
- ❒ Only three months.
- ❒ **About a year and a half**.
- ❒ four years.
- ❒ almost six years.

3. How many containers with rubber ducks and other toys were lost at sea?
- ❒ **12**.
- ❒ 407.
- ❒ Hundreds and hundreds.
- ❒ Over 28,000.

4. Which of the following best describes the cargo ships discussed in the conversation?
- ❒ They regularly go through the Panama Canal.
- ❒ They mainly navigate between North America and South America.
- ❒ **They carry hundreds of containers above and below deck**.
- ❒ They almost always drop some containers in the sea.

5. Which of the following statements is TRUE?
- ❒ **Large ships are better able to navigate in storms than smaller ships.**
- ❒ The ship lost the toys in the Graveyard of the Pacific.
- ❒ The weather in the North Pacific is so good that few wrecks occur.
- ❒ Sailing ships in the 19th century did not cross the Pacific.

6. What do we know for certain about the accident that resulted in the loss of rubber ducks at sea?
- ❒ It occurred at night.
- ❒ It occurred during the day.
- ❒ It occurred because of an error by the ship's captain.
- ❒ **It occurred when there were high waves.**

7. We can deduce from the conversation that the toys were originally
- ❒ packed in plastic bags.
- ❒ **packed in cardboard boxes**.
- ❒ not individually packed.
- ❒ made out of cardboard.

8. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as an important source of plastics in the oceans?
- ❒ Waste from coastal cities.
- ❒ Fishing boats.
- ❒ Garbage dumps.
- ❒ **Cruise ships.**

Listening comprehension

DO YOU GET ON WELL WITH YOUR SMART PHONE?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

overload: sobrecàrrega / sobrecarga
mindfulness: atenció plena / atención plena
dopamine: dopamina
boost: estimular

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Anne Smith: Hello. My name is Anne Smith, and on today's programme Dr John Thomson is going to help us find out why smart phones are so addictive and how can we break our dependence on them. Can we learn how to renegotiate our relationship with our smart phone?

Anne Smith: Throw your mobile phone hard against a brick wall. Just imagine it. How does it feel for you? What emotions come up in your mind and in your body? What about when you realize you've left your mobile device at home, or in a taxi? Dr Thomson, have we become addicted to our mobile phones?

John Thomson: Well... to a certain extent we are. The well-known example of people sitting around the dinner table, each of them on their phones, is a terrible example of it. But we make a lot of assumptions about technology that aren't quite right.

Anne Smith: What do you mean by that?

John Thomson: Well, one of the assumptions we are making is that this is an inevitable process. We assume that these technologies do a lot of wonderful things for us. For example, they allow us to be in touch with people and get information from all over the globe. But then we also have to become aware that they are related to problems of distraction and information **overload**. I think there are things that we can do about it.

Anne Smith: Can you give us some examples?

John Thomson: Well, we need to observe our behaviour when using technology. Almost everything that human beings do now uses digital technology, whether it's business, entertainment, or socialising. Smart phones have entered all those areas and have become essential. We need to learn to become aware of the effects that our devices are having on us as the basis for figuring out how to use them well.

Anne Smith: So what do you suggest we do?

John Thomson: So really what I'm suggesting is that there is a lot of power in bringing **mindfulness** to our use of these devices to use them in more intentional ways. For example, take the time to observe what we are feeling when we get a text message. We need to learn to change our habits by conscious observation and reflection.

Anne Smith: How can we use our digital devices in ways that are healthier?

John Thomson: Our habits are based on a reward system. We humans have developed such a system as a way to help us find where food is. So on a very simple level, we have to remember where to get food, and before there were grocery stores, our brains had to have mechanisms to learn to remember where food was. From a neurobiological standpoint, reward comes in the form of **dopamine**. So if food is rich in calories, then our stomach sends a signal off to our brain through dopamine that says, hey, remember what you ate and where you found it. This is the way actions become habits.

Anne Smith: And so this same reward mechanism applies to everything?

John Thomson: That's right. Let's take a simple example; stress may make us eat cupcakes or chocolate, and then we feel better, that's the reward, so that becomes a habit. Well, the same thing is true with technology. If we get stressed out and then we go and distract ourselves by surfing the internet on our phone, that temporary distraction gives that same type of temporary reward.

Anne Smith: So we are still being rewarded by that dopamine hit.

John Thomson: Yes, and some of the technologies, for example, email or texting, maximise that type of hit. If we knew that we were going to get an email every 30 seconds, then our brain would start expecting that and would not get the big dopamine hit that it gets with random emails. So this technology basically **boosts** our dopamine system and trains us to develop expectations.

Anne Smith: What can mindfulness training, then, do for us? And how do we develop mindfulness?

John Thomson: For example, I would just say to people "Think about your phone. Don't even take it out yet. Just bring it to mind. What happens when you think about your phone, what happens to your breathing? Does your body posture change? What emotions come up when you think about your phone? And what does it do to the quality of your attention?" So these are the first questions I ask.

Anne Smith: Right, I see...

John Thomson: Then I would say "Now I want you take your phone out, I want you to hold it in your hand. I don't want you to turn it on yet. Notice what's going on with your emotions". Then I ask people to turn on their phone and to open their email inbox, and I tell them to open a message and respond. But I want them to notice what's happening in their mind and body all the time. And finally, I tell them to turn off their phone and put it away and ask them how they feel.

Anne Smith: What are the responses that you usually get from the people who go through this exercise?

John Thomson: Everybody has somewhat different reactions. Some people notice that as soon as they think about their phone, they start to get anxious and then they feel more relaxed when they put the phone away, whereas others feel bad when they have to put it away. By doing this exercise they begin to become aware of their own habits.

Anne Smith: Dr Thomson, many thanks for being with us today and for explaining how mindfulness can help us have a healthier relationship with our mobile phones.

Sources:
Adapted from:
http://www.abc.net.au/radionational/programs/scienceshow/biomechanics-of-movement-improves-animation-and-animal-rehabili/6805750
ABC Radio National (Australian Broadcasting Corporation)

1. According to Dr Thomson,
   - **we are very dependent on mobile phones.**
   - we are addicted to our emotions.
   - technology harms our mind.
   - we should not use our phones while eating.

2. In Dr Thomson's view, which of the following is NOT true?
   - We need to learn to use digital devices intentionally.
   - Mindfulness allows us to observe and reflect on our behaviour.
   - **We should change our text messaging habits to feel better.**
   - We should learn to observe consciously how we feel.

3. In order to understand how to use technology well, we need to
   - **become aware of how devices affect our lives.**
   - have a lot of determination.
   - learn how to carry on business with it.
   - stop using smart phones for entertainment.

4. Our addiction to technology is based on
   - the high levels of dopamine in the food we eat.
   - a neurobiological brain disorder related to eating habits.
   - a mental condition that makes us forget what to do.
   - **a psychological system of reward related to survival.**

5. E-mails can cause a dopamine hit if they are
   - answered intermittently.
   - **received at irregular time intervals.**
   - received at regular time intervals.
   - answered within 30 seconds.

6. To develop mindfulness, Dr Thomson asks people to
   - think about their body before thinking about their phone.
   - take their phone out, hold it and put it away without turning it on.
   - **think about their phone and what happens in their mind and to their body.**
   - think of three questions to ask him.

7. In mindfulness training people are supposed to
   - stop thinking about their own emotions.
   - avoid expressing their own feelings.
   - **develop an awareness of their own habits.**
   - pay close attention to the others in the room.

8. When going through mindfulness training, some people
   - feel anxious when asked to put their phones away.
   - react violently and throw their phone away.
   - **relax when they put phone away.**
   - create bad habits in the use of their phones.

Listening Comprehension

Does High School Start Too Early?

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

public policy: política governamental / política gubernamental
sleep deprived: privat de son / privado de sueño
deprivation: privació / privación
melatonin: melatonina

Presenter (Guy Raz): Does high school start too early? Some experts say teens are **sleep-deprived** because of early school start times that are designed for adults. I'm Guy Raz, and today I'm talking with Dr. Wendy Troxel, Adjunct Professor of Psychiatry and Psycology at the University of Pittsburgh. Dr. Troxel's research focusses on the relationship between sleep and health, as well as the implications for **public policy**.

GUY RAZ (GR): Welcome to the show, Dr. Troxel. If I were to ask you to give me one idea about something that could have a huge impact on kids in schools, what would it be?

WENDY TROXEL (WT): More sleep.

GR: More sleep—that could actually have measurable impact on how well students do at school?

WT: Absolutely, and we have evidence.

GR: Your research focusses on teenagers, so high school-age kids.

WT: Yes. That's right. Kids who get adequate amounts of sleep perform better in school. They're more likely to show up for school on time, have better graduation rates. They're able to think and perform better. Their attention is better. Kids who are sleeping sufficient amounts also have better mental health and physical health, all of which we know goes into the factors that contribute to a whole, healthy child who's able to perform and succeed in school.

GR: This may sound obvious, right? Kids need more sleep.

WT: Yes, but it's not that easy. Sleep **deprivation** among American teenagers is an epidemic. Only about 1 in 10 gets the 8 to 10 hours of sleep per night recommended by sleep scientists and paediatricians. And remember, 8 hours is the minimum recommendation.

GR: And what do you think are the main factors contributing to sleep deprivation?

WT: There are several, but a major factor preventing teens from getting the sleep they actually need is public policy, not hormones, social lives or Snapchat.

GR: Public policy?

WT: Yes. Across the country, many schools are starting around 7:30 a.m. or earlier, despite the fact that major medical organizations recommend that middle and high schools start no earlier than 8:30 a.m. These timetables have a direct effect on HOW MUCH or, in fact, HOW LITTLE sleep American teenagers really get.

GR: Basically what you're saying is that since school starts so early for teens, and obviously they have to wake up much earlier than that to get ready and reach the school before 7:30, they're not going to sleep enough.

WT: Exactly. It's a simple math problem. If you have a school that starts at 7:35 a.m., like my own child's, that means that they're getting on a bus between 6:30 and 6:45 a.m. So if you simply count backwards from the clock, your child has to be going to bed by 10:00 p.m. at the latest. And that's simply not realistic for most teenagers. But the truth of the matter is all this is a decision that was made years and years ago before we knew the consequences of sleep deprivation.

GR: So, according to your research, we're setting teenagers up for failure—failure in their ability to sleep and failure in their ability to perform well at school.

WT: That's exactly right. Adolescence is a period of dramatic brain development, particularly in the parts of the brain that are responsible for those higher order thinking processes, including reasoning, problem solving and good judgment—in other words, the very type of brain activity that's responsible for those impulsive and often risky behaviours that are so characteristic of adolescents.

GR: So, many of the unpleasant characteristics of teenagers, like abrupt changes in mood, irritability, laziness, depression, could actually be a product of chronic sleep deprivation?

WT: Right. Around the time of puberty, teenagers experience a delay in their biological clock, which determines when we feel most awake and when we feel most sleepy. This is caused in part by a shift in the release of the hormone **melatonin**. Teenager's bodies wait to start releasing melatonin until around 11 p.m., which is two hours later than what we see in adults or younger children. This means that waking a teenager up a 6 a.m. is the biological equivalent of waking up an adult at 4 a.m.

GR: But this seems like an easy problem to solve. You just change the start time of schools.

WT: I wish it were that easy. But first let me tell you about some other benefits of later start times.

GR: Sure, please go on.

WT: What we know is that when schools start later, one school district found a 25% reduction in school absences. When we delay start times, children are actually more likely to get the bus. So we see an increase in class attendance, and as a result, an increase in graduation rates.

GR: This must eventually have a direct impact on their lifetime earnings.

WT: Of course. Teens from districts with later start times get more sleep, and not surprisingly, they do better academically. Standardized test scores in math and reading

go up by 2 to 3 percentage points. Their health improves, and even their families are happier.

GR: So in essence what you're saying is the teenage period in our lives is when our biology requires a specific schedule, and that specific schedule involves waking up later.

WT: Exactly. This is a developmental issue. People don't have these shifted sleep-wake schedules for the rest of their lives. It's only during adolescence. Sleep science has clearly shown that there is a change in sleep-wake cycles and teenagers naturally go to bed later and sleep in later. So by depriving them of sleep in adolescence, we're hurting their health and their chances for success.

GR: Thank you, Dr. Troxel. Unfortunately, we're out of time. I'm Guy Raz, and you've been listening to our show about how simple solutions can be the answer to some of our most complex problems.

Adapted from
https://www.npr.org/2017/11/17/564608245/wendy-troxel-does-high-school-start-too-early [November 17, 2017]

1. Studies have shown that teenagers who sleep more
- **do better at school**.
- have earlier start times.
- need treatment for insomnia.
- are less active at school.

2. Approximately what percentage of American teenagers gets enough sleep?
- **10%**
- 20%
- 50%
- 70%

3. Which of the following contributes directly to teens' sleep deprivation?
- **Governmental policy.**
- Hormones.
- Social lives.
- Snapchat.

4. The text claims that for most teenagers, going to bed by 10:00 p.m. is
- a requirement imposed by the school system.
- **not possible.**
- a decision that was made years and years ago.
- setting them up for failure.

5. Reasoning, problem solving and good judgment can be characterized as
- impulsive and risky behaviours.
- **higher order thinking processes.**
- a consequence of sleep deprivation.
- factors preventing cognitive development.

6. According to Dr. Troxel, around the time of puberty
- teenagers feel sleepy around 7 p.m.
- teenagers' bodies start releasing melatonin for two hours.
- **teenagers' biological clocks undergo a change**.
- teenagers' biological clocks wake them up at 4 a.m.

7. Which of the following sentences is TRUE?
When schools start later,
- school absences increase by 25%.
- teens miss the bus more often.
- fewer students graduate on time.
- **standardized test scores improve**.

8. According to Dr. Troxel, the sleep-wake schedule that we experience during adolescence
- lasts for the rest of our lives.
- **is temporary and will change in adulthood.**
- improves our mental and physical health.
- increases our chances for future success.

Listening comprehension

An Interview with a Dancer

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

channel: conduir / conducir
put so much into something: esforçar-se molt / esforzarse mucho
demanding: exigent / exigente
rehearsal: assaig / ensayo
chill out: descansar, relaxar-se / descansar, relajarse
icon: icona / icono

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

PRESENTER (REPORTER): You have probably seen our guest on ITV's new show "Dance" or maybe you have been to the theater where she is now performing 'Aladdin'. After dancing with the ballet company for five years, she is starting to break into principal roles and discover what it means to be at the top of their profession. Otherwise the chances are that you follow her on Instagram… after all, she boasts over 100,000 followers. In today's program, I'm going to interview Claire Petty.

REPORTER: Hi, Anne. Welcome to our programme.

CLAIRE: My pleasure.

REPORTER: **To start, tell us a little about yourself.**

CLAIRE: I started dancing at the age of four, doing ballet, because I had a lot of energy and my mum needed to channel it into something productive! I was very lucky that at the age of 12 I had a teacher that guided me more towards the classical route, and I joined the School of American Ballet in New York when I was 14. I worked with the New York City Ballet my last year at school, and we performed 'Nutcracker' that year, which was an amazing experience. I went back to school that January and on the first day back my head teacher told me I had a job at the Boston Ballet and that I started work the next day—I literally re-packed all my things and hopped on the plane straightaway!

REPORTER: What advice do you wish someone had given you at 15?

CLAIRE: I wish someone had told me not to let people tell me that I can't do something. At school most of my teachers told me dance was a waste of time and that I couldn't make a career out of it. That really upset me because I had put so much into it and my family made a lot of sacrifices. But as I got older, I realised that those people motivated me to prove them wrong and I guess they will always motivate me, because now when people tell me I can't do something, I make sure I **DO** do it.

REPORTER: Ballet is a pretty demanding profession: there are long hours, it's very physical, you have to travel a lot. What motivates you?

CLAIRE: It's just those times on stage where you're either doing a role you love, or you're in a really beautiful theatre, and sometimes you just realise how lucky you are to be doing a job where you absolutely love it, and you're doing your hobby as a career. Those moments push you through. You've done all that hard work in the studio, you've tried to get your technique to the highest standard it can be, and then you just need to enjoy that moment on stage.

REPORTER: There must be a fine balance between relaxing after a long day of rehearsals and thinking over the work you've done that day. How do you manage that?

CLAIRE: Immediately after rehearsal, I like to reflect a little bit on the positive things. There's always going to be something that's gone wrong—I don't think you ever walk away thinking 'well, that was perfect'—but that's the beauty of performing a character role because every day can be different. The way we perform 'Aladdin' in our first show will be different from the way we play it in our second show. That's what's exciting – the growth, and the change, and responding to each other.

REPORTER: You're super busy! What do you do to relax and chill out?

CLAIRE: Ha ha. I have very little free time, which is how I like it—I hate being bored. I go to the movies, hang out with my dance friends, watch TV, listen to music, do all those normal things. It's good to chill out and remind yourself that, as brilliant as ballet is, there's a big world out there.

REPORTER: You've already danced with Justin Bieber and Jennifer Lopez. What has been your career highlight so far?

CLAIRE: Dancing for Justin Bieber and definitely Jennifer Lopez have been major highlights but I'm excited about working with Lady Gaga on her dancing videos for her new album. That's been really cool, and I can't wait for everyone to see what she's been working on!

REPORTER: Which musical icons do you dream about working or dancing with one day?

CLAIRE: I've always wanted to dance for Beyoncé. She's a very talented dancer herself, with so much energy. It's definitely something I would love to do. Being involved with Lady Gaga's music clips and seeing what is involved in the process has opened my eyes to professional dancing outside ballet and I've loved it, so I hope dancing for other musical icons is just as fun. It's lot of hard work but rewarding for sure.

REPORTER: I was following you on Instagram earlier and there's a fan page for you! What's it like going from living a normal life to dealing with the fame that comes with your profile now?

CLAIRE: Ha ha. It's no different, to be honest! Most of the fans are from overseas, so my life here hasn't changed all that much in the past five years. When I go out, a few people recognize me and it's nice, but I'm not that famous.

REPORTER: What's next for you?

CLAIRE: I'm going to the Dominican Republic in August for the World Latin Dance Championship to perform in Jennifer Lopez's show there – I'm very excited about that! We also have stuff happening in Australia after and possibly Switzerland. Then I'm filming the rest of the episodes for "Dance", which I'm looking forward to.

REPORTER: Finally, if you weren't a dancer, what would you be doing?

CLAIRE: I'd quite like to learn something about architecture and interior design because I've always liked drawing, but I've never had time to work on it properly. I've always loved walking into a stylish home. It's my dream to build my own house and decorate it with things from all around the world .

REPORTER: Well, Claire, it's been a pleasure having you here tonight.

CLAIRE: Thank you for inviting me.

Adapted from: https://www.fq.co.nz/missfq/celeb/entertainment/dancer-kaea-pearce-interview-grid [30th November 2017]

1. Why did Claire start doing ballet?
□ A teacher told her she was good at it.
□ **She was a very active child.**
□ Her mother was a ballet producer.
□ She was forced by the head teacher.

2. Which of these sentences is NOT true according to the text?
□ Most of Claire's teachers thought that she would not succeed in dancing.
□ Her family supported her decision and helped her.
□ She is motivated to do the things others think she cannot do.
□ **She liked people to tell her that she couldn't make a career out of dancing.**

3. What motivates Claire to dance?
□ The fact that it is a very demanding job.
□ The joy she has when she is in the studio.
□ **The happiness she feels when she is on stage.**
□ The hobbies she is able to keep thanks to ballet.

4. How does Claire feel after rehearsals?
□ She thinks about the following day's performance.
□ **She thinks of all the positive things in the performance**.
□ She's excited about the things that may go wrong.
□ She reflects on the beauty of the performance.

5. Which of these things does she NOT do to relax?
□ She watches movies.
□ She goes out with her friends.
□ **She dances ballet.**
□ She listens to music.

6. What's her opinion on musical stars?
□ She would only like to work with Justin Bieber and Jennifer Lopez.
□ **She thinks dancing for them is hard work but gratifying.**
□ She can't wait to work with them as she has not worked with them yet.
□ She has worked with Beyoncé and that was a dream came true.

7. Why does Claire not consider herself famous?
□ **Because only some people recognize her.**
□ Because most of her fans are five years old.
□ Because her fan page on Instagram is new.
□ Because five years ago she was very famous.

8. What would Claire like to do if she were not a dancer?
□ She would like to go to Australia to film a movie.
□ She would like to study art and become a painter.
□ **She would like to design houses and especially her own.**
□ She would like to be an actress in a television show.

Listening comprehension

EDUCATION IN THE 21ST CENTURY

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

disabilities: discapacitats / discapacidades
skills: habilitats / habilidades

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Presenter/Interviewer: UNESCO organized the World Education Forum 2015 in the Republic of Korea where over 1,600 participants from 160 countries adopted the Declaration for Education 2030. This declaration sets out a new vision for education for the next fifteen years. Today with us we have Ms Ryan, an expert and researcher in education and one of the participants in the Forum.

Interviewer: Good morning, Ms Ryan. And welcome to the programme.

Ms Ryan: Good morning. And thank you for inviting me

Interviewer: We all know that UNESCO believes that education is a human right for all. So what exactly IS its aim in the next 30 years?

Ms Ryan: UNESCO wants to make sure that all people get an inclusive, quality education. Inclusive education means that children with and without disabilities participate and learn together in the same classes. And all children should have access to high quality teachers, materials, and school. UNESCO also wants to promote lifelong learning opportunities for all; that is, education throughout life. Learning does not finish when we leave school anymore.

Interviewer: And why now? Hasn't this always been important?

Ms Ryan: Of course. But we are now thinking about the many skills that children will need in order to be successful in the 21st century: The ability to collaborate and work in teams, critical thinking skills, oral presentation skills, written communication skills, ability to use technology, willingness to examine civic and global issues, ability to conduct research to learn about issues and concepts. All these are basic skills that a citizen will need in twenty years' time.

Interviewer: Everybody talks a lot about education. Why is education such a common topic in debates now?

Ms Ryan: Our world is changing, and in order to prepare our children for this new world we need to change the way we educate them. We must create a curriculum that will help students to connect with the world and understand the issues facing our world Obviously, teaching in the 21-century is different; never before could learning occur the way in which it does now -- everywhere, all the time, on any possible topic, supporting any possible learning style or preference.

Interviewer: So, what do you think classes will be like in 2030?

Ms Ryan: Schools in the 21st century will become a place for teachers and students to connect with those around them and their community. Teachers in this new environment will talk less while providing students with tools so that they can turn information into knowledge.

Interviewer: I see. So, if we're able to maintain the student's interest in the material by showing how this knowledge applies in the real world, kids will be excited about going to school.

Ms Ryan: Exactly. In this type of classroom, activities and lessons are directly related to the community. Students collaborate with people from different schools and different countries to learn about issues that affect us all.

Interviewer: Are you talking about reaching the whole world? Global education?

Ms Ryan: Well, yes. That's it.

Interviewer: So, you're saying that schools have to make use of technology and multimedia. Students should have full access to technology and, if possible, every student will have a laptop.

Ms Ryan: Right. The lessons are not based on textbooks, instead they are project-based. Skills and content are learned through research and projects, and textbooks are just one of many possible resources. At schools, there will be labs, learning centres, as well as studios for art, music, theatre, and so on. Each classroom will be equipped with a computer or television so that all students can watch school productions as well as presentations from other schools.

Interviewer: Do you think that textbooks will disappear?

Ms Ryan: As I said, textbooks are just one of the many tools we can use in school. But it is true that today's tools make it possible to learn about other countries and people first-hand. Of course, textbooks are still necessary, yet, there is nothing like learning languages, cultures, and communication skills from actually talking to people from other parts of the world.

Interviewer: Sure. They are digital natives after all, aren't they?

Ms Ryan: Yes. That's true. However, today's students have the latest, greatest tools, yet they're only used to calling or texting with family and friends. Even though students are now viewed as digital natives, many do not really produce digital content. While they own expensive devices that can produce blogs, infographics, books, how-to videos, and tutorials, just to name a few, in many classes they are asked to turn those devices off and work with printed handouts and worksheets. Sadly, these papers are simply thrown away once graded. In fact, if given the chance, students can produce beautiful and creative blogs, movies, or digital stories that they can feel proud of and share with others.

Interviewer: So, what's your opinion about mobile phone use in class?

Ms Ryan: When students are encouraged to view their devices as valuable tools that support knowledge, they start using them as such. I remember my first years of teaching when I would not allow mobile phones in class and I'd try to explain

every new vocabulary word or answer each question myself; something I would not even think of doing today! I have seen positive changes ever since I started viewing students' devices as useful aids. In fact, sometimes I even respond by saying "I don't know -- use Google and tell us all!" What a difference in their reactions!

Interviewer: Is there any other advantage you see in the use of these new technologies in class?

Ms Ryan: Technology allows collaboration between teachers and students. Creating digital resources, presentations, and projects together with other educators and students will make classroom activities resemble the real world. Collaboration should go beyond sharing documents via e-mail or creating PowerPoint presentations. Many great ideas never go beyond a conversation or paper copy, which is a great loss! Collaboration globally can change our entire experience!

Interviewer: So how do you see this new school? What will it look like?

Ms Ryan: New schools in the 21st century will be bright and spacious, and kids will have room for group projects and individual assignments. Walls will be hung with student work, and there will be places for students to put on performances for their parents and members of the community.

Interviewer: We've run out of time. Thank you very much for sharing your time with us.

Ms Ryan: My pleasure. Thank you.

Adapted from: http://www.teachercertification.org/a/role-of-education-in-the-21st-century.html and http://www.innovationunit.org/sites/default/files/10%20Ideas%20for%2021st%20Century%20Education.pdf [30th November 2016]

1. What is UNESCO's aim in the next 30 years?
❒ **To provide everyone with good, lifelong education.**
❒ To participate in teachers' and schools' debates on inclusive education.
❒ To promote school attendance in disadvantaged countries.
❒ To provide separate classes for disabled children.

2. Which of these things does Ms Ryan NOT mention as a skill children will need in the 21st century?
❒ **Designing new technology.**
❒ Working cooperatively in groups.
❒ Investigating topics.
❒ Communicating in writing and orally.

3. Why is education a popular topic these days according to Ms Ryan?
❒ Because today we all have different learning styles.
❒ Because there is a new curriculum that we have to follow.
❒ **Because the way people learn today is different from before.**
❒ Because nowadays we take into account different phenomena.

Comentari [JD1]: Put in world has changed

4. What will classes be like in the 21st century, according to Ms Ryan?
❒ The teacher will speak a lot so that the instructions are clearly understood.
❒ The teacher will speak a lot and students will become providers of knowledge.
❒ The students will give information to teachers and will teach each other.
❒ **The students will get information which they will transform into knowledge.**

5. Which of these sentences is NOT correct, according to Ms Ryan?
❒ Children will like going to school if they see a connection to the real world.
❒ Students will work together with students in different schools or places.
❒ **Textbooks will not be used at all and laptops will be the only source of information.**
❒ Schools will have many different types of classrooms: labs, studios, etc.

6. How do most students actually use the latest technological tools they have, according to Ms Ryan?
❒ They design web pages online to show their families.
❒ They write magnificent handouts and worksheets.
❒ They produce blogs and digital stories, which they share.
❒ **They talk to friends and family using chats or texts.**

7. What is Ms Ryan's opinion of the use of mobile phones in class?
❒ S**he is in favour of using them as they are a useful resource.**
❒ Mobile phones should only be used to look up new words.
❒ She is against using them in class as she herself can provide the information.
❒ She was in favour but now she prefers not to use them because of the students' reactions.

8. Which is one of the main advantages of using new technologies in the classroom, according to Ms Ryan?
❒ **To be able to share experiences and ideas like in the real world.**
❒ To have a nice conversation with people abroad via email or chats.
❒ To create PowerPoint presentations to collaborate with other students.
❒ To increase the use of e-books in class.

Plantilla de correcció per a les preguntes d'opció múltiple de l'examen de Llengua estrangera (Comprensió escrita i Comprensió oral)

La puntuació és la que cal traslladar (sense cap arrodoniment) a la graella de la caràtula

Correctes	Incorrectes	Puntuació
8	0	3,00
7	0	2,63
7	1	2,50
6	0	2,25
6	1	2,13
6	2	2,00
5	0	1,88
5	1	1,75
5	2	1,63
5	3	1,50
4	0	1,50
4	1	1,38
4	2	1,25
4	3	1,13
4	4	1,00
3	0	1,13
3	1	1,00
3	2	0,88
3	3	0,75
3	4	0,63
3	5	0,50
2	0	0,75
2	1	0,63
2	2	0,50
2	3	0,38
2	4	0,25
2	5	0,13
2	6	0,00
1	0	0,38
1	1	0,25
1	2	0,13
1	3	0,00
1	4	0,00
1	5	0,00
1	6	0,00
1	7	0,00
0	--	0,00

Listening comprehension

U.S. NATIONAL PARKS: YELLOWSTONE

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

geyser: guèiser / géiser
bison: bisó americà / bisonte americano
elk: cérvol del Canadà / alce
browse: pasturar / pacer
beaver: castor
dam: dic / dique
endangered species: espècie en perill d'extinció / especie en peligro de extinción
to thrive: prosperar
carcasses: carronya / carroña

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Presenter (Christopher Brown): Hello and welcome to "The real world", our weekly programme about nature. My name is Christopher Brown, and today we travel to the western United States, to Yellowstone National Park. With me today is Dr. Catherine Smith, a professor at Montana State University and an expert on the history and development of Yellowstone.

Christopher Brown (CB): Good morning, Dr. Smith. Can you tell me a little bit about Yellowstone National Park?

Catherine Smith (**CS**): Good morning, and thank you for inviting me. Yellowstone is the nation's oldest national park and was established shortly after the end of the Civil War, when Ulysses S. Grant was President. The park is located in three states, Montana, Idaho, and Wyoming, and covers almost 9,000 km^2. The park is probably best known for its **geysers**—those hot springs that eject lots of water and steam, and its wildlife. The park has large populations of bears, **bison**, **elk**, and importantly, wolves.

CB: Why are wolves so important?

CS: Wolves are a vital part of the Yellowstone ecosystem. You know, not so long ago there were no wolves in the park at all.

CB: None at all? How's that? I thought wolves were all over this part of the Rocky Mountains.

CS: You're right, wolves have always lived in this area. But by the 1920s, most had been killed by hunters. People often think of the mass shootings of American bison because of Hollywood movies, but in fact wolves were hunted with more determination than any other animal in American history. Officially, the last wolves in the park were killed in 1926.

CB: And what has happened since then? How did wolves come back to the park?

CS: Well, in the 1940s and 1950s, biologists began to realize that the absence of wolves was a problem. The elk population began to increase tremendously, because wolves are natural predators of elk and without them, the elk multiplied.

CB: Why would an increase in the population of elk be a problem? I mean, elk are native to this area too, aren't they?

CS: Yes, of course, but scientists saw that there were too many elk for the habitat. Yellowstone has long, hard winters, with lots of snow. Without the wolves, the elk did not need to move around very much to

look for food because they were not being threatened. So the elk stayed in places with lots of young trees and branches that were above the snow, and ate them—they **browsed**, as we biologists say—and as a result, certain types of trees would no longer grow in some areas because the elk had eaten all the young ones. And this was devastating for **beavers**, which depended on those branches to survive during the winter. The elk had eaten them all.

CB: There was a problem with beavers, too? I thought that the beaver population was stable after people stopped wearing beaver coats and hats.

CS: Well, ecosystems are incredibly complex. Beavers were disappearing from Yellowstone because their food supply was limited since the elk ate so much. Today the beaver population is growing, and beavers are building new **dams** and ponds all over the park. The park is experiencing much less erosion and plant loss. And one of the main reasons for the increase in the number of beavers and plants is the Yellowstone Wolf Project.

CB. So in essence, are you saying that the wolves saved the beavers and trees? Could you tell us a little more about this project?

CS: Sure. In the 1990s biologists in Yellowstone began exploring the idea of bringing Canadian wolves to the park. In January 1995, the first eight wolves arrived from Alberta, Canada. Today we have about a hundred wolves. About 10 years ago we had a peak of 174 wolves, but in the past ten years some hunting has been permitted because wolves were no longer classified as an **Endangered Species**. The wolf population is stable now.

CB: It sounds like an interesting project. Was everyone in favour of it? I mean, in the western part of the United States there are a lot of ranches with cattle, and wolves are known to attack cattle. I can imagine that the ranch owners were not too happy.

CS: In fact, this project has been called the most controversial project in the history of the U.S. National Park Service. Depending on your point of view, the revival of wolf populations in Yellowstone is either one of the greatest wildlife restoration projects ever undertaken, or the worst idea that the government has ever had for ranchers and hunters. It's a real source of debate here. A 2010 study by the U.S. Department of Agriculture showed that only a little more than 2% of cattle deaths were caused by predators. In fact, government studies have shown that between 1991 and 2005, coyotes, dogs and mountain lions, not wolves, were the main killers of cattle.

CB: And how do you feel about the project? Now that you've been able to see and study the consequences over twenty years, would you do it again?

CS: Absolutely, reintroducing wolves to Yellowstone has been very successful. Most scientists agree that a wide diversity of species is a healthy thing for the larger community of animals. The return of the wolf has helped other animals to **thrive**. Bears, coyotes, foxes, and even birds like eagles eat **carcasses**. All those meat-eaters benefit from the protein the wolves leave on the landscape. We have more trees than 20 years ago. And the increase in beavers has helped the rivers. So in my opinion, the project has had a very positive impact.

CB: Our time is up for today. Thank you, Dr. Smith, for joining us today on "The real world".

CS: My pleasure.

Adapted from an article by Kate Tobin on the PBS News Hour https://www.pbs.org/newshour/science/wolves-greenthumbs-yellowstone.

Listening comprehension

1. When was Yellowstone National Park created?
   - Right before the Civil War.
   - **Soon after the Civil War.**
   - at the beginning of the 19th century.
   - at the turn of the 20th century.

2. By 1930, the number of wolves in Yellowstone was
   - high (> 150).
   - low (< 20).
   - **zero.**
   - unknown.

3. In the 1950s, the number of elk in Yellowstone
   - **increased.**
   - decreased.
   - remained stable.
   - was unknown.

4. In the winter, the elk in Yellowstone feed on
   - beavers.
   - birds.
   - **branches.**
   - nothing because they hibernate.

5. One result of the presence of wolves in Yellowstone is
   - fewer eagles in the park.
   - fewer trees in the park.
   - more elk in the park.
   - **more plants in the park.**

6. The wolves that were taken to Yellowstone in the 1990s were brought from
   - Alaska.
   - **Canada.**
   - Montana.
   - Wyoming.

7. Why has the wolf population in Yellowstone gone down from 174 to about 100 in the past 10 years?
   - Because there was not enough food for the wolves in the park.
   - Because the winters were especially hard and as a result, many wolves died.
   - **Because some wolves were killed by hunters.**
   - Because some wolves were poisoned by ranchers.

8. Catherine Smith believes that the Yellowstone Wolf Project
   - **a successful wildlife restoration project.**
   - a terrible idea of the U.S. government.
   - proves that wolves are a danger for cattle ranches.
   - has had little effect on the park.

Plantilla de correcció per a les preguntes d'opció múltiple de l'examen de Llengua estrangera (Comprensió escrita i Comprensió oral)

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2	5	0,13
2	6	0,00
1	0	0,38
1	1	0,25
1	2	0,13
1	3	0,00
1	4	0,00
1	5	0,00
1	6	0,00
1	7	0,00
0	--	0,00

LISTENING COMPREHENSION

JENNIFER RAZ: So let's get just a little bit more creative about what's on our plates because that's what Marcel Dicke does. About once a week, Marcel and his wife have what some might consider an unusual ingredient with dinner—insects.

DICKE: And it's something that we put, for instance, over a rice dish or in the vegetables or in salad.

RAZ: What do you buy, like, which ones?

DICKE: We have three species that are for sale in the Netherlands. That is locusts, crickets and mealworms.

RAZ: Yup - bugs, which, for the record, do not taste like chicken.

DICKE: Quite often, they taste like nuts.

RAZ: And you buy them alive?

DICKE: No. We buy them, at this moment, freeze-dried. You can bake them, or you can fry them, or you can boil them.

RAZ: Marcel Dicke is an entomologist. He studies - and eats - bugs. And he's actually written a whole insect cookbook with dishes like...

DICKE: Pancakes with
mealworms.

RAZ: And for lunch...

DICKE: A quiche with mealworms in it.

RAZ: And of course, dessert.

DICKE: Chocolate topped with locusts.

RAZ: OK. Those dishes might be a little unusual. But eating insects actually isn't so strange, is it, because a lot of people around the world do so every day.

DICKE: About 2 billion people on this planet eat insects, so that's about 30 per cent that do that on a regular basis.

RAZ: Even if you're not eating whole crickets or caterpillars, you are still eating insects. You just don't always know it.

DICKE: Every one of us eats insects. It's impossible not to eat insects.

RAZ: Even if we don't want to?

DICKE: Even if you don't want to. And I'll give you an example.
RAZ: Okay, please.

DICKE: Tomato ketchup? Now and then, there will be one tomato that has a worm in it. And, well, not all of those will be removed in the production process. And so a part of them will end up in the ketchup.

RAZ: So you're saying that chocolate, peanut butter, noodles - almost any processed food — has a small dose of insects. And in the not-too-distant future, do you think that we all might need to eat bugs out of necessity?

DICKE: The human population is growing very rapidly. It will grow to about 9 billion in 2050. How are we going to feed this world? We will have a third more mouths to feed. And as the world population is increasing, it's also getting wealthier. And anyone who gets wealthier starts to eat more meat. A meat effect is something that costs a lot for our agricultural production because, at the moment, 70 per cent of all our agricultural land is being used to produce livestock. We can increase productivity a little, but we'll still reach our limit very soon. We could do much better if we changed from meat to insects.

RAZ: So, you see insects not only as a good alternative to meat but as the future of food?

DICKE: Absolutely.

RAZ: Really?
DICKE:
Insects are an excellent alternative because they need much less land than what's needed to produce regular livestock. Livestock is so inefficient because for 1 kilogram of beef that you will get on your plate, you need about 25 kilograms of feed. Insects are doing a much better job. You need only about 2.2 kilograms of feed for 1 kilogram of cricket meat. So if we are going to be forced to produce food in a more efficient way, then switching from regular meat and livestock to insects is a very logical thing to do. And even in terms of calories, it's very good. One kilogram of grasshoppers has the same amount of calories as 10 hot dogs or six Big Macs.

RAZ: Professor Dicke, I see one pretty significant problem with all of this.

DICKE: What problem would that be?

RAZ: It's gross, insects are disgusting. How could you eat them?

DICKE: Yeah, that's the thing that comes to mind most often. But if you rethink it very seriously, you look at an insect - you take a locust or a cricket and you take away the wings and the legs and then you put that next to a nice shrimp - if you look at them, they're basically the same. And even from a biological point of view, they're very close relatives.

RAZ: But - (laughter) but I can't even - I'm trying to be mindful and imagining biting into

a locust. And it's just - I can't get there.

DICKE: But when sushi was first sold in the markets in the United States, eating raw fish was not something well accepted. Now you can eat sushi everywhere.

RAZ: Yes, that's true.

DICKE: So there's all kinds of foods that maybe at the beginning aren't easily accepted by everybody, but often they become popular after a while.

RAZ: So if - if actually, you know, let's say we could get over this sort of cultural aversion in the West to eating lots of insects and let's say that we just ate enough to really reduce our consumption of chicken and beef and pork and, you know, lamb, what would happen?

DICKE: I think we would have a world population with a sustainable production of animal protein. And ideally we would have a world population that would eat less meat. But it would also be good if we replaced at least part of our animal protein with new meats. And with this, I think, we would see a bigger variety of foods on our dinner table. We can make life even more enjoyable by having a bigger variety of foods to eat.

RAZ: Thank you professor Dicke. I'm Jennifer Raz, and you've been listening to our show about food this week.

1. Marcel Dickie and his wife…

❒ usually have a rice dish with vegetables for dinner.
❒ eat insects for dinner because they taste like chicken.
❒ **have insects for dinner about once a week.**
❒ have three species of insects for dinner every week.

2. Which of these sentences is TRUE?

❒ **The species of insects for sale in the Netherlands are freeze-dried**.
❒ The species of insects for sale in the Netherlands are from farms.
❒ You can buy lots of species of insects in the Netherlands.
❒ You can buy edible insects alive in the Netherlands.

3**. Which of these dishes does not appear in Marcel Dickie's cookbook**?
❒ Pancakes with mealworms.
❒ A quiche with mealworms.
❒ Chocolate topped with locusts.
❒ **Chicken with bugs.**

4. According to Professor Marcel Dickie…
❒ eating insects might be a little unusual.
❒ **about 30 per cent of the population eat insects on a regular basis.**
❒ about 2 billion people want to eat insects regularly.
❒ about 30 per cent of the people don't know they are eating insects.

5. Insects are the future of food because…
❒ only 70 per cent of all agricultural land is used to produce livestock.
❒ **they need much less agricultural land than livestock.**
❒ the land used to produce livestock will be limited to 70%.
❒ they are very expensive to produce on a large scale.

6. Insects are a good alternative to regular meat because…
❒ they have better quality protein**.**
❒ **they are low in calories**.
❒ they take little time to cook.
❒ they can be eaten frozen.

7. From a biological point of view…
❒ **locusts, crickets and shrimps are closely related.**
❒ a locust and a cricket are the same as a shrimp with wings and legs.
❒ locusts and crickets are nicer than shrimps.
❒ when you look at a shrimp you look at an insect.

8. According to Marcel Dickie, if we could get over the cultural aversion in the West to eating insects…
❒ **the world population would eat less meat.**
❒ dinner tables would be more enjoyable.
❒ the world population would eat less animal proteins.
❒ new meats would be replaced on dinner tables.

8) Although the main medical professions support a 20% tax on sugary drinks, the government has decided
   a) to ignore the proposal made by the doctors.
   b) to study the proposal carefully before taking any move.
   c) to promote optional actions among the food industry.
   d) to ban soft drink advertising.

Listening comprehension

DOES HANDWRITING HAVE A FUTURE?

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure that you know what they mean.

skill habilitat/habilidad
evolving en evolució / en evolución
die out desaparèixer/ desaparecer
carving escolpir / esculpir
tool eina / herramienta
lecture conferència / conferencia

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Presenter

Does handwriting have a future? Finland and many American states have removed handwriting from the curriculum. But many psychologists believe writing still has an important role to play in cognitive development. So what's the truth? My name is Antony Brown interviews Professor Anne Downey, author of the forthcoming book *The Uncertain Future of Handwriting*.

Text adapted from an ABC radio interview

[Now listen to the interview]

Antony: Hello, welcome to *Future Tense*. I have to confess it's been years since I've hand-written a letter or even sent a Christmas card. In today's programme, we put the question "Does handwriting have a future?" to our expert, Professor Anne Downey.

Anne: It's a very interesting question. Today we have many alternative ways of recording our thoughts and of communicating. So, in a way, younger generations don't

use handwriting in the way perhaps we did a generation ago or, even sometimes, they don't use handwriting at all.

Antony: What do you mean by that?

Anne: I mean that they text or they type but usually they text. So they particularly don't use handwriting at all anymore. In fact, I would say that for the day-to-day stuff, absolutely everybody texts, not just the younger generations.

Antony: Well, then if most people use technology much more than they would use handwriting for even the simplest of daily tasks, the question is, should we keep handwriting?

Anne: Well, the first thing is that handwriting actually in some way stimulates cognitive processing. By that I mean it helps us to learn, it helps us retain information, it helps us develop other skills such as reading, and it's even been found to help with mathematics. Handwriting is as personal as the clothes you wear, it's something which is part of you.

Antony: So, you believe that handwriting is actually better than texting or typing. So we should continue to teach it.

Anne: Yes, absolutely. And there seems to be pretty solid evidence that handwriting in preschool changes the brain, that there is a link between handwriting and learning how to read. Handwriting is a skill which has to be taught. If we don't teach it, it will die out.

Antony: But, what about the link between typing and learning to read? Or is handwriting unique in its ability to help us to develop our reading skills?

Anne: There is no evidence out there that tablets and computers are having an effect on reading.

Antony: Well, you also say that handwriting changes the brain, then ..., if our brain is highly adaptable, is it possible that over time our brains will change because of the use of technology?

Anne: It is true that digital technologies will become more common, and so sure, we probably will adjust to them, but adaptation is going to take a long, long time. Writing has gone through many changes in the 6,000 years since humans have been writing.

Antony: So texting or typing is simply another step, you would say, in the evolving history of the way in which we communicate.

Anne: Exactly. For instance, if you look back at the Roman world, carving on stone is something that used to be done much more than it is now. We've lost many things in the history of writing.

Antony: The big question, I suppose, is how does it change the way in which you communicate?

Anne: This is a very good question. We have to remember that the technology itself is really changing all the time and I think that we should be looking way beyond text and type to a new stage of communication.

Antony: A next stage of communication? What do you mean by that?

Anne: I started noticing, you know, people walking down the streets and they'd be talking into their phones and they were not talking to a person, they were dictating a text message, or an email. They were composing texts.

Antony: So, you mean that people have now started to compose text on their phones with their voice?

Anne: Exactly. If you speak in a clear voice you can generate an email, a text message, a note to yourself on a mobile device. So, we are starting to see a new practice, voice dictation, writing text by speaking it. I call it "voice writing".

Antony: So, if people are going to be doing composition with their voice, could we train them to do it well, in the same way that when we teach people to handwrite?

Anne: Right now we know little about handwriting and typing. If you want to take notes, if you want to understand what someone is telling you in a lecture, research seems to suggest that it's better to write by hand because you go more slowly but you think more about what's actually there, even if you go more slowly. If you type, you'll tend to just transcribe the contents, you won't think about the meaning as much. So we could now start to think of the situations when writing with your voice might be the best cognitive tool.

Antony: But when you look at the amount of time in schools that is put into communication, that's put into things like writing, presumably some of that is going to have to change, isn't it?

Anne: Well, one of the things that we forget is that we've always had multiple channels to enter information into computers. The fact that we use keyboards today doesn't mean that we will use keyboards forever. I think it's somewhat naive to think that handwriting is just going to disappear in the near future.

Antony: Thank you very much for sharing your time with us.

Anne: My pleasure. Thank you.

Adapted from: http://www.abc.net.au/radionational/programs/futuretense/does-handwriting-have-a-future3f/6738582#transcript

[6th September 2015]

1. The younger generations …
   - ❒ use handwriting in class only.
   - ❒ used to type or text but they don't anymore.
   - ❒ don't text or type at all anymore.
   - ❒ **don't use handwriting anymore**.

2. Which of the following sentences is NOT correct?
   - ❒ Handwriting stimulates cognitive processing.
   - ❒ **Handwriting helps us develop information**.
   - ❒ Handwriting is personal.
   - ❒ Handwriting helps us to learn.

3. According to the expert,
   - ❒ there is no link between handwriting and teaching.
   - ❒ there is no need to teach handwriting.
   - ❒ **if we don't teach handwriting, it will disappear.**
   - ❒ handwriting and teaching will die out.

4. There is no evidence that tablets and computers are having an effect on
   - ❒ handwriting.
   - ❒ **reading**.
   - ❒ typing.
   - ❒ texting.

5. Humans
   - ❒ haven't changed writing for 6.000 years.
   - ❒ haven't changed writing for 16.000 years.
   - ❒ have been writing for 16.000 years.
   - ❒ **have been writing for 6.000 years**.

6. Romans
   - ❒ carved on a used stone.
   - ❒ used to look back when carving on stone.
   - ❒ **used to carve on stone**.
   - ❒ didn't carve on stone.

7. According to the expert, which one of the following practices cannot be considered as "voice writing"?
   - ❒ Dictating an email on a mobile device.
   - ❒ **Dictating a note to a person on a mobile device**.
   - ❒ Dictating a note to yourself on a mobile device.
   - ❒ Dictating a text message on a mobile device.

8. When taking notes in a lecture, the research seems to suggest that it's better to …
   - ❒ type because you just transcribe and don't think about the meaning.
   - ❒ write with your voice because it might be the best cognitive tool.
   - ❒ type because you don't go so slowly and think about the meaning.
   - ❒ **write by hand because you think more about the contents**.

Listening Comprehension

Salvador Dalí's Cookbook

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

***gold-leaf*:** full d'or / hoja de oro
***velvet**:* vellut / terciopelo
***peacock**:* paó reial / pavo real
*to **clog**: obstruir*
***lean**:* magre, sense greix / magra, sin grasa
***canvas**:* llenç / lienzo

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

If you're of a certain age or if you love surrealist art, then you probably remember Salvador Dalí. He was widely known for his celebrity persona, his pointy mustache and his paintings filled with melting clocks and exotic deserts. But did you know that Dali also enjoyed exotic desserts? Turns out that the artist published a cookbook in the early 1970s. It was called "Les Diners De Gala" or "The Dinners of Gala," named for his wife. In the following interview, journalist Hank Ghazi talks to publisher Alexi Horowitz, who is preparing a facsimile of the original.

Now listen to the interview

HANK GHAZI: Welcome to our program, Ms Horowitz, and thank you very much for accepting our invitation.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Thank you very much for inviting me. It is a pleasure being here.
HANK GHAZI: Most of us know Salvador Dalí as one of the greatest artists of the 20th century, but I'm sure most people would be surprised to find out that he also published a cookbook.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Well, in a way we could say that this book is also a work of art. It isn't your typical cookbook. The original edition was a **gold-leafed** collection of exotic French recipes. The book was published just once so it immediately became a rare collector's item.
HANK GHAZI: Is that why you decided to republish it?
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Yes, I discovered it in an old bookstore in Germany over 30 years ago and I found it fascinating. Ever since then I have fantasized about republishing it.
HANK GHAZI: So this must be a pretty unique cookbook in many ways.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: It is completely unique and unexpected. Starting with the fact that it begins with a warning.
HANK GHAZI: A warning?
ALEXI HOROWITZ: "Les Diners de Gala" is devoted to the pleasures of taste. If you're one of those calorie counters who turn the joys of eating into a form of punishment, close this book at once. It's too lively, too aggressive and far too impertinent for you.
HANK GHAZI: I didn't know that Dalí had a particular interest in food?
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Food was actually a common element in his paintings, and he and his wife were known for their dinner parties. In one of those parties the painter dressed his wife in a unicorn's head while she presided over the table from a red **velvet** bed.

On the menu that night, fish was served in slippers and live frogs were jumping from the plates.
HANK GHAZI: You mention in the introduction to the book that when he was six years old, Dalí wanted to be a cook.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Yes, that is true. But then at age 8 he wanted to be Napoleon! Eventually, it was another of his childhood passions, painting, that he would become most famous for.
HANK GHAZI: So tell us a little bit about the kinds of recipes that we can find in the book.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: The recipes came from some of the most exclusive restaurants in Paris, and the book itself was opulent, filled with erotic paintings, sketches of exotic animals and dreamlike photographs of Dali surrounded by enormous pyramids of lobsters, **peacocks** and decadent dishes.
HANK GHAZI: So not the kinds of dishes we would prepare at home on a regular day...
ALEXI HOROWITZ: No, not exactly. All of them are filled with cream sauces and organ meats and puff pastry. These are dishes to **clog** your arteries just by looking at the pictures!! Not exactly for the calorie conscious!!
HANK GHAZI: Nothing like a green salad with avocado...
ALEXI HOROWITZ: No, not at all! It is very heavily meat based. And not exactly **lean** meats like chicken breast, but rather things like goose meat fried in duck fat or pig ear stews!
HANK GHAZI: It is also true that culinary tastes have changed a lot in the last 40 years and that people back then were not as concerned about what they ate as we are now.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Absolutely. Also, you have to remember that this is a cookbook by one of the most amazing and surprising artists of his time, so you cannot expect anything simple even for those days.
HANK GHAZI: Of course. Like his paintings, they are probably surreal in many ways.
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Yes, and you can tell that many of the recipes are there because of the visual impact. In some ways, they are like small paintings that can be eaten.
HANK GHAZI: Have you considered adapting some of the recipes to more modern tastes?
ALEXI HOROWITZ: No, we wanted to keep it as close to the original as possible, with all its excess and decadence. Adapting it to modern culinary tendencies would have been like going against the spirit of Dalí.
HANK GHAZI: How about the gold-leafed pages?
ALEXI HOROWITZ: We thought a lot about that and in the end we decided to publish a very small number of those, exactly as they were published in the early 1970s. But we also wanted to make the book available to a larger audience, so we will also be publishing a simplified version. It will still have all the recipes, drawings and pictures, but there will be no gold and it will also be much cheaper.
HANK GHAZI: Do you think many people will try the recipes?
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Probably not, among other reasons because it could be difficult for most people these days to find a lot of the ingredients. But, as I said before, the book is a tribute to the author's amazing mind and his endless creativity. We have to remember that Salvador Dalí saw the entire world as his **canvas**, and the dinner table was no exception.
HANK GHAZI: Well thank you so much for this fascinating conversation. We will certainly be looking forward to getting a copy of "Les Diners de Gala", though maybe not the gold edition!
ALEXI HOROWITZ: Thank you very much for having me.

ADAPTED FROM NPR, ALL THINGS CONSIDERED, AIRED DECEMBER 2016

1.When did Alexi find out about the book?
❒ While looking for exotic French recipes.
❒ While talking to a publisher.
❒ While she was in a 30 year-old bookstore.
❒ **While looking at old books in Germany.**

2. Which of the following statements is true?
❒ The book turns the joy of eating into a form of punishment.
❒ In one of their dinner parties, they served a unicorn's head.
❒ **Dalí often showed food in his paintings.**
❒ Gala used to preside over the table in red velvet slippers.

3. When he was eight years old, Dalí…
❒ **wanted to be Napoleon.**
❒ wanted to be a cook.
❒ knew he would become a painter
❒ didn't have any passions.

4. Which of the following are not part of the book?
❒ Drawings of exotic animals.
❒ Photographs of the painter with peacocks.
❒ **Sketches of restaurants in Paris.**
❒ Pyramids of lobsters and decadent dishes.

5. Which of the following best describes the recipes in the book?
❒ **Meat is a very important ingredient in most of them.**
❒ They are indicated for people who are calorie-conscious.
❒ They mix goose meat with chicken breast and salad.
❒ Avocados are served with cream sauces.

6. In what ways do the recipes resemble Dalí's paintings?
❒ Some of his small paintings could be eaten.
❒ Interpretations of both have changed a lot in the last 40 years.
❒ They both can be adapted to more modern tastes.
❒ **They both share a desire to create a visual impact.**

7. How many versions of the book will be published?
❒ One, exactly as it was published in the early 70s.
❒ **Two, one with gold leaf and one without it.**
❒ One, with all the recipes but cheaper than the original.
❒ Two, one with all the recipes and one with just a selection,

8. How did Dalí view the dinner table?
❒ As a collection of hard-to-find ingredients.
❒ It was an exception to his endless creativity.
❒ **As a canvas, just like the rest of the world.**
❒ He thought it was a tribute to his book.

Listening Comprehension

INTERVIEW WITH A SCRIPTWRITER

Narrator: Cliff Dorfman is a film scriptwriter who has worked in the TV series *Entourage* and the film *Warrior*. He is also an actor and a film director. He started working in the early 1990s, and has not stopped since. Right now, he also teaches writing at UCLA (University of California in Los Angeles). In this interview, he talks to a reporter of *Filmmaker* magazine.

[Now listen to the interview.]

Reporter: We are here today with Cliff Dorfman, who is many things: actor, film director, scriptwriter, teacher… Today we want to talk to him about his writing. Good evening, Cliff.

Cliff Dorfman: Good evening!

Reporter: Let's start at the very beginning. What is the first story you ever wrote?

Cliff Dorfman: You'll be surprised… my first story was the beginning of a novel which I wrote when I was around 11 years old. I handwrote at least 50 pages on a notebook that I kept inside my desk drawer in my bedroom. Somehow, though, it got lost. I have no idea what happened to it.

Reporter: That's a pity! Growing up, what movies or stories inspired your creativity?

Cliff Dorfman: From early on it was Greek mythology. I was, and still am in a lot of ways, obsessed with it. Then I moved to classic literature (Shakespeare, Dickens, to name a couple) and then films, especially American films.

Reporter: What about modern literature? It doesn't inspire you?

Cliff Dorfman: I have to admit that I don't read anything "modern"…

Reporter: Imagine that you were not a well-known writer, how would you make directors and producers read your screenplay?

Cliff Dorfman: Well, I have never had any problems with that myself, so I don't really know what to say. However, some friends of mine have told me how they do it.

Reporter: So, how do they do it?

Cliff Dorman: Well, according to them, you must follow the work of other writers and directors that you find interesting. Then get in touch with them through the Internet. In this digital age, it's easier than ever to contact people: e-mail, webpages, Facebook, Twitter… Once you've made contact, you can send them your script directly.

Reporter: What experiences from your life influence your characters?

Cliff Dorfman: Every single one. Every person I know, have ever known or even **run into** for an instant. Every experience I've ever had. My family. My friends. My relationships. Everything. I sit around public places and listen to other people's conversations. If they interest me, I sometimes record them or write down things they say.

Reporter: How emotionally involved are you with the characters you create?

Cliff Dorfman: Oh, they live with me the entire time I'm writing them. I can be out with friends, at a dinner, on a date and I'm sitting there thinking to myself, well, how would my character react now? They're all around me except when I sleep, fortunately!

Reporter: What is the most important aspect of building a great character?

Cliff Dorfman: Many things: life experience, including **weird** eating habits. Physical aspects are also extremely important. We are constantly doing things with our bodies that reflect the way that we feel and what we think.

Reporter: Do you write an outline before you actually start writing?

Cliff Dorfman: Sometimes. I don't particularly like doing it, but certain stories **demand** it.

Reporter: Now I'd like to ask you about your favourite films. What type of structure do these films usually have?

Cliff Dorfman: They completely vary. The structure in *Goodfellas* is one I love: instead of starting at the beginning and going until the end, it starts in the middle, and goes backwards and forwards. Very interesting. But the film I love the most, though, is *Pulp Fiction*. Brilliant…

Reporter: During the writing process, do you ever find that your characters start to speak for themselves?

Cliff Dorfman: Always. If they don't speak for themselves, then I'm sure I've done something wrong.

Reporter: Does dialogue come easily, or is it difficult for you?

Cliff Dorfman: No! None of it comes easily. It's all painful. Everything in writing a script is very, very hard.

Reporter: What about your daily routine when you're writing? Do you have one?

Cliff Dorfman: Working out is a huge part of it. I do boxing and yoga. I go to the gym, but I'm not very fond of jogging. Other things that also help are putting my phone away, turning it off and leaving it in another room.

Reporter: Have you ever experienced writer's block? That is, have you ever found yourself totally unable to write?

Cliff Dorfman: Oh yes! I think it happens to all writers, and it's really awful! You sit in front of the computer, hour after hour, and you don't write a single word. Very frustrating. Very depressing.

Reporter: And so, how did you overcome it?

Cliff Dorfman: Well, I have to admit that I've tried a lot of things: keeping a strict routine, meditation, writing on paper, using a notebook, working with colleagues. Finally, what worked for me was camping a few days alone in the woods. When I came back, I could write again.

Reporter: Interesting! Screenwriting is obviously a solitary job. How do you deal with it? Is it hard to be alone so much?

Cliff Dorfman: As a matter of fact, I like being alone and working alone, although it can get hard sometimes. When you work in an office, you can discuss things with people, or even get mad at them. When you work alone, you have to do all these things with yourself! But it's not really a problem for me.

Reporter: Well, I'm glad to hear that, Cliff. Thank you very much for the interview.

Cliff Dorfman: You're welcome!

INTERVIEW WITH A SCRIPTWRITER

1. The first story that Cliff Dorfman ever wrote…
❒ was a whole novel.
❒ **was handwritten.**
❒ is still in a drawer.
❒ had less than 50 pages.

2. What was Cliff Dorfman NOT inspired by?
❒ Greek mythology.
❒ **Modern novels.**
❒ Shakespeare.
❒ American movies.

3. According to Cliff Dorfman, if you want your script to be read you must …
❒ follow writers and directors everywhere.
❒ **contact writers and directors.**
❒ visit writers and directors.
❒ be active in Facebook and Twitter.

4. Which of the following statements is TRUE?
❒ Cliff Dorfman finds it extremely hard to write about characters.
❒ Cliff Dorfman never listens to other people talking outside his home.
❒ **Everything in Cliff Dorfman's life influences his characters.**
❒ Cliff Dorfman never goes out with friends during the writing process.

5. Cliff Dorfman's characters…
❒ all have strange eating habits.
❒ are constantly moving.
❒ **are part of his life.**
❒ appear in his dreams.

6. What does Cliff Dorfman say about the films he likes?
❒ **His favourite is *Pulp Fiction* .**
❒ They all follow a chronological order.
❒ They all have the same structure.
❒ His favourite is *Goodfellas*.

7. Which of the following is NOT part of Cliff Dorfman's routine?
❒ Yoga.
❒ Boxing.
❒ Going to the gym.
❒ **Jogging.**

8. How did Cliff Dorfman overcome writer's block?
❒ He stopped using a notebook.
❒ He tried many things, but nothing worked.
❒ **He spent a few days alone in the forest.**
❒ He went camping with his friends.

Listening Comprehension

FOOD IN SPACE

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

***crave*:** desitjar / desear
***sour**:* agre / agrio
***Charlie Brown**: personatge de còmic/ personaje de cómic*
***stuffy**:* tapada / tapada
***cramped**:* apretat / apretado

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

_____

NARRATOR: If you're planning to take a long space voyage, say nine months or so to Mars, here's some advice: bring Tabasco or the hot sauce of your choice. That's because there's evidence that astronauts like to eat spicy food in space. And since NASA likes to keep its astronauts happy, the space agency is asking food scientists to help them create a better menu for future missions. Our correspondent, Joe Sexton, talks to Professor Jean Hunter from Cornell University about the reasons behind this request.

Now listen to the interview

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JOE SEXTON: Jean Hunter is a food engineer at Cornell University. She's one of the scientists who will be helping NASA design the menu for future space voyagers. Welcome to our program, Professor Hunter.

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Hello and thank you very much for inviting me.

JOE SEXTON: It seems after some time in space, astronauts start **craving** foods they might never have liked on Earth. So what kind of foods do astronauts **crave** while they're in space?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: They crave peppers. They crave **sour** and sweet things.

JOE SEXTON: Besides a taste for hot peppers, what other kinds of foods do astronauts prefer when they are away from Earth?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Foods that rely on smell are less preferred.

JOE SEXTON: Really? Why is that?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: That's because most of our sense of taste is based on smell, so food that is only pleasurable for its smell isn't as good in space. For example, many people don't know that the pleasure of coffee comes mostly from its aroma.

JOE SEXTON: What do you mean by that? Are you saying that coffee has no taste?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Well, not exactly, but if you hold your nose while drinking coffee, you'll realize that you're getting just a bitter liquid without much taste at all.

JOE SEXTON: So why do we lose our sense of smell in space?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: No one is sure. But there are some interesting ideas. Some people say that gravity or, more properly, its absence, may be part of the problem. Hot air doesn't rise in a weightless environment. And so, the aromas aren't necessarily going to your

nose. They may be going to your elbow.

JOE SEXTON: Wow! I never thought about that!

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: We also need to think about what happens to the fluids in your body. On Earth, gravity tends to pull those fluids downward, toward your feet. In space they go everywhere, including to your head. So, you look a bit like a cartoon character.

JOE SEXTON: Like a cartoon character?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Yes! We call it the **Charlie Brown** face, because their faces get more round.

JOE SEXTON: Why more round?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Because they are retaining fluid in their heads. And as they retain fluid, they also feel like they have a cold or they're congested. And again, they're not smelling as much.

JOE SEXTON: So what are you and your colleagues at Cornell doing to test the **stuffy** nose theory?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Well, we're trying to replicate the situation on Earth by asking volunteers to spend several weeks in a bed where their heads are lower than their feet, to try to recreate that Charlie Brown effect.

JOE SEXTON: Is this the first experiment you run about smell?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: No, a couple of years ago I spent four months with six colleagues in a tiny cabin in the Arctic - a Mars habitat simulation. No fresh air, no fresh food, limited water so showers were once a week. It was **cramped**, but no one complained of the smell.

JOE SEXTON: How was that possible?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: We felt it was pretty normal, until we went outside at the end of our four months. And, you know, we spent a little time in the fresh air, and then went back into the habitat... Oh My God!! It was absolutely unbearable!!

JOE SEXTON: So what do you put on the menu for people who are losing their sense of smell and can't get fresh food for months?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Now we are planning to run another of these Mars habitat simulations to help NASA come up with some ideas. One of the most common foods is dry vegetable protein because it can be kept for a long time.

JOE SEXTON: I see but…does that taste good?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: It's OK. I mean, it looks like dog food. It tastes a little bit like dog food. But, with a bit of creativity, it can be made into quite good food. We want the people who will take part in these simulations to be creative with their cooking. We plan to give them a wide variety of spices and herbs, and as many different ingredients as we can think of. And this is great because then, from a limited set of ingredients, you can get thousands and thousands of dishes.

JOE SEXTON: Even without fresh fruit and vegetables, is it possible to make some, shall we say, interesting dishes?

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Absolutely!, with powdered milk alone, you can make a pretty

poor mozzarella, but it's a mozzarella anyway. And after you haven't had fresh cheese for several months, even a little bit of not very good mozzarella is a wonderful, wonderful thing. You can put it on some toast, you can make a basic pizza… It becomes a real treat.

JOE SEXTON: At least it will keep your mind off the stress of being locked up in a tiny space with a half dozen others! Thank you Professor Hunter for this very interesting conversation.

PROFESSOR JEAN HUNTER: Thank you!

FOOD IN SPACE

1. What kind of foods do astronauts crave while they are in space?
❒ hot peppers that smell sweet.
❒ **those that have sweet and sour tastes**.
❒ the ones they never liked on earth.
❒ only sour things, not sweet.

2. Astronauts don't like foods that rely on smell because
❒ they don't taste very good.
❒ food loses its aroma in space.
❒ their taste isn't pleasurable.
❒ **our sense of taste depends on smell**.

3. Would astronauts enjoy drinking coffee while they're in space?
❒ Yes, because it is pleasurable for its smell.
❒ No, because coffee has no taste.
❒ **No, you can't smell it in a weightless environment**.
❒ Maybe, no one has any interesting ideas about that.

4. In the absence of gravity…
❒ **aromas can go to your elbow instead of your nose.**
❒ liquids tend to be pulled towards your feet.
❒ your head fills with aromas and it becomes round.
❒ astronauts' feet look like those of cartoon characters.

5. How are scientists at Cornell University testing the stuffy nose theory?
❒ By making people feel that they have a cold or they're congested.
❒ By asking Charlie Brown to spend several weeks in a bed.
❒ **By having people sleep with their heads lower than their feet.**
❒ By using volunteers who sleep with their feet lower than their heads.

6. Strange aromas were not a problem for Professor Hunter during a Mars habitat simulation in the Arctic because
❒ there was very little water.
❒ space was cramped.
❒ **she had lost some ability to smell**.
❒ most liquids have no smell.

7. Dry vegetable protein is a common food in space
❒ and it is often mixed with fresh fruits and vegetables.
❒ even though it does not allow for many creative dishes.
❒ which is made from a wide variety of ingredients.
❒ **because it does not go bad easily**.

8. According to Professor Hunter
❒ mozzarella made from powdered milk is better than fresh cheese.
❒ **it's possible to make acceptable mozzarella from powdered milk.**
❒ you can make pizza from a piece of toast.
❒ it is unhealthy to eat pizza with poor mozzarella.

Listening Comprehension

BUILDING FOR A BETTER WORLD

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

environment
sustainable
soil
damage
pavements
renewable

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Narrator/Interviewer: Last year a new building project located outside Amsterdam started. It's called the 20/20 Park Project. The idea is to have buildings that have a positive, beneficial impact on the **environment**. We asked the architect, Mr Zicari, to discuss the 20/20 Park Project with us.
Interviewer: Good morning, Mr Zicari. And welcome to the programme.
Mr Zicari: Good morning. And thank you for inviting me

Interviewer: First of all, tell us something about yourself. You are considered the father of a new concept in architecture: Building for a better world. When did you first think about this?
Mr Zicari: Well, I first thought about this while I was a graduate student at Yale University in the U.S., and I designed and built the first solar house in Ireland. I got help from NASA at the time. I was very interested in green architecture and so, I think that my ideas evolved from that.
Interviewer: So what exactly IS green architecture?
Mr Zicari: Green architecture is a philosophy to building which has become more popular in the last 25 to 30 years. It is also known as **sustainable** design. Green architecture is a way to minimize the impact of building on the environment.
Interviewer: So how is your idea of architecture different from green architecture?
Mr Zicari: I do not only think we have to take care of the environment. I think we have to improve it.
Interviewer: Are you talking about the materials we build with? Or the way we build?
Mr Zicari: I'm talking about changing our ideas about building. We know that we don't inhabit an infinite planet. The concept of throwing things "away" has, in effect, itself gone away. Nothing disappears forever. When I began my architecture career in the late 1970s, I was already thinking about the permanence of things.
Interviewer: Why is the 20/20 Park Project important to you?
Mr Zicari: The 20|20 Park Project became the opportunity to bring all my ideas together.
Interviewer: Could you tell us something more about this project?

Mr Zicari: When I started the project, I realized we were designing buildings that were dangerous for the **soil**, the air and the water. Why would anybody do that on purpose?

Interviewer: But that's what we have been doing for years, isn't it?

Mr Zicari: Exactly, we have used materials that **damage** our environment. But, instead, we should be asking a different question: How much can we give for all that we get? And that's what I did. Not simply protect, but rather improve the environment.

Interviewer: This project started during the economic crisis. So what about money? Could people buy such houses?

Mr Zicari: The financial crisis has been going on since the start of the project, but the 20/20 Park Project has been very successful. We didn't think it would be so successful. In fact, we've done about 40 percent better than we anticipated. And I believe this is because we've done things thinking about what the world should be like.

Interviewer: Do others agree with you?

Mr Zicari: Most people agree that the project is quite successful. We are proud of the buildings that are complete, and of how comfortable the people living there find them.

Interviewer: So you believe that people prefer green architecture.

Mr Zicari: Well, yes. The concept of green architecture is great, but it's more than green roofs and permeable **pavements**. It is not just a question of managing water.

Interviewer: Could you give us some examples?

Mr Zicari: Green roofs can also be used as parks, farms and natural habitats for wildlife. Green infrastructure can lower air temperature. All these things are really important for making our buildings more sustainable.

Interviewer: So, is the 20/20 Park Project green architecture?

Mr Zicari: Yes and no. It is more than green architecture. The 20/20 Park Project is green architecture but it is also a project where people are more important than business. The things that we value are quality and beauty. The questions are "How can we make it more beautiful? How can we make it healthier? How can we make it more effective through the use of clean energy?" It's always about better, better, better.

Interviewer: And can ordinary people pay for it?

Mr Zicari: It is expensive but people pay for it. Numbers are important, but what makes people happy? That matters, too. That's what we try to do —and maybe change the world a bit, too.

Interviewer: We've run out of time. Thank you very much for sharing your thoughts with us.

Mr Zicari: My pleasure.

Listening comprehension

1. Where did the idea of building for a better world come from?
❒ **It is an evolution from his interest in green architecture.**
❒ It originated in Ireland where the first solar house was built.
❒ It came from a group of students at Yale University.
❒ It came from a NASA theory when designing a solar house.

2. What is the difference between green architecture and Mr Zicari's idea of architecture?
❒ **Green architecture cares for the environment and his architecture tries to improve it.**
❒ His architecture is more popular than green architecture.
❒ His architecture takes care of the materials we build with and green architecture does not.
❒ Green architecture is continuously improving and his architecture never changes.

3. What is the most important part of a project for Mr Zicari?
❒ The location of the buildings.
❒ The time needed for construction.
❒ **The person's well being.**
❒ The things that are thrown away.

4. What did Mr Zicari worry about when he started the project?
❒ He was concerned about people who put the environment in danger on purpose.
❒ He was only worried about the soil and the water .
❒ **He wanted to give something back to the environment.**
❒ He wanted to sell all the houses in the development.

5. Which of these sentences is NOT correct?
❒ People living in the buildings find them comfortable.
❒ **All the buildings in the project are complete.**
❒ Mr. Zicari thinks the project is a big success.
❒ The financial crisis does not seem to have affected the whole project.

6. Which of these things about green architecture is NOT mentioned in the text?
❒ Green roofs.
❒ Permeable pavements
❒ Green infrastructures
❒ **Green façades**

7. Which are the most important things in the 20/20 Park Project?
❒ **Quality and beauty.**
❒ Beauty and energy.
❒ Biodiversity and clean energy.
❒ Business and quality.

8. What is Mr Zicari's ultimate goal?
❒ To earn a lot of money.
❒ To build for rich people.
❒ **To try to change the world a little bit.**
❒ To make people rich.

Comprensió Oral

AN INTERVIEW WITH A CHAMPION

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

catch up with: retrobar-se, tornar-se a trobar / reencontrarse, volverse a reunir
practice: entrenament / entreno
odd: estrany / extraño
social networks: xarxes socials / redes sociales
insight: percepció / percepción
leisure: lleure, temps lliure / ocio, tiempo libre

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Reporter: Each year at this time since 2009, tennis player Chris Jules has been coming to New York *City* and leaving with the U.S. Open trophy. Jules, who is 33 and among the top tennis practitioners, has no immediate plans to retire. Last August he won the Western Open title and was in the semifinals in Wimbledon in July. In November he was in the London Masters final. In today's program he's interviewed by our sports reporter.
Now listen to the rest of the interview.
Reporter: Good evening, Chris. Welcome to our program.
Jules: Good evening. Thank you for inviting me!
Reporter: First of all, Chris, how does it feel being a world champion, again?
Jules: Well, I'm great! I'm feeling so much better than I did last year. But hearing you say I've been coming to New York since 2009, I can't believe how old I am. Time really flies. But I'm feeling in great shape.
Reporter: Being a tennis champion means you must do a lot of travelling. How do you manage personal life and competition?
Jules: I love being in the tennis court but I am also happy to go back home in Austria, where I can **catch up with** friends and family ... although my wife and I also love it when it's time to pack things up and travel abroad. We always see its positive side, even though leaving our kids behind is hard.
Reporter: Tennis is your life and your passion, but has it always been like that? The discipline of **practice** and the tournaments and championships, don't you ever feel it's too much?
Jules: In my early years I had to struggle. There were times when I got bored after 45 minutes of practice; I wasn't enjoying tennis so much. That must have been when I was between 16 and 21 and there were so many of these moments that I nearly gave up. One day I said to my coach, "I'm fed up with this, I want to become professional". And so I did, and then I started to really enjoy tennis practice. Today I love practice; in fact my favorite time is when nobody's watching. When there's a crowd, I feel the pressure of the people watching, taking pictures, analyzing me…. I know it may sound **odd**, because I also enjoy the competition, and it's great when people are cheering and celebrating a good serve.
Reporter: You once told me you don't like being alone. Has that changed?

Jules: Not really. I love having people around. When we're at home, our house is always open; friends and family come in and out all the time. My wife travels with me most of the times but if she can't, well, it feels **odd** not having her with me. I remember when I went to Barcelona by myself last year. I got back to my room after the match and there was nobody there. I felt pretty lonely. My family, my wife and my twin daughters, are really important to me. If we can, we are always together. But, of course, the kids have to go to school; so sometimes that's not possible.
Reporter: Let's talk about tennis now. What has been the biggest change in tennis these last 10 years?
Jules: The game has evolved. The way we play tennis today has changed a lot, probably because of racket technology. Maybe it's not so much fun sometimes as it used to be. Ten years ago tennis players were aggressive in the sense that they would play from the back of the court and also from the front. Nowadays most tennis players play from the back. I prefer the way tennis was played before.
Reporter: But if I ask you what's the biggest change in YOUR life, what would you say?
Jules: The biggest change for me has probably been social media**.**
Reporter: You really seem to have taken to it!
Jules: Yeah, but it took me a while. I started with Facebook: downloading a few pictures and making comments. That was my slow introduction into the **social network.** Then last year it was Twitter. Everybody uses social media differently. I said to myself, "If I am going to do it, I'll do it my own way!" My idea was to give people the extra **insight** into tennis nobody else has. Give them something they didn't know. So I'm not publishing game results or other things that people may learn from the news. I'm giving them my feelings, my thoughts. And I'm glad about it since people say they like what I'm doing. I think it's been actually quite nice.
Reporter: Apart from tennis, your family and networking, what other things do you enjoy doing?
Jules: In my leisure time, I love meeting up with friends for coffee. And since I live this busy life, when I'm on vacation my favorite place is going to the beach; just listening to the waves on a solitary, quiet beach.
Reporter: What's one thing you're really looking forward to when you're not playing tennis? Other sports, perhaps?
Jules: I had to stop playing other sports because I'm too scared I might get injured. I used to play squash, badminton, basketball and soccer. So maybe I'll play them again in the future. And of course skiing; can you imagine living in Austria and not skiing?
Reporter: Well, Jules, I'm afraid we've run out of time. Thank you very much for your time.

Jules: My pleasure.

Clau de respostes

Choose the appropriate answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

1. According to the interview, Chris Jules …
   feels he's much better this year than the previous one.

2. Which of these things is the hardest for Jules when he leaves home?
   Leaving his children.

3. When did Jules start loving tennis practice?
   When he became a professional tennis player.

4. Today, Jules's favorite time playing tennis is when ….
   he is alone and no one is observing what he does.

5. Which of these statements is TRUE?
   Jules's wife did not travel with him the last time he went to Barcelona.

6. According to Jules, tennis has changed in the last ten years…
   thanks to racket technology.

7. What does Jules say about *Facebook* and *Twitter*?
   He likes to use the social media to express his own ideas.

8. What does Jules like to do in his leisure time?
   To meet up with friends and going to the beach.

Comprensió Oral

HEARING DOGS

Interviewer: Nearly 10 million people in the UK experience some degree of hearing loss. That's one person in every six. Over half a million are severely or profoundly deaf. Can dogs help them? In today's interview Julie Bradford, a dog trainer working for a **charity**, *Hearing Dogs for Deaf People*, will tell us how.
Interviewer: Welcome to our programme Julie! It's a pleasure to have you here.
Julie: Thank you!
Interviewer: Julie, we've all heard of dogs that have been specially trained to help blind people, but I don't think I have ever heard of dogs specially trained to help people with severe hearing loss, or "hearing dogs" as we might call them. Is this a new kind of dog training?

Julie: Well… not really, our organization has been around for three decades now, working with deaf people in the UK. We've been helping people to **alleviate** some of the consequences that **deafness** can have, but we know that we're still considered a small organisation, although there are many deaf people that can benefit from having one of our dogs.
Interviewer: Now, tell us Julie, what do you exactly do at *Hearing Dogs for Deaf People*?
Julie: I am a dog trainer, so I teach our dogs to alert their deaf owner to important sounds. I train our dogs to respond to sounds such as the alarm clock, smoke alarm, doorbell and telephone. I also work on the behaviour of the dogs to make sure they are comfortable in social environments before they are placed with their deaf owner.

Interviewer: And what does the training consist of?

Julie: First the dogs need to be socialised when they are very young, between 3 and 8 weeks. These **puppies** stay with a volunteer for a full-time socialisation period of about one year: they get exposed to a wide range of people, animals, places and experiences. Then they arrive in the organisation for their sound training and are **allocated** to a trainer, such as myself.

Interviewer: These dogs have a little dark red jacket on, which tells you that they are hearing dogs. Why do they wear them?

Julie: Well, this is because the problem for a lot of deaf people is that their disability is invisible. If you're blind there are obvious indications because you would be walking with a stick, but with hearing loss, it is very difficult to tell, and that can cause a lot of problems.

Interviewer: You are right… I never thought of this!

Julie: It's actually a serious problem. Many of the hearing aids that people use now are so small that they can't be seen, so you don't know whether a person who has hearing loss is perhaps struggling with it in many social situations.

Interviewer: Could you give us an example?

Julie: Sure! Many of our clients comment on how they are often in supermarkets and people behind them would say: "Excuse me, do you mind moving to the side?" because they are there with their shopping trolley. But they don't hear the comment and do nothing and people often think they are rude, but of course they just didn't hear the comment.

Interviewer: I see…

Julie: So the dog makes a huge difference in that situation, because it stands next to the person with its hearing dog jacket on, telling everybody in the shop that the person with the dog is deaf, and therefore it starts to break down some of those barriers created by **deafness**.

Interviewer: I see… It is very important that the dogs wear these jackets. How many hearing dogs can the charity provide? How many are available?

Julie: At the moment we have slightly more than 800 deaf people allocated to one of our dogs across the UK, but since we started we have trained 1,850 dogs, so we have got a long history working with people, but we can never provide enough dogs.

Interviewer: That's excellent! But, at a personal level, do you find your job rewarding?

Julie: Yes, definitely! I have worked for the Charity for nearly seven years now so there have been lots of good moments! I also find it really rewarding speaking to dog owners and seeing how much their hearing dogs have changed their lives.

Interviewer: What is it like to work with other trainers that might have different ideas about how to best train a dog?

Julie: Everyone is here to help improve the lives of deaf people, and so all the staff and volunteers are like one big team. Like any job, there are difficult moments too, but a sweet puppy or a ball game with one of the dogs soon puts a smile back on your face!

Interviewer: What are you working on at the moment?

Julie: I am currently training four dogs and have another one coming in next week, so that keeps me pretty busy. The job is full of variety though, which I love. One day you can be training sound work and the next you can be taking a dog on the train to London. It is important that each dog is well adapted, matched to their owner's lifestyle so we prepare them as much as we can.

Interviewer: A truly fascinating job! Julie, thank you for telling us about it. I'm afraid we've run out of time. Thank you so much for being with us today!

Julie: It was a pleasure! Thank you.

826 Words. Adapted from: *http://www.hearingdogs.org.uk/ ; http://www.pdsa.org.uk/*

Clau de respostes

Choose the appropriate answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

1. Which of the following statements is FALSE about Julie's organization?
It is a large organization.

2. What are hearing dogs trained to do?
To respond to various sounds.

3. When are hearing dogs socialized?
Not much after they have been born.

4. One of the problems of hearing loss is that…
it is a disability often unnoticed by others.

5. Why is the dark red jacket hearing dogs wear useful?
It helps people notice that the dog owner is deaf.

6. How many dogs has Julie's organization trained?
About 1800.

7. What does Julie really like about her job?
How much it changes deaf people's lives.

8. Julie thinks that when training a hearing dog it is important to…
consider who the owner will be.

Comprensió Auditiva

DO SCHOOLS DESTROY CREATIVITY?

Do schools kill creativity? That's one of the ideas we'll explore in a special conversation with Professor Mila Saunders, an internationally recognized expert on creativity and education innovation. Professor Saunders has worked with governments and cultural organizations to make creativity a more integral part of education.

DAVID Peterson: Professor Saunders, welcome and thank you for accepting our invitation.

MILA Saunders: It's my pleasure to be here, thank you for inviting me!

DAVID: Well, one of the things that we all have in common about going to school is that we have very mixed feelings about our own schooling, really. I mean, some of it was great, but I also spent a lot of time doing things I didn't really care for all that much. Are your memoires any different? What started your interest in education?

MILA: I guess not, I'm afraid. I recall doing some things simply because I had to. I can't say I was motivated and this must have remained as part of my school memory. So, I would say my interest in education must be related back to my own schooling experience.

DAVID: After University, you took up a position as a teacher, didn't you?

MILA: Yes, and as a young teacher I realized that there were pupils whose capacities were underestimated. And there were some bright people who often didn't think they were very **smart**. There were smart people who didn't think they were good enough just because they were never given the chance.

DAVID: What did you do, then?

MILA: I had become involved in theatre at the school, even directing some of the school plays. And it was then I became aware of the potentiality of the students' **skills**. I became very interested in theater in education. That was something I enjoyed more than anything. And I eventually did a master in creative education, and eventually became a teacher trainer; that is how it all really started. So that's how I started being involved in education.

DAVID: In fact, you spent ten years until 2001 as a professor of arts education. Why did you leave that post? You were after all influencing the next generation of teachers so that they could perhaps do a better job than some of the teachers did when you were coming up?

MILA: That might be true, er…Yes, but I'd never planned to be a professor. I mean I never quite had a plan. People think that life is linear, that you can plan it all out. And one of the problems I think is that our educational systems are based on that principle: that everything must be planned.

DAVID: Didn't you enjoy it as a professor of arts education?

MILA: Oh, Yes, I loved it! But I felt I had come to the end of it. You know, I always feel it's important to know when the time is right to move on and I just wanted to do things that interested me directly.

DAVID: Can we now move onto motivation? In your book of 2009, *The Element*, you talk about Gillian Lynn. Gillian is this famous choreographer who did the choreography for *Cats* and the *Phantom of the Opera*, besides other musicals.

MILA: Oh, Yes, Gillian. That was a wonderful case. You know, when she was a little girl she was constantly **fidgeting** at school, looking out of the window and being distracted. No one cared to teach her anything. Her parents were quite desperate. And one day her mother took her for a medical test. Gillian was left alone in the room, while the doctor and the mother were discussing. The minute they were out of the room she was on her feet, circling harmonically to the music all around the room. Then the doctor turned to her mother and said, "Mrs. Lynn, Gillian isn't sick. She's a dancer! Take her to a dance school".

DAVID: And she became an international dancer and choreographer!

MILA: Precisely! Kids are kids. They are restless. They have this energy. This inability to sit still could be channeled into something. Most people don't seem to know what their real talents are and many doubt that they have any talents at all.

DAVID: In your book you also talk about educational systems around the globe that are introducing reforms to meet the **challenges** of the 21st century. And most of them you say don't need reform, they need transformation.

MILA: Something that really worries me is that in public education now there is something like a 30 percent **dropout rate** from between the ninth grade and the twelfth grade. At this point, it is obvious you can't blame the kids. You can't say, well this 30 percent of the kids cannot be educated. There's something wrong in the system. And I am not criticizing teachers or principals; they have a really challenging job to do. The problem is the system. It's the way it's organized. They are being driven by this obsession with **standardized** testing. We have to get everything to the same standards.

DAVID: And yet teachers are teaching to that test.

MILA: They have to!

DAVID: So how or who can encourage the students' creative capacity?

MILA: It is probably the teachers themselves. Teachers are the people who **turn you on or turn you off**. Somebody who realized there was something happening in you (the pupil) that they should encourage. Everybody should bear in mind, you know, that if you invest in people's natural talents, something good will come of it!

DAVID: Well Professor, thank you so much for sharing your ideas with us today.

MILA: It's been my pleasure!

1. What memories do both the interviewer and Dr. Saunders have about school when they were young?
   a) Both of them liked everything they did at school.
   b) Neither of them can recall much of their school memories any more.
   c) They both disliked everything they did at school.
   d) Both of them feel some of the things they did were good but not all.

2. As a young teacher, Saunders noticed that …
   a) some students had little interest in learning..
   b) most students were never given due attention.
   c) some clever students thought they were not good.
   d) only clever students were taught properly.

3. How did Professor Saunders' interest in education arise?
   a) She had always planned to become a teacher.
   b) It was through her interest in the school theatre.
   c) She loved acting, and teaching was very similar.
   d) When she was not accepted as a theatre director.

4. Why did Dr. Saunders leave her post as arts and education professor?
   a) She was fed up with education and university.
   b) She was no longer interested in teaching her pupils.
   c) She lost her job and looked for another place.
   d) She wanted a change in her career.

5. What did Gillian Lynn do when she was left alone in the doctor's office?
   a) She started fidgeting and moving around.
   b) She remained still, looking out of the window.
   c) She sat at the doctor's table doing nothing.
   d) She started moving to the sound of music.

6. According to the conversation, what is Dr. Saunders' most worried about?
   a) The challenging jobs teachers and principals have.
   b) Teachers and principals who criticize the school system.
   c) The students who do not want to be educated.
   d) The number of kids who leave school between 9th and 12th grade.

7. Which one of the following is NOT TRUE about Dr. Saunders' views on education?
   a) **Students should be given more standardized tests**.
   b) The problem is not in the children, but the system.
   c) School should be more motivating for students and teachers alike.
   d) The educational system is badly organized.

8. Who can encourage the students' creative capacity, according to Dr. Saunders?
   a) Good teachers who motivate the students' talents.
   b) Only the most talented and motivated teachers.
   c) Those who can plan the school of the future.
   d) Teachers who can invest more time educating them.

Comprensió Auditiva

ARE WE ALONE IN THE UNIVERSE?

Some scientific discoveries can be fascinating, but sometimes it is hard to believe that they are true. That's the case with an article in the March issue of the Journal of Cosmology. In it, Richard Hoover, a scientist at NASA's Marshall Space Flight Center, says he found signs of bacterial life in a group of meteorites, and that raises the exciting possibility that life had once arrived on Earth from **outer** space. In the following conversation, journalist Johanna Palmer talks with George Cody, a NASA expert on meteorites. They discuss Prof. Hoover's discoveries concerning the existence of life on Mars.

JOHANNA PALMER: Mr. Cody, thank you very much for accepting our invitation.

GEORGE CODY: You're welcome. Thank you for inviting me and for giving me the opportunity to talk about meteorites.

JOHANNA: I'd like to begin by asking you about Prof. Hoover and his fascinating discovery. His **findings** seem to give firm evidence that we are not alone in the universe!

CODY: Indeed, this is an amazing theory. And if this was true, those alien life forms may have a lot more in common with life on Earth than we had previously thought.

JOHANNA: All right Mr. Cody, but, as someone said once, extraordinary discoveries require extraordinary **proof**. As far as I understand, in this case the proof seems to be missing. Could you tell us your opinion about Prof. Hoover's discovery?

CODY: Well, first of all, I have to say that if Prof. Hoover's **claim** was true, this would be one of the most important scientific discoveries ever made. Unfortunately, I agree with most other scientists who say that there is no proof that this is true.

JOHANNA: This isn't the first time that NASA scientist Richard Hoover has claimed to see signs of life in meteorites. Why do you think that this particular article and not others got special attention?

CODY: I really have no idea; it is one of those media mysteries!

JOHANNA: Could you explain, for those of us who are not experts on meteorites, what

Prof. Hoover's main **claim** actually is?

CODY: The main idea defended by Prof. Hoover is that a microscopic evaluation of these meteorites shows that they contain filaments that might have been formed by a living organism, such as bacteria. But there are other possible explanations, too. There are all sorts of chemical processes that might have created those filaments.

JOHANNA: But, does that mean that the bacteria found on meteorites might possibly not come from space?

CODY: It's hard to be certain that any signs of life you see in meteorites found on Earth came from **outer** space. In fact, it's more likely that the bacteria infected the meteorite after it arrived on Earth, or even when they were picked up by scientists for examination.

JOHANNA: So, in other words, you pick this thing up –this fragment of meteorite—from the ground and, almost immediately, if you're not careful, even from the bacteria on your hands, you've contaminated the meteorite!

CODY: Absolutely. This is a more than probable conclusion. Contamination is almost **unavoidable**.

JOHANNA: So, if human contamination is more than likely, why do you think Prof. Hoover is defending the idea that the bacteria came from outer space?

CODY: Well, you must remember that scientists are obsessed with discoveries. We always want to discover something new, that's why we're in the game! And if you discover something that seems like it might be extraordinary,[…] well, there's this in human nature: you tend to think, "wow, I've made this great discovery, I have to share it with the world!"

JOHANNA: But scientists must be very careful and absolutely sure before they publish their **findings**, don't you think?

CODY: Absolutely! Fifteen years ago, another group of scientists claimed they'd found signs of life in a meteorite from Mars recovered in Antarctica. The media also gave it full **coverage**; even other scientists supported the theory. But only a few years later, most scientists were convinced the finding was false. So this time, most scientists are skeptical about Prof. Hoover's claim for evidence of bacterial life in meteorites.

JOHANNA: So, if a scientific discovery turns out to be wrong, is that necessarily a bad thing?

CODY: Well, no; not necessarily. It often happens that we learn more from mistakes than we do from successes! These meteorites from Mars probably don't have any evidence of life in them, but they surely have some fascinating chemistry.

JOHANNA: So would you say that there is any chance at all that Prof. Hoover's new finding is correct, this time?

CODY: Well, there have been some extraordinary claims in the past that turned out to be right. You see, sometimes it takes years for scientific findings to be confirmed right. But this only happens once in a while.

JOHANNA: But what will happen if the new claim is wrong?

CODY: Then it will be corrected. There's no question about it. Scientists will come up with the correct explanation for these structures, and we'll move on. And that's the way science progresses.

JOHANNA: Well, Mr. Cody, thank you so much for your time and for sharing your views with us.

CODY: Thank you. It's been my pleasure!

QUESTIONS

1. Johanna Palmer has invited George Cody…
   a) to talk about his scientific discoveries.
   b) to discuss his work at NASA.
   c) to talk about Prof. Hoover's discovery.
   d) because she wants to specialize on meteorites.

2. What does George Cody think about the possibility of life in outer space?
   a) He would like this to be true.
   b) He firmly believes in this possibility.
   c) If it were true, it would be like living on Earth.
   d) He thinks there is no evidence of it yet.

3. What is Prof. Hoover's main **claim** about meteorites?
   a) The bacteria found in meteorites prove that there is life on Mars.
   b) Microscopic fragments from meteorites are like those on Earth.
   c) Microscopic filaments in meteorites were not created by bacteria.
   d) The filaments found in meteorites were brought alive from Mars.

4. What is George Cody's opinion about Prof. Hoover's findings?
   a) He believes scientists should not manipulate contaminated meteorites.
   b) He thinks that Prof. Hoover's discovery is not scientific.
   c) He believes the meteorites may have been contaminated on Earth.
   d) He doesn't like experiments made on meteorites.

5. According to George Cody, scientists publish some discoveries before they have proved them, because...
   a) they want other people to know about their findings.
   b) they want to show their superiority.
   c) they are obsessive people.
   d) they like to play with extraordinary things.

6. When a group of scientists claimed they'd found signs of life in a meteorite from Mars in the Antarctica,
   a) most of the media talked about the discovery widely.
   b) scientists didn't want to hear anything about this theory.
   c) the newspapers ignored that important discovery.
   d) only a few scientists thought it was a false discovery.

7. According to the interview, what happens when a discovery turns out to be wrong?
   a) It hardly ever happens that scientific discoveries go wrong.
   b) It is very bad for scientists as their reputation will be damaged.
   c) Scientists have to wait for many years before they find a new theory.
   d) Scientists have to accept it and learn from what goes wrong.

8. Which sentence is FALSE? What will happen if Prof. Hoover's theory is not proved?
   a) **George Cody will provide correct structures.**
   b) Scientists will continue and learn from the error.
   c) Scientists will give a correct explanation for his findings.
   d) Science always progresses through correcting mistakes.

Comprensió auditiva

THE BEST ADVICE

QUESTIONS

Anthony Marra, is a young American writer who grew up in Washington, DC, and has lived and studied in Russia. His work has appeared in *Best American Nonrequired Reading 2012.* In 2013 Marra received the prestigious Whiting Writers' Award. His debut novel is entitled *A Constellation of Vital Phenomena* (2013). His story "Chechnya" won First Place in *Narrative*'s Spring 2009 Story Contest and has received many prizes since then. In today's programe, Bertha Morris talks with Mr Marra about his work and his career.

BERTHA MORRIS: Welcome to our interview Mr. Marra

ANTHONY MARRA: Thank you. It's my pleasure to be here.

BERTHA: Mr. Marra, you are 28, but you seem simultaneously older and younger. You have a rather boyish manner, yet your hair is already flecked with gray.

ANTHONY: Ha, ha! I know; and yet I still have to finish writing school. I'm finishing up the second year of a Fellowship at Stanford.

BERTHA: And you have already published a novel and a number of short stories. Tell me about your novel. *A Constellation of Vital Phenomena,* unusual for a first novel, is purely a work of research and invention, without even a hint of autobiography.

ANTHONY: Yes, but I'll tell you something: I took a year off between high school and college, during which I worked in a store. I missed my girlfriend a lot and began writing short stories about a **lovelorn** guy working in the same store. One of them had three pages on a single kiss! (He laughs)

BERTHA: Does that mean you are no longer interested in autobiographical fiction?

ANTHONY: Not at the moment. I quickly realized I lived the least interesting literary life imaginable. My parents are happily married. There haven't been any major traumas in my family. I'm not sure that the story of my life would be much fun to read.

BERTHA: So you had a rather **uneventful** childhood. How influential were your parents in your decision making and your career?

ANTHONY: My father once said to me: **'**If you want to be a geologist, be a geologist." I can't recall when, exactly, my dad said this to me. Maybe I was in high school, or it could have been at someone's graduation, at a celebration, a place where the road forks, where journeys begin. It wasn't intended to be advice but the kind of thing we say and hear and forget about every day.

BERTHA: And did you follow his advice?

ANTHONY: No! I've never had the **slightest** desire to be a geologist. But my dad did, at least briefly. He studied geology in college. He served in Vietnam, went to professional school, went to work, and the necessities of earning a living and supporting a family narrowed the field of geology to a corner of his office desk that held a few quartz rocks. When I was a kid we went to a beach one afternoon to look for prehistoric shark teeth. Instead we found all sorts of bizarre and beautiful rocks, and my dad knew all about them. It was a fun day.

BERTHA: It is true, isn't it, that our lives are often shaped by small, seemingly trivial choices and the advice that guides those choices can come to us just by chance.

ANTHONY: Indeed! When my father said, "If you want to be a geologist, be a geologist," what I heard were his words of encouragement, a paternal **blessing**. Now I think of it less as advice than as a reminder to thank my lucky stars. Few people have the privilege to do what they love for a living, and in that sense I am, in a way at least, a geologist.

BERTHA: Let's go back to your novel. Six years after starting to think about Chechnya, the disputed Russian republic that became the setting for your acclaimed new novel, you visited Russia for the first time. Until the Boston Marathon bombings most Americans paid little attention to Chechnya. How did your interest on Chechnya **arise**?

ANTHONY: My own interest actually began during an undergraduate semester studying in St. Petersburg, Russia, in 2006. I arrived there not long after the murder of Anna Politkovskaya, a journalist who exposed Russian atrocities in Chechnya. At a metro stop near my apartment, I could see Russian veterans of the Chechen wars, drinking and begging for change.

BERTHA: And what did you find there?

ANTHONY: I didn't know what to expect, I traveled with a guide and talked to Chechens, many of whom were still trying to recover from years of war and occupation.

BERTHA: So, although your novel is not autobiographical you did make a great deal of research and documentation to be **accurate** about facts.

ANTHONY: Oh, yes. Research is not an obstacle or something to be frightened of. It can be one of the real joys of writing. Someone once said, 'Don't write what you know; write what you want to know.' But to make a book convincing, it's less important that the right tree be in the right place than that the characters are emotionally real. I did the best I could to make the environment and the setting as realistic as possible, but I hope it's the characters and the emotional reality that make the book true.

BERTHA: One literary critic, writing in The New York Times, called your book "ambitious and intellectually restless." Another fan of yours is Sarah Jessica Parker, who in a review for Entertainment Weekly described it as "full of humanity and hope." So it seems you have fully succeeded.

ANTHONY: I was deeply moved by the Chechens who were just trying to retain their humanity. I'll be pleased if my readers appreciate that.

BERTHA: Anthony, thank you very much for sharing your time with us. And the best of luck with your books.

ANTHONY: That's very kind. It's been my pleasure.

945 words http://www.nytimes.com/2013/05/30/books/anthony-marra-on-a-constellation-of-vital-phenomena.html

QUESTIONS

1. In the conversation we hear that Anthony Marra looks young…
   a) although he has quite a lot of gray hair.
   b) and yet he is already a classical writer.
   c) and old at the same time.
   d) although he has not finished school yet.

2. *A Constellation of Vital Phenomena,*
   a) is a novel about the author's personal experience.
   b) is based on the life of the author's family.
   c) is based both on research and fiction.
   d) was inspired by the author's first love.
3. Why isn't Anthony Marra interested in writing autobiography?
   a) **It would have no literary interest**.
   b) It would cause a trauma to his family.
   c) He wants to keep his life private.
   d) His parents would not like to read about it.

4. In the interview we hear that Anthony Marra's father,
   a) was a professional geologist.
   b) convinced his son to become a geologist.
   c) became an amateur geologist.
   d) collected shark teeth and kept them by his desk.

5. In which way was the writer influenced by his father's advice?
   a) He never followed his father's advice.
   b) **He remembers his father's words as encouragement**.
   c) He decided to choose a very different route.
   d) He always felt lucky enough without his father's help.

6. Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE about the author's interest on Chechnya?
   a) It arose during a visit in Russia as an undergraduate student.
   b) It was inspired by watching Russian veterans beg for money in the streets
   c) It came after watching the Boston Marathon bombings.
   d) It was influenced by reading about the Russian actions in the Chechen wars.

7. According to Anthony Marra, what is most important in order to make his books convincing?
   a) To have the exact details about the trees and the place.
   b) To be able to make the story ring true.
   c) To make the setting as realistic as possible.
   d) To be able to capture the character's feelings.

8. The interviewer thinks that Marra has succeeded in his novel, because…
   a) of the humanity in his characters.
   b) Sarah Jessica Parker liked the book.
   c) the critics praised its intellectual ambition.
   d) many readers were identified with the story.

COMPRENSIÓ AUDITIVIA

SMILING INDIANS

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

***proud*:** orgullós / orgulloso
***lopsided**:* esbiaixat / parcial
***to break into a grin**:* fer un somriure burlaner / hacer una sonrisa burlona
***stray**:* perduda / perdida
***gunshots**:* trets / disparos

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

In the early 1900s, photographer Edward Sheriff Curtis traveled around the United States photographing North American Indians from 80 tribes. Those 2000 or so black and white images show Native Americans in tribal dress: serious, facing the camera straight on and mostly all not smiling. Well now, a century later, comes a video in response to Curtis's photos. It's titled "Smiling Indians," and it's exactly that, four minutes of video of Native Americans, young and old, smiling and laughing. It was co-created by Ryan Red Corn, an Osage Indian from Oklahoma. Journalist Edward Block is chatting with Mr. Red Corn today to find out more about the video and why he decided to make it.

Now listen to the interview

EDWARD BLOCK: Welcome to the program, Ryan.

Mr. RYAN RED CORN: Well, thank you for having me.

EDWARD BLOCK: You have dedicated this video to the photographer Edward Sheriff Curtis. Did you mean that dedication sincerely or were you being sarcastic?

Mr. RED CORN: I think it would be fair to say that I was being sarcastic.

EDWARD BLOCK: Well, why is that? What's your problem with those images from Edward Curtis?

Mr. RED CORN: Basically, they appear in every history book, you know, from the time that you enter grade school to even the documentaries that are shown on TV now. It becomes the dominant image that people have of Indians. I mean, they imagine that Indians don't ever smile.

EDWARD BLOCK: You know, it's interesting because when I look at those old photographs, I see images that seem to me very dignified, very **proud**, unsmiling, yes, but in most photographs from the early 1900s people would not be smiling. It was a serious business to have your picture taken!

Mr. RED CORN: It's true, but unfortunately, that was kind of the end of the era when people were taking pictures of Natives. Even if you just Google Native American or Indian, you'll still come up with a ridiculous, **lopsided** image of what Native Americans are like today.

EDWARD BLOCK: There are babies smiling in this video. There are a few times when there's somebody who starts out looking very serious and then **breaks into a grin**. And what were you telling people when you were trying to get them to smile or explaining what you were doing here?

Mr. RED CORN: I just told them I was shooting a video of smiling Indians.

EDWARD BLOCK: And it worked?

Mr. RED CORN: It pretty much worked. I mean, it's like… the presence of humor in Indian country is everywhere, it's just right there on the surface all the time. All the Indians I know are smiling Indians. While we were making the video, everybody in the community wanted to participate in order to show that the old-fashioned image that Indians are always serious is simply not true.

EDWARD BLOCK: Isn't it true, however, that many North American Indians have really hard lives? Isn't it difficult to smile when life around you is so tough?

Mr. RED CORN: It is true that for many Indians, especially those living in poor areas in and around reservations, life is not easy. And sometimes there aren't many reasons to smile. But even in those conditions, people always find a reason to be positive, and that happens to everybody, not just Indians. The point here was to show a side of our

communities that a lot of people never get a chance to see. It's like saying, not only are we still here, we're enjoying ourselves, too.

EDWARD BLOCK: And you really must have enjoyed yourself making this video, right?

Mr. RED CORN: Oh yes, very much. When I was shooting the video, I couldn't stop smiling all the time and my face hurt so much just from looking at all these people laughing, especially the children and the older people, they were having so much fun!

EDWARD BLOCK: You have this message at the very end of your video. This message pops up: If you remember nothing else about me, remember that I smiled.

Mr. RED CORN: When I was editing the video, we heard some **gunshots** across the street. And I thought: Man, this would be a really poetic way to end my days if I'm sitting here working on this video, and a **stray** bullet comes in and gets me. So I had this idea that if that happened, I was just going to type on my cell phone that if you remember nothing else about me, just remember that I smiled. And we decided to put it at the end of the video. It seemed like a good way to finish because, you know, that was exactly what we were trying to show in this project.

EDWARD BLOCK: Well, Ryan Red Corn, thanks for talking to us about it.

Mr. RED CORN: You're very welcome, I appreciate it.

Choose the most appropriate answer according to the text. Only one answer is correct. Look at number 0 as an example.
[0.25 points each correct answer]

0. How many photographs did Edward Sheriff Curtis take?
❒ 80 or so.
❒ **approximately 2000.**
❒ about 1900.
❒ 2000 or so from each tribe.

---

1. What problem does Mr. Red Corn have with Curtis's pictures?
❒ They never appear in history books.
❒ They are only shown in documentaries.
❒ **They give people the impression that Indians never smile.**
❒ They are the dominant image when you enter grade school.

2. According to the conversation, why didn't most people smile in old photographs?
❒ Because they wanted to look like Indians.
❒ Because people in the 1900s were very serious
❒ Because smiling was not considered a good business.
❒ **Because having your picture taken was a serious thing.**

3. How did Mr. Red Corn get people to smile in his video?
❒ He told them to look very serious and then break into a grin.
❒ **He simply told them he was doing a video about smiling Indians.**
❒ He told them to look ridiculous and lopsided for the video.
❒ He showed them pictures of smiling babies**.**

4. According to the interview, humor in Indian country is present…
❒ **everywhere all the time.**
❒ wherever there are old-fashioned Indians.
❒ only on the surface.
❒ only in some communities.

5. The interviewer thinks it's difficult for Indians to smile because
❒ they can never find a reason to be positive
❒ they don't like to say that they're enjoying themselves.
❒ **many of them live in very tough conditions.**
❒ they don't get a chance to enjoy themselves.

6. Mr. Red Corn couldn't stop smiling while making the video because…
❒ **there were so many people laughing.**
❒ the Indians were making fun of him.
❒ he was trying to give a message.
❒ the older people were having too much fun.

7. When Mr. Red Corn was editing the video he…
❒ thought about poetic ways to end his days.
❒ was afraid that a stray bullet had come in.
❒ **heard gunshots across the street.**
❒ couldn't remember anything else.

8. How did the video end?
❒ With a message about what happened across the street.
❒ **With a message that spoke to the heart of the video**.
❒ With Mr. Red Corn typing a message on his cell phone.
❒ With Mr. Red Corn smiling.

Comprensió audivia

NORWICH

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

mayor: batlle, alcalde / alcalde
keep: torre / torreón
spire: pinacle / aguja
cloister: claustre / claustro
Olympic Torch Relay: relleus de la torxa olímpica/ relevos de la antorcha olímpica
banners: pancartes / pancartas

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Norwich is a city on the River Wensum in England and the regional administrative center in Norfolk. With a population of more than 195,000 people, Norwich is an ideal destination for family and individual outings due to its proximity to London and its historical and cultural offer. With us today in our programme "Cities of the World", is its mayor, Mr. Johnston.

[Now listen to the interview.]

Reporter: Good morning, Johnston and thanks for accepting our invitation.

Mr Johnston: Thank you for inviting me.

Reporter: Why did you decide to run for the mayor of Norwich, Mr. Johnston?

Mr. Johnston: Well, I have to admit that I only decided to run for mayor one year before election time. So, it's something recent. For about 10 years I'd been working for the labour party helping organise city events, designing projects to make our city a better one. I've been the mayor of Norwich for two years, now and I still have many things to do to improve in the city.

Reporter: How did you get into politics then?

Mr. Johnston: I've always been into politics, you know. My father was a city counselor and he was a Member of Parliament for 8 years. Politics has always been part of my life. So when I finished my degree in Law I joined the Labour party and worked for it in my city. You know, I was born in Norwich and I've lived in this city all my life. I only lived away when I studied at London University and when I took a master's degree at Harvard University. Seven years away from my beloved city. That was more than enough! So I came back and decided to help Norwich become a much better city and I've been working for it ever since.

Reporter: It seems to me that you're in love with this city. Tell our listeners something about it. For instance, why should people come and visit it?

Mr. Johnston: In the 11th century Norwich was the largest city in England after London and one of the most important places in the country. In fact, from the medieval period until the start of the Industrial Revolution, Norwich was England's second city, enormously prosperous and culturally active. This has created a rich heritage, for example we are proud to have the largest intact medieval street pattern in Europe.

Reporter: One of the city's most famous landmarks is Norwich Castle. Tell us something about it.

Mr. Johnston: It was built by the Normans as a Royal Palace 900 years ago. Now it is a museum and art gallery, and home to some of the most outstanding collections of fine art, archaeology and natural history. But let me tell you that my favourite place there is the Norman keep, which has been made into a new space where models, computers and videos bring history vividly to life.
Reporter: And what can you say about the Cathedral? I think it is another remarkable building, isn't it?

Mr. Johnston: Yes. Norwich's Cathedral is magnificent: it is one of the finest complete Romanesque cathedrals in Europe. It has the second tallest spire and the largest monastic cloister in England. It is set in beautiful grounds as well. If we had time for it I would tell you all the big things our city has. And there are a lot!!!

Reporter: You are right; unfortunately we don't have time for that much. So let me ask you about a special event this summer. Norwich was on the screen on the occasion of the Olympic Torch Relay.

Mr. Johnston: Indeed! We were very excited that Norwich was chosen as one of the destination cities for the Olympic Torch Relay. There was a whole city celebration welcoming the Olympic Torch to the streets of Norwich on Wednesday 4 and Thursday 5 July. We had a packed programme, which continued late into the evening, including the Olympic stage show, a line-up of bands and street theatre in the city center, and a spectacular 3D video projection.
Reporter: I've also read there were some spectacular street decorations...
Mr. Johnston: Oh yes! The route was animated with activities created by arts organisations and communities who had worked together to design and make giant puppets, flags and human pyramids. Trees along the route were covered in Olympic colours, banners in lampposts and the whole city was dressed to welcome the Torch. I'll never forget that day. The whole city seemed to be so happy, even the weather was great, the sun shining, amazing really amazing.
Reporter: Well, Mr Johnston I can see you're proud of your city**.**

Mr. Johnston: Indeed I am.

Reporter: Thank you for sharing your city with us for some minutes. It's been a pleasure.

Mr. Johnston: Thank you!

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[0.25 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. Norwich …
❒ has more than 200,000 inhabitants.
❒ **is in Norfolk.**
❒ is far from London.
❒ doesn't have many historical buildings.

---

1. When did Mr. Johnston decide to run for Norwich mayor?

❒ Approximately 10 years ago.
❒ **Three years ago.**
❒ Since he started working for the Labour party.
❒ Since he organized city events.

2. Which of the following statements about Mr. Johnston is FALSE?

❒ He has a degree in law.
❒ He studied at Harvard University.
❒ He lived away from Norwich for seven years.
❒ **He was a Member of Parliament**.

3. When was Norwich the second largest city in England?
❒ From the Industrial Revolution to the present day.
❒ Only in the Medieval Age.
❒ **From the 11th century till the Industrial Revolution.**
❒ Only in the 11th century.

4. Norwich Castle
❒ keeps a model tower full of computers.
❒ **used to be a palace for the Norman kings.**
❒ was destroyed by the Normans.
❒ is now an archeological site.

5. Norwich Cathedral is
❒ surrounded by a cemetery.
❒ the tallest in England.
❒ **Romanesque and has a tall spire**.
❒ beautiful but has no cloister.

6. How long did the celebrations for the Olympic Torch relay last?
❒ One evening.
❒ **Two days**.
❒ Three days.
❒ One day.

7. Which activities were organized to celebrate the Olympic Torch Relay?
❒ There were bands and people drawing in the streets.
❒ There were shows and animals parading in the streets.
❒ There was just a spectacular video projection in the city center.
❒ **There were video projections, shows and bands in the city center.**

8. Which of these things was NOT used in the city center celebrations?
❒ Human pyramids.
❒ Giant puppets
❒ **Flags in lampposts.**
❒ Olympic colours in trees.

8. Which of the following may indicate nomophobia?
   a. **charging the phone's battery all the time**.
   b. worrying about having just one mobile phone.
   c. having many missed calls and messages.
   d. putting the phones in a safe place.

COMPRENSIÓ AUDITIVA

VEGETARIANISM

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

***slaughter**:* sacrificar
slaughterhouse: matadero / escorxador
trust: confiar
***bred** (to breed):* criar
shortage: escassetat / escasez
stuffed: fartar /atiborrar

Ready?
Now read the questions on the next page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Please note that this paragraph must be read by someone other that "Mary" or "Michael"

According to an opinion poll recently published in the press, vegetarianism is on the increase. In today's programme Michael Thomson, chef and owner of a restaurant famous for the quality of the meat it serves, and Mary Stone, TV actress and a committed vegetarian, will present their views on vegetarianism. Michael Thomson, Mary Stone, welcome to our radio show *Debate*, the floor is yours!

Adapted from a BBC Radio 4 Interview.

[Now listen to the interview]

Mary: Thanks for inviting me to the programme!
Michael: Thank you! It's a great pleasure being here.
Mary: Could I start by asking a question to Michael?
Michael: Sure.
Mary: Michael, I know many people have recently become very committed vegetarians and are very anxious to convince people that it's the right course to take. My impression is that this is because people are very sensitive to the images of slaughtered animals that appear so frequently in the media. Do you think this is the case?

Michael: Yes, of course. I don't know what kind of beliefs could drive people into being a vegetarian but certainly seeing animals going to the slaughterhouse is disgusting.

Mary: Do you think these images harm your bossiness?

Michael: Well, obviously people who think that animals shouldn't be killed for food would probably avoid eating at my restaurant, but maybe the images in the media will make more people consider eating fish instead of meat, which of course is vital to our diet and probably more important than meat.

Mary: As far as I know, fish consumption in people's homes has been dropping for many years. Do you also serve fish in your restaurant?

Michael: Yes, we have a number of fish dishes on the menu. In fact, the fish dishes we serve are becoming more and more popular, so it seems people's choices when eating out are gradually changing... but meat dishes always sell better. Just remember that we've been eating meat ever since we were in the caves …

Mary: Well, I think that people are eating less meat now. Have you actually noticed in your restaurant that people eat less red meat, for example?

Michael: No, not really. I think people eat less read meat at home, but when they go to restaurants they feel the meat is going to be of superior quality and they **trust** it. People order more fish dishes probably because they don't know how to cook fish at home.

Mary: Yes, but surely people are influenced by the images they see on TV, and this is going to change people's minds, they won't eat meat anymore because eating meat will make them think of disgusting **slaughterhouses**.

Michael: Maybe... but there is nothing wrong with eating meat, I think everyone's got the right to choose, that is the main thing about diet.

Mary: Yes, but that's precisely what we vegetarians are questioning. Where is the humanity if everyone has the right to choose to kill?

Michael: Well, animals have been bred to eat, if we had no farms there would be a serious food **shortage**.

Mary: Yes, but maybe you don't need to have animals **stuffed** in factory farms. They are suffering. Factory farming methods have nothing to do with the way animals were bred in traditional farms a hundred years ago.

Michael: I agree with you there, most factory farmed animals live in such a tight space that they can hardly move. We need to invest more to make farms more like they used to be. This would make our food better, and healthier!

Mary: Yes, but you don't need to eat meat. It's not a healthy habit, and it's causing a lot of suffering, so why not stop eating meat and invest all that money in something else, education for example!

Michael: I really think that the principles of the Vegetarian Society which was set up in Ramsgate in 1847 are fine for people who want to be vegetarians, but there is no need to

force everyone to eat just vegetables. Let the choice be with the public: if they like eating meat, if they like fish, let them eat it! But, please, I ask vegetarians if you're going to be serious about it, why eat rubbish like veggie-burgers?

Mary: Now you're just being unfair. Can you call veggie-burgers rubbish when you're eating meat from slaughtered animals and you're feeding that to your children? We just don't want to participate in a slaughter!

Michael: No, what I mean is that there are meat-eaters out there; about eighty-seven per cent of us eat meat. We have been eating meat for generations, centuries! I know there are some very famous people who have been vegetarians: Verdi, Tolstoy, Wagner, Bernard Shaw, but I don't see why we should all become vegetarians and stop enjoying eating meat.

Mary: That is the problem, there are two antagonist views: vegetarians will not see how the enjoyment of food can go along with the killing of the animals, whereas many other people enjoy eating meat, but things are changing for the better I think.

Journalist: Well, this was most exciting, but I'm afraid our time is over. Thank you for taking part in our debate today.

Michael: It was a pleasure. Thank you!

Mary: Thank you!

Choose the most appropriate answer according to the text. Only one answer is correct. Look at number 0 as an example.

[0.25 each correct answer]

1. **Mary thinks that many people become vegetarian because they...**
a) become anxious when they eat meat.
b) are committed to their beliefs.
c) **are impressed by images in the media.**
d) are convinced by other vegetarians.

2. **What does Michael think is important in a person's diet?**
a) avoiding bad food.
b) eating meat.
c) eating at a restaurant.
d) **eating fish.**

3. **In Michael's restaurant fish dishes are more popular now…**
a) than meat dishes.
b) **than they used to be.**
c) because they are cheaper.
d) because people eat out more.

4. **What should be done in order to improve the quality of meat, according to Michael?**
a) Animal suffering should be stopped.
b) **There should be more investment in farms**.
c) Better slaughterhouses should be built.
d) Animals should be fed with healthier food.

5. **Mary and Michael both agree that…**
a) **factory farming methods are bad.**
b) animals have been bred to eat.
c) animals should not be bred in farms.
d) factory farms should be closed down.

6. **In order to stop animal suffering, Mary thinks we should…**
a) build larger factory farms.
b) **stop eating meat.**
c) adopt healthy eating habits.
d) stop building modern farms.

7. **Michael thinks that vegetarians should let other people…**
a) eat red meat.
b) eat more fish dishes.
c) eat veggie-burgers.
d) **eat what they want.**

8. **Which of the following statements is correct:**
a) **eighty-seven per cent of the population are not vegetarians.**
b) many meat-eaters also eat veggie-burgers.
c) famous people like Verdi enjoyed eating meat.
d) veggie-burgers sell better than meat-burgers.

Prova Auditiva

IS HOLLYWOOD IN CRISIS?

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

***to market*:** promocionar
***brand (movie)**:* marca
***appeal**:* atraure / atraer
***neglected**:* desatès / desatendido
garbage: brossa / basura
assume: donen per fet / dan por sentado

Ready? Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

_____

According to writer Mark Harris, Hollywood is in deep crisis. He says that the atmosphere in the movie-making capital of the world is so cautious that most executives are afraid to try new formulas. So moviegoers are left with a continuous repetition of the same titles. This year alone, Hollywood has produced "Spy Kids 4," "Final Destination 5," more "Harry Potter," more "Pirates of the Caribbean," more and more of what we've seen before. There are common themes that both filmmakers and **brands** return to, time and time again. In his book, Mark Harris asks: How did we get here? Today he has been invited to talk to reporter Barbara Walker about his recent article "The Day the Movies Died" and maybe he will be able to answer that question for us.

_____Now listen to the interview_____

BARBARA WALKER: Mark, welcome to our show and thank you very much for accepting our invitation to talk about the situation in Hollywood.

MARK HARRIS: Thanks so much for inviting me. It's a pleasure being here to talk to you and your listeners.

BARBARA WALKER: So how did we get here? In your book you say that Hollywood has almost completely lost interest in making any kind of movies for adult audiences.

Mr. HARRIS: Well, I think one of the reasons is that it now costs, in many cases, more **to market** a movie than it does to make the movie: up to $40 to $50 million for a regular studio movie, sometimes more for a big adventure movie. And because marketing is so expensive, the people who pay for it, that is, the advertisers, can decide what movies get made in the first place. And what they want are movies that are **brands**, and there's not a lot of room for adult dramas based on just the quality of the story.

BARBARA WALKER: I'm interested in the examples that you offer in your book, and I want you to explain something. You said the problem, that is, the fact that there are very few movies made for adult audiences can in part be found in one specific film, "Top Gun", perhaps the biggest success by Tom Cruise.

Mr. HARRIS: Exactly. A movie made in 1986. I think that that moment, the "Top Gun" moment, in the mid-'80s, was a moment when movies changed from being about the content to being about the image. In other words, if you put all the right elements together - the star, the noisy soundtrack, the special effects, the poster, and the slogan - you can actually make a movie that will **appeal** to the largest possible audience, a movie that isn't necessarily very good quality, but that a lot of people can identify with.

BARBARA WALKER: So after "Top Gun", what kind of movies stopped getting made? What kind of movies for adults are we missing? Could a movie like "Marathon Man" or "Taxi Driver" or "The Godfather" be made and be successful now?

Mr. HARRIS: Well, it actually can be very good business to make adult dramas, like 'The Godfather' if you make them for, say, $40 million or less. You know, if you keep the cost under control, you can do very, very well. So, you know, even a movie like "The Social Network," still needs a movie studio to say yes to it and pay for it, and that's what's really hard right now.

BARBARA WALKER: There's another thing that I want to talk to you about before I let you go. You say that in these days, when marketing is everything, the audience is divided into groups

that are based on age and gender. And as I read that sentence, my goodness, it is so depressing to find out that women in Hollywood are basically treated like **garbage**.
Mr. HARRIS: It's absolutely true. If you're over 25, you're old. If you're under 25, you're not. You know, as someone who's much older than 25, I'm not happy about this either, but if you're a woman over 25, you're probably in the most **neglected** of those four groups. Movie producers really **assume** that unless there's a Sandra Bullock movie, moviegoers would probably rather stay at home. And it becomes a vicious circle because, of course, the fewer movies that are made for adults, the more people will stay home.
BARBARA WALKER: One more point before you go. We've heard that a sequel to "Top Gun", "Top Gun 2" is in production. Is that correct?
Mr. HARRIS: That's right, because all of the kids who loved "Top Gun" when they saw it in their late teens and early 20s are now the bosses in the studios. And that maybe is not such great news for those of us who love movies other than "Top Gun."
BARBARA WALKER: Mark, I'm afraid that's all the time we have for today. Thank you very much for this very interesting and entertaining chat.
Mr. HARRIS: Thank you.

Clau de respostes

1. How much does it cost to market a movie?
   - ❒ over $50 million.
   - ❒ **up to $40 or $50 million.**
   - ❒ under $40 million.
   - ❒ between $40 and $50.

2. Who decides what movies get made?
   - ❒ The people who make adult dramas.
   - ❒ The studios who make big adventure movies.
   - ❒ The studios that want quality stories.
   - ❒ **The people who pay for the marketing.**

3. Mark Harris considers "Top Gun" an important movie because…
   - ❒ it was one of Tom Cruise's greatest successes.
   - ❒ it had the right kind of soundtrack.
   - ❒ **it represented a change from content to image.**
   - ❒ it was made for a large audience.

4. Mark Harris thinks that a movie like "The Godfather" would probably not be made today because …
   - ❒ it might cost less than $40 million.
   - ❒ it was less successful than "Taxi Driver".
   - ❒ **it would probably cost too much money.**
   - ❒ it's not good business to make adult dramas.

5. According to Mr. Harris, the audience nowadays is divided into…
   - ❒ one group for age and one for gender.
   - ❒ **four groups, based on age and gender.**
   - ❒ two groups: over 25 and under 25.
   - ❒ four groups, based on marketing.

6. According to the interview, which group is the most neglected?
   - ❒ Basically, Hollywood women.
   - ❒ **Women who are over 25 years old.**
   - ❒ Women who are under 25 years old.
   - ❒ Adult women who stay at home.

7. Movie producers believe that a lot of people would stay home unless…
   - ❒ the movie shows a vicious circle.
   - ❒ the movie is made for a adult moviegoers.
   - ❒ Sandra Bullock plays a woman under 25.
   - ❒ **there's a movie with Sandra Bullock in it.**

8. Will there be a continuation of Top Gun?
   - ❒ No, because the bosses in the studios are not interested
   - ❒ Yes, and it is very good news for kids and teenagers.
   - ❒ **Yes, and that's bad news for those who love other kind of movies**
   - ❒ Maybe, because the kids who loved "Top Gun" are now the bosses.

Prova auditiva

LIVING IN GREENLAND

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

ice sheet: capa de gel / manto de hielo
snowplows: màquina llevaneu / máquina quitanieve
dog sleds: trineus tirats per gossos / trineos tirados por perros
stink: fer mala olor / apestar
sniff: ensumar / oler
spare change: xavalla / calderilla
Northern Lights: Aurora Boreal
whistle: xiular / silbar

Ready?
Now read the following questions. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

JOURNALIST: With us today is Chris Ryan, a student of Spanish Studies at the University of Lleida, who grew up in one of the world's remotest nations, Greenland. Today we would like to learn more about Greenland and Greenlandic life.

Now listen to the rest of the interview.

JOURNALIST: Good morning, Chris.

CHRIS: Good morning.

Journalist: Why did you choose the University of Lleida for your studies?

Chris Ryan: Well, you know Greenland is all about ice. The ice sheet covers about 80% of the landmass. Spain is just the opposite: sun, sun and more sun. Besides, every summer holiday we took a vacation in Spain, because my grandparents used to live in Lleida.
Journalist: What is your experience of Europe?
Ryan: Europe has so much. It has trees and warm weather, which I'm not used to. I can't cope well with warm weather. So when I am in Spain, I feel it's really, really hot.
Journalist: But how hot is hot? Do you mean twenty degrees Celsius? What do you do when it's thirty degrees?
Ryan: I just can't deal with that kind of heat. I think twenty degrees is really hot for me. That's the temperature in summer in Greenland! In Greenland, you don't walk around in T-shirts and shorts and stuff like that. I always feel kind of uncomfortable if I have to dress for warm weather. I'm always hot in Spain. I've never been in Lleida in July when it's 35º! (laughs)
Journalist: How are the winters back home?
Ryan: Well, there's a lot of snow, and if there's too much snow, you can't go to work. In most parts of Spain, as soon as there're five centimeters of snow, everything stops, because people aren't used to driving around in the snow. But up in Greenland it would have to be really wild before anything closed. Snowplows are driving around all the time.
Journalist: What's the name of the town you lived in?
Ryan: Nuuk. It's the capital city. It's the largest city in Greenland. When I lived there it was about thirteen thousand in population, and I think now they're up to about fifteen thousand.
Journalist: Did you ever find it boring?
Ryan: Living up there? No. I don't think so, though we looked forward to our vacation in Spain, because in Greenland, movies and clothes are like a year back. When we came to Spain, we got the newest clothes. But I was happy in Greenland.
Journalist: And how do you feel about it now?

Ryan: Now I've lived in Spain almost as long as I lived in Greenland, and it's almost like another part of my life, because everything's changed, and there's so much more to do in Spain.
Journalist: Did you people in Nuuk drive around in snowmobiles shooting at wolves?
Ryan: Well, There weren't snowmobiles—well, there were, but mainly, there were dog sleds. We actually don't shoot wolves, but we used to shoot a lot of other animals for example, reindeer. In fact, in Nuuk, you're not allowed to ride a dog sled. You've got to go further north, because the dogs can be really dangerous.
Journalist: The sled dogs?
Ryan: Yes. There are not many places in the city where you can have your twelve dogs, because they are so dangerous. They are really cute as puppies, but they aren't treated as pets. They are work dogs. The owners, of course, respect them and love them. But you don't go out and pet them. Small children might get killed if they came too close.
Journalist: Did you go riding on dog sleds?
Ryan: No. No, I never tried it. In Nuuk, it's something the tourists do. But not a lot of us did, because we had to go to another city. And to go to another city, you had to take a helicopter—no roads.
Journalist: Was there a hospital in Nuuk? What would you do if you got ill?
Ryan: There's a big hospital, actually, with the latest equipment. However, emergencies are flown into Denmark, but it's a four-hour flight. So it has to be really bad to decide to fly to Denmark. Actually, in Greenland, doctors and nurses are often Danish. Because, I don't know, it seems there aren't enough Greenlandic doctors.
Journalist: Right, Denmark exports medical interns to Greenland.
Ryan: Yes, and there're teachers that go there, too. And also, I think that when you come up there as a Dane, it pays really well. And there are not many places to spend the money. But it's also a bit expensive to live in Greenland, for example if you want to get fresh vegetables. A cucumber can easily cost four or five euro!
Journalist: What's the strangest thing that you thought was normal, when you were growing up in Greenland?
Ryan: Well, there're some things, yeah! When you thought something was cute, like a little child, for instance, you took your nose to the little child, and you sniffed. And said, *Iggu, igg'.*
Journalist: What does that mean?
Ryan: It means, yeah, *Yum, cute.*
Journalist: You smelled the kid. What else?
Ryan: On your birthday, they wake you up by shouting that you stink. Also, you are given a lot of spare change, and you throw your coins up in the air, and you yell, *Bagga.* And then all the little children get to collect the coins. Like if you had a *piñata* and candy, but in Greenland, it's money. I don't know why.
Journalist: Last recollections?
Ryan: In winter when we played outside there would often be Northern Lights. Which was both beautiful and frightening because it really made you feel so tiny, and also because we couldn't help ourselves testing the 'spirits' by whistling. A local myth says that the Northern Lights are dead spirits who are playing with a ball which is in fact a head–if you whistle while they play, they will come for you.
Journalist: That's very interesting. Thanks a lot, Chris. It's been a pleasure.

Clau de respostes

1. What makes Chris uncomfortable about the hot weather?
   - ❒ He's never hot in Greenland.
   - ❒ **The way he has to dress for hot weather.**
   - ❒ He doesn't like wearing short or t-shirts.
   - ❒ He doesn't know; he's never been in July in Lleida.

2. According to Chris, what's the main difference between winters in Greenland and in Spain?
   - ❒ **Everything stops in Spain if there's 5 cm of snow.**
   - ❒ There are no snowplows in Spain to take snow away.
   - ❒ In Greenland, people go wild when driving in the snow.
   - ❒ All shops close in Greenland when it snows.

3. Why did Chris like to go to Spain on holidays? Because…
   - ❒ it was almost as if he had always lived there.
   - ❒ he found Greenland boring.
   - ❒ **films and clothes were not so updated in Greenland.**
   - ❒ he could meet her grandparents.

4. Why are you NOT allowed riding dog sleds in Nuuk?
   - ❒ **Because dogs are dangerous; they are not pets.**
   - ❒ Because dogs are kept as pets.
   - ❒ Because a child was killed by a dog once.
   - ❒ Because dog owners do not respect them.

5. How do people travel from town to town in Greenland?
   - ❒ People have cars and bicycles.
   - ❒ **People fly by helicopter.**
   - ❒ People ride on dog sleds.
   - ❒ People ride on reindeer sleds.

6. Why do Danish teachers and doctors go to work in Greenland?
   - ❒ It's only a four-hour flight to Denmark.
   - ❒ It's compulsory before working in Denmark.
   - ❒ The pay is not very high but life is not expensive in Greenland.
   - ❒ **They are very well paid even if life in Greenland is expensive.**

7. Which two things does Chris mention as strange habits on your birthday in Greenland?
   - On your birthday, you …
   - ❒ are sniffed and you throw coins in the air which children collect.
   - ❒ have a *piñata* with coins instead of sweets and you are said to stink.
   - ❒ are sniffed and you are said to stink.
   - ❒ **are said to stink and you throw coins in the air which the children collect.**

8. Which is the local story behind the Northern Lights?
   - ❒ **The lights are spirits who take you if you whistle while they play.**
   - ❒ The lights are heads playing football.
   - ❒ The lights are whistles that play with balls.
   - ❒ People should whistle when the lights die out.

Prova auditiva

Interview with Steven Spencer (Detective David Jones)

Stephen Spencer made his acting debut at age 16 in BBC 2's television action film *Life or Death* and playing the role of detective David Jones at the age of 23, Jones has starred in five *David Jones'* films since 2001, with the final one being released in July 2011.

From a BBC Radio Interview. Adapted.

Mary: Welcome to our radio show *Celebrities*, today we have a very special guest. I'm very pleased to welcome onto the show now, um, oh, what do I call you? Do I call you Stephen, or Steve, or David?

Steve: Steve. Please call me Steve.

Mary: It's Steve Spencer, or David Jones. Star of detective David Jones films. Thanks for coming in today.

Steve: It's a pleasure... God... it's fantastic to be here today.

Mary: I am surprised to see that you look a little bit nervous…

Steve: No, I'm just really excited because I'm, I... I mean, I've never done an interview in a radio station before!

Mary: Really? Well that's exciting. Can I start by asking you about your last film? Is this your favourite so far?

Steve: I don't think you'll be disappointed. It's really good, I've seen the film twice now, the full, finished version, and it's really, really amazing. It's really sophisticated, it's brilliant. It's really... it's quite **scary**, in parts, I mean... I knew what was coming and I still jumped all the time! It's quite different from the other films.

Mary: And what about **stunts**? We've heard you like doing your own **stunts**, don't you?

Steve: It's just fun! I like doing most of them... but, obviously, if something's really really... like, if I'm incapable of doing something, then obviously I won't do it, because I'll probably just kill myself! So... yeah, I like to do as many as is possible.

Mary: So, which were the really good ones? Which were the most extreme? Could you tell us about a nice scary one?

Steve: On my latest film, for example, I had to do this thing where I was climbing up the face of this huge statue, I was on a **wire,** and I had to do all the climbing, and that was really fun, and there were lots of sword fights, so it was a bit dangerous but it was really great.

Mary: Have you ever had any great **bruise**s, or injuries?

Steve: Not really... I hope to get maybe a few battle **scars** on the film I am working on at the moment.

Mary: Right, we want you to tell us a bit about your director in this film. There was a story that the new director got each one of the actors and actresses to write essays about your characters.

Steve: Yeah, and that kind of revealed to us how much like our characters we are, and it terrified us, I think. Because... for example, in the film David, at his office, kind of does the work, but he doesn't really do any great work, he doesn't do much in fact, he doesn't like being in his office doing paperwork. So, I wrote just a few lines on a page, which was what David would have done. So, writing about my character was interesting but it was bit scary.

Mary: In this film Michael Goodman plays Jonathan Black, a serial killer. What was it like, working with him?

Steve: He's amazing! He's the coolest guy. We talked a lot about music. He's really big on music, really big on The Beatles and loads of other really cool bands.

Mary: Really? Can I ask you what kind of music you like? We've heard you're a major music fan, is this true?

Steve: Yeah**,** I love music.

Mary: Do you get to go to see any concerts?

Steve: Not as much as I'd like to, but I'm seeing the Chilli Peppers in Hyde Park. I'm going to that, I'm very excited, because The Drixies are supporting, but my first concert was The Strikes last year, in December, which was really good fun.

Mary: So when did you come across The Drixies?

Steve: Um... I bought a compilation of film soundtracks, and the song *"The name of my soul"* was on there, because it's part of the soundtrack to the film *Fight Club*, and so I went out and bought their greatest hits record *The Drixies*, and from there, I just, kind of, became obsessed, basically.

Mary: Completely obsessed.

Steve: Yeah.

Mary: And what about music festivals? Are you going to any?

Steve: Oh, I would love to…, but I don't... it's just... because I'm filming all the time, there's just no time at the moment. But soon, I'm hopefully going to get time to start going to some more concerts and music festivals, definitely.

Mary: If you ever got fed up and stopped acting, what would you do?

Steve: I'd actually like to be in a band.

Mary: Really?

Steve: I know that probably sounds really **weird**, because I'm here as an actor, but I actually would love to do it.

Mary: What instrument would you play?

Steve: Well, I'd like to sing. But, I kind of play a little bit of guitar, as well. I'm kind of getting there, but slowly.

Mary: Gosh, Steve, we are running out of time. Thank you very much for talking to us today.

Steve: Thank you very much indeed.

Clau de respostes

1. …has never been interviewed on the radio before.

2. …it is more sophisticated and scary.

3. …he had to climb up a statue.

4. Because he found out how much like David Jones he himself was.

5. Steve went to his first concert last year.

6. He heard one of their songs in a film soundtrack.

7. …is crazy about The Drixies.

8. …go to music concerts.

7. Tina's experience as an au pair was,
a. terrible.
b. wonderful.
c. depressing.
d. unbelievable.

8. Most Slovakian au pairs apply for the job mainly because…
a. they want to travel abroad to get a well-paid job.
b. it's a good opportunity to leave their homes and relatives.
c. their love relationships are broken and they want to meet new people.
d. it's a way of learning a language and earning some money.

Listening Comprehension

Lost...or maybe not.

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

crew: equip / equipo
***sequel* :** continuació / continuación
***clue*:** pista
***source* :** font / fuente
***huge* :** enorme
***stage*:** etapa
thread: fil / hilo
***to wrap up*:** concloure / concluir

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Since ***Lost***, one of the most successful TV shows in recent times, came to a dramatic finish at the end of the sixth season, many fans have been wondering whether the last episode could have possibly left any options for a sequel. In the following interview, Pat Lawson chats with Matthew Fox, Dr. Jack Shepard in the show, and tries to find out how truly final the end was.

Pat Lawson: Hellow, Matthew, thank you very much for accepting to chat with us about a TV show that has already become a legend for a lot of people.

Matthew Fox: Thank you, Pat, for inviting me and for giving me the opportunity to chat with your listeners about *Lost*, even though I think the word *legend* is probably a little too much.

Pat Lawson: Well, I don't know about that, Matthew. If we look at the number of websites and forums that even now stay active talking about the show, I think it is truly amazing.

Matthew Fox: That is true. I can't believe it myself! After the show finished I thought people would lose interest very quickly and move on to other shows, but it's been months now since the last episode aired and there's still a lot of speculation going on among the fans.

Pat Lawson: Tell us a little bit about these speculations. What do fans talk about?

Matthew Fox: All sorts of things, actually. Some people were really happy with the end while others were terribly disappointed. A lot of fans are trying to find hidden clues in the last episode about the possibility for a sequel. There are even some people who are convinced that the entire show was a secret message from extraterrestrials!

Pat Lawson: Well, I don't imagine that's true…or is it?

Matthew Fox: Ha-ha! No, no, it isn't true, unless the entire crew was abducted by aliens but we never knew it! It is just fascinating to see that something you have been a part of and helped create has become such a source of discussion for so many people.

Pat Lawson: So, if there was a sequel, would you be happy to participate in it?

Matthew Fox: First of all, there is NOT going to be a sequel. And I know that anything I say here will be the object of much discussion and speculation as soon as it's published, but, even if there was one, I don't think I'd be part of it.

Pat Lawson: Could you explain why?

Matthew Fox: Well, as you can imagine, *Lost* has been a turning point in my acting career and in my life in general. None of the people who participated in the show could ever have imagined that it would become as huge as it did. But I also think about it as a completed stage of my life. And I think most of the actors who were part of the show feel the same way.

Pat Lawson: Certainly a sequel of *Lost* without Dr. Shepard or Hurley, for example, wouldn't be the same.

Matthew Fox: Exactly, and that's why I don't think there will be a sequel. What we created with *Lost* was a really unique thing, not just the show itself, but all the interest it generated, the discussion forums, the theories about the island, the serious interest in aspects like time travel. I am afraid a sequel would ruin all of that.

Pat Lawson: You mentioned before that there were opposing opinions about the resolution of the show, in the last episode. How do you feel about that?

Matthew Fox: Personally I find the last episode very appropriate. The progress in the story line had become so very complicated that there was no easy way to finish all the open threads in one final episode. So, while it is true that many

questions remained unanswered, the idea that the characters had crossed the line between life and death seemed like a good way to wrap it all up.

Pat Lawson: That's actually one of the things a lot of people criticized, isn't it? The fact that the end was not very, how shall I say, realistic.

Matthew Fox: It's true, but then again, what's realistic about a tropical island inhabited by polar bears, smoke monsters and people who live hundreds of years? There was always an element of unreality in the show and that's why I think the end was in line with that.

Pat Lawson: Exactly! And that's why some of us liked it so much! Well, Matthew, it's been a pleasure talking to you about *Lost*. Even though you've made it quite clear that there will not be a continuation, we will keep our fingers crossed and hope that we get some more episodes of *Lost* in the future and, of course, we expect Dr. Shepard to be in it!

Matthew Fox: Thank you, Pat. It's been great to be here and talk to you about *Lost*. As I said, I don't think there will be any more Dr. Shepard, but who knows…

Choose the most appropriate answer according to the text. Only one answer is correct.

1. Matthew Fox is surprised that…
❒ people have lost interest in the show so soon.
❒ **so many people are still interested in the show.**
❒ people's interests have moved to other shows.
❒ speculation about the show lasted for one month.

2. About the show's end,
❒ everybody was happy with it.
❒ everybody was disappointed with it.
❒ people were neither happy nor disappointed.
❒ **some people liked it a lot, some didn't like it at all.**

3. What are some fans looking for in the last episode?
❒ Hidden secrets about the last episode.
❒ The presence of a hidden message.
❒ **Hidden cues about the possibility for a sequel.**
❒ Evidence of extraterrestrials.

4. Matthew Fox finds it fascinating that…
❒ they were all abducted by aliens but didn't know it.
❒ the show was a source of aliens.
❒ **so many people discussed the show.**
❒ the aliens helped to create the source of discussion.

5. How does Matthew Fox feel about the possibility of a sequel?

❒ He will know if there will be one as soon as the interview is published.
❒ **He's convinced that there will not be one.**
❒ He thinks the other actors disagree with him.
❒ He thinks a sequel would be a turning point in his career.

6. A sequel without Dr. Shepard or Hurley wouldn't be the same because…
❒ these characters did not generate a lot of interest in the forums.
❒ ***Lost* was a unique thing that can't be repeated.**
❒ they weren't interested in serious time travel.
❒ it would ruin the theories about the island.

7. According to Matthew Fox, the last episode is…

❒ appropriate because it is so complicated.
❒ **appropriate because it concludes a very complicated story line.**
❒ inappropriate because it finished all the open threads.
❒ inappropriate because all questions were answered.

8. Was *Lost* a realistic show?
❒ Yes, because the people in the island lived for hundreds of years.
❒ No, because polar bears and smoke monsters don't live hundreds of years.
❒ Yes, because tropical islands are usually inhabited by polar bears.
❒ **No, because it showed a tropical island inhabited by polar bears and smoke monsters.**

7. The author did the *Camino* because
   a. he had strong religious beliefs, just like many other pilgrims.
   b. as a pilgrim, he was looking for absolution.
   c. he wanted to experience a cheap walking holiday.
   d. he had never been to Santiago before.

8. When he reached Santiago, he was very pleased because
   a. he had won his *compostela*.
   b. he had to attend Mass in the cathedral.
   c. he could see the buskers and beggars in the square.
   d. he had completed the *Camino*.

Listening Comprehension

John Craven: the best-loved presenter on British television

In this radio programme you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

***missed*:** va faltar **/** faltó

apprentice: aprenent / aprendiz

eye-catching: que crida l'atenció / que llama la atención

push the boundaries*:* portar al límit / llevar al límite

AIDS*:* SIDA

rewarding: gratificant / gratificante

Ready?

Now read the questions on the next page. Read them carefully before listening to the radio programme.

Famous for his jumpers and his relaxed behaviour, John Craven is one of the best-loved presenters on British television. He has been the presenter of the BBC television programmes **Newsround** and **Countryfile** and in 1996 the Royal Television Society made John Craven a member of its Hall of Fame

From a BBC Radio Interview. Adapted.

Mary: John, we are delighted to have you here. Welcome to our programme.

John: Thank you for inviting me. It's a real pleasure.

Mary: Is it true that you only ever missed one episode of **Newsround** and that was because your wife was having a baby?

John: No, that's not exactly true. The first edition I **missed** was in the very early days, in 1972, when my first daughter was born and the newsreader Richard Whitmore took over for me. Later, I did miss two or three editions because of illness and when the programme went daily round the year, every week, I did take some holidays!

Mary: How did you start in the TV business?

John: Well, I left school at 16 and got a job as a commercial **apprentice.** But I was really more interested in writing than in studying to be a company secretary so after three years I became a junior reporter for a local newspaper. Maybe I should have studied harder and tried to get to university, but in those days you didn't need a degree to get into journalism and I had a great time in my early twenties learning my trade.

Mary: What do you think of the way news programmes have developed? What is the impact of computers for example?

John: Computer graphics have changed everything and almost every story seems to need an **eye-catching** graphic. Because television is THE visual medium, I think there can be a tendency for television producers to say: "We've got a great graphic here, now what's the story to go with it?" Some can be extremely helpful in understanding a subject as well as being entertaining to watch, but I often ask myself if some of them are really needed.

Mary: Are there any decisions you regret as editor of **Newsround**? Did you ever feel that you went too far with a story, or not far enough?

John: No, I don't regret any editorial decisions I made on **Newsround**. Sometimes we did **push the boundaries**, such as the first time we reported on **AIDS**. It was in the late 1980s, and children were being told they could catch AIDS from toilet seats, from kissing dad, things like that. So we decided to correct all that by devoting a whole edition of Newsround to AIDS and putting it into a proper perspective. I thought we might get lots of complaints, but we had only two, and one of them said we had not gone far enough.

Mary: Why did you decide to leave **Newsround** and work on **Countryfile** rather than staying with the news? Was it a difficult decision? Do you have any regrets?

John: I moved to **Countryfile** from **Newsround** because the job was offered to me and, after many years in the daily news business, I thought that presenting a weekly programme about the countryside would be a very pleasant change - and so it has proved to be. I was looking for a new direction. I have always had great affection for the countryside, and my years on **Newsround** had developed my interest in the environment and conservation, so **Countryfile** was for me the perfect choice. I see some of the best bits of Britain on my **Countryfile** travels, which makes the job even more **rewarding.**

Mary: Are there any other jobs in television that you would still like to do?

John: I would love to work on a programme for children and teenagers.

Mary: Children and teenagers are often said to be only interested in quiz shows and pop stars, do you think that is a **fair** criticism?

John: Not in my experience. During my time on **Newsround**, I got thousands of letters from children expressing strong opinions on a huge variety of topics. They have high ideals, they want to prevent the world from destroying itself - the problem has always been in retaining those ideals when they grow up. And anyway, what's wrong with being interested in pop stars?

Mary: I believe that you presented **Newsround** for about 17 years. Do you have any idea how long you'll stay on **Countryfile** and do you think you'll stay in television for the rest of your working life?

John: Yes, I was with **Newsround** for 17 years and I've been with **Countryfile** since 1989 so I have spent almost all my broadcasting years as lead presenter on just two programmes. I am proud to be associated with these programmes. I hate the thought of retiring and hope to keep broadcasting for as long as people will have me.

Mary: Well John, I'm afraid we've run out of time. Thank you very much for being with us, and the best of luck with **Countryfile**!

John: Thank you. It was a real pleasure.

Choose the most appropriate answer according to the text. Only one answer is correct. [0.25 each correct answer]

1. John Craven first missed an episode of Newsround because
- □ his wife was ill.
- □ **his daughter was born.**
- □ he was on holiday.
- □ his daughter was ill.

2. John Craven started out in journalism as a
- □ commercial apprentice.
- □ company secretary.
- □ student of journalism at university.
- □ **reporter on a local newspaper.**

3. John Craven thinks that computer graphics are
- □ absolutely necessary nowadays on television.
- □ useless to help the audience understand a story.
- □ only needed on television if they are really eye-catching.
- □ **changing the way stories are presented on television.**

4. After an edition of Newsround entirely devoted to AIDS, John Craven
- □ regretted having pushed the boundaries.
- □ believed he had not gone far enough.
- □ received lots of complaints.
- □ **did not have any regrets.**

5. John Craven accepted presenting the programme Countryfile because
- □ he was fed up with the daily news business after 17 years.
- □ it was the only choice he had after 17 years on Newsround.
- □ **he felt like changing directions and doing something new.**
- □ he wanted to contribute to the conservation of the environment in Britain.

6. In the future, John Craven would like to present a TV programme
- □ about travelling in the countryside.
- □ about the environment and sightseeing.
- □ for people living in the countryside.
- □ **for teenagers and children in general.**

7. According to John Craven, children and teenagers
- □ **are interested in many different things.**
- □ have too many problems.
- □ think adults are destroying the world.
- □ are only interested in quiz shows and pop stars.

8. John Craven
- □ has been the lead presenter of Newsround since 1989.
- □ **is very proud of his job in Newsround and Countryfile.**
- □ has been the lead presenter of Countryfile for 17 years.
- □ would not mind retiring from the broadcasting business.

7. The author's views on the new social networks could be said to be generally...
a**. positive.**
b. negative.
c. sceptical.
d. indifferent.

8. The article concludes that...
a. it is impossible to tell what is good from what is bad on the net.
b. there is too much information on the net.
c. only those who control the net will be successful in the world.
d. the internet may become the most powerful political tool in the future.

Comprensió Auditiva

THE END OF THE WORLD TRAIN

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean

bay*:* badia / bahía
timber : fusta per a la construcció /madera para la construcción
bounded**:** delimitat / delimitado
convicts **:** presos / presos
woodcutting site: serradora / serrería
mainland: terra ferma / tierra firme

Ready?
Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

PRESENTER: Ushuaia in Argentina is the southernmost city in the world. No other place gives us the opportunity to make a trip on the Southern Railway, proudly advertised as *The end of the World Train*. Today in our program "Round the World", I'm pleased to introduce Chris Van Gils, a keen traveller. Hi Chris and welcome to our program.

CHRIS: Thanks a lot for your invitation.

PRESENTER: Chris, today we are going to talk about a train rather than about the city of Ushuaia. The train is the most popular tourist attraction in this city, isn't it?

CHRIS: Well, yeah. Ushuaia is the capital city of the Argentinean Province of *Tierra del Fuego* and commonly regarded as the entry to Antarctica. As you said, there is no other city which is more southern. It's located in a wide bay on one of the islands of Tierra del Fuego, …- don't forget it IS an island- and bounded on the north by mountains, the Martial Mountain Range and by water, the Beagle Channel, on the

south. Besides, it has about 60,000 inhabitants. Not many people, I'm afraid, to have a lot of tourist attractions. So, yeah, the train is one of the most interesting attractions in the city.

PRESENTER: Ok, so let's concentrate on the train. Why is it called *The End of the World Train*?

CHRIS: Well, it is quite literally The End of the World Train because there is no other train anywhere closer to one of the poles.

PRESENTER: So why build a train on an island where so few people live?

CHRIS: To understand why this railroad is where it is, you have to realize that *Tierra del Fuego* is completely cut off from the rest of South America by virtually impassable mountains and is surrounded by water. It is almost impossible to reach except by ship or air and therefore, it served as Argentina's maximum-security prison. In the same way as England once deported those considered undesirable to Australia, Argentina sent its worst criminals to *Tierra del Fuego*. They built a prison for dangerous criminals. Escape from there was virtually impossible and the convicts had to survive as best as they could.

PRESENTER: Interesting. A prison in Ushuaia is the start of the train? When was that?

CHRIS: We are talking about the 1880s. That's when the first prison was established but it was not till the beginning of the 20th century that the jail received its first prisoners. According to the Penal Code of the time, their sentences were just a bit below the death penalty. They were convicts of the worst kind; they were in prison for the second or third time.

PRESENTER: So then Ushuaia is also the name of the prison?

CHRIS: Yeah, yeah. But the name of the city does not mean prison or anything similar. It comes from the Yamanas, the indigenous people who inhabited *Tierra del Fuego*. In their language, Ushuaia means "deep bay to the west".

PRESENTER: And what about the train? Why was it built?

CHRIS: The jail was built using local materials: basalt rock, timber from the forests, clay and sand from the streams in the region. The convicts themselves built the prison. The train was set up to transport these materials. At the beginning it ran on wooden rails and later, in 1909, a real train was built which was popularly known as the "Convict Train".

PRESENTER: So the railway was built to transport wood from the forests for heating and building purposes, as well as other materials, wasn't it?

CHRIS: Exactly. The little train crossed the town along the waterfront, linking the jail to the woodcutting site where prisoners once collected timber.

PRESENTER: And, Chris, the train is still working today. So has it been running without interruption since 1909?

CHRIS: Yes and no. Let me explain. In 1949 there was a violent earthquake that destroyed the railway. Besides, by that time the prison had been closed down and things were very different from the way they were at the beginning of the century. So it wasn't until 1994 that the train started running again to and from the Tierra del Fuego National Park. The trip is now a tourist attraction and it is much shorter than it used to be, but one can still get the feeling of what it was like.

PRESENTER: Chris, I'm afraid we've run out of time. Thanks a lot for your interesting stories.

CHRIS: Thank you.

1. Where is Ushuaia located?
❒ On the mountainous island of Antarctica.
❒ **On an island by a channel.**
❒ On the mainland near Beagle Channel.
❒ On mainland Argentina.

2. What type of prison was built in Ushuaia?
❒ A prison for first-time convicts.
❒ A prison for people sentenced to death.
❒ A prison for Australian and English prisoners.
❒ **A maximum security prison.**

3**. When did the first prisoners arrive in Ushuaia?**
❒ At the end of the 18th century.
❒ At the beginning of the 19th century.
❒ **At the beginning of the 20th century**
❒ At the end of the 19th century.

4. Which of the following sentences is TRUE?
❒ The Yamanas gave the name to the prison.
❒ Yamana is the name of the prison in Ushuaia.
❒ **The name Ushuaia comes from the indigenous people.**
❒ There were no indigenous people in *Tierra del Fuego*.

5. Who built the prison?
❒ It was built by the people of Ushuaia.
❒ **It was built by all the prisoners.**
❒ It was built only by the prisoners sentenced to death.
❒ We do not know exactly who built the prison.

6. What other name did the train have?
❒ The Wooden Train.
❒ **The Convict Train**.
❒ The Prison Train
❒ The Transport Train.

7. Which route did the train cover when it was used by the prisoners?
❒ It started in the jail and ended in the city.
❒ It ran from the waterfront to the prison.
❒ It went from Ushuaia to the National Park.
❒ **It started in the prison and ended in the forest.**

8. Why did the train stop running in 1949?
❒ The government closed it down.
❒ The National Park opened.
❒ The prison was closed and it was no longer needed.
❒ **It was destroyed by an earthquake.**